

**TEMPTING
IRRETERRI
BEN BOSWELL**

Tempting Terri

Ben Boswell

Tempting Terri ALL RIGHTS RESERVED

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FOREWORD

Two Sides of Terri is perhaps my favorite of the books I've written. Maybe because it was the first longer-form work I actually completed, or perhaps just because Terri came to life for me more than almost any of my other characters, I've always had a special place in my heart for that book, and indeed for Bill and Terri. So despite the fact that readers have been asking for a sequel for years, it took me a long time to come around to writing one. Basically, I didn't want to fuck it up.

The challenge with this sort of story is that you can either go dark or light. Dark drags the plot into themes of betrayal, humiliation, hurt and pain. I didn't want that. At least exclusively. Light, in some ways, is even worse: happy swingers, and the whole "plot" just ends up revolving around different pairings – FF, MMF, MFF, MMMF, etc – like a bad porno, back when they actually made pornographic *movies* rather than just shot individual scenes. Who would have imagined anyone would look back on formulaic, shot-on-video porn of the 1980s as some lost standard of excellence? *You mean, there were actually characters? Who appeared in more than one scene? Dialogue, however stilted? Shocking!* Anyway, I digress.

I didn't want to just recycle Bill and Terri into a series of empty sexual vignettes. More importantly, I didn't want to do anything too mean to them. I like them. Terri especially, but Bill too in his own way. Now, I'm not going to say that nothing unpleasant occurs. A book, even an erotic novella, needs some sort of tension, and you don't get tensions if everyone is on the same page emotionally at every stage of the story. But I hope you'll agree that I managed to be true to the characters even as I introduced some depth to their story and some challenges to their future.

This is not the end of the line for Bill and Terri. Instead, this is the second act of a three-part arc. I do think this book stands alone, but you'll enjoy it more if you've read *Two Sides of Terri* first. And I hope that as you finish

this – and then digest the teaser from the finale, *Taming Terri* – you’ll look forward to reading the next, and final installment in the trilogy.

Happily, you won’t have to wait too long for the third volume. Indeed, the two releases should follow on one another within a few weeks or so.

I’d like to thank all the readers who enjoyed the first book and clamored for a sequel. Of course, big thanks to Kenny Wright for his encouragement and his cover designs. And this time around, also thank you to readers Marge G and Michael Kay for helping catch typos and other editorial suggestions. I’m sure some errors still got through, but many fewer than would have been the case otherwise.

Ben Boswell, 2016

PROLOGUE

I'm not into the idea of my wife being with another man. But I do love what it does to her. I know that will seem like a bizarre distinction. A distinction without a difference. Or perhaps a bullshit rationalization. If you not only don't stop it, but have actually encouraged it, then you must want it, right?

But I don't. I swear I don't. Every time it has happened it has been a horse kick in the chest, knocking me on my ass. Painful, both emotionally and even physically. Stomach churning and nausea provoking. But also hot.

For her the thrill is to tap into her adventurous, lusty side. The excitement of a new man. Flirting. Letting herself be seduced. Being kissed by someone different. Feeling his hands on her body. Different scents, tastes, sensations. And of course, that sense of being desired. So addictive, even though Terri, blond, busty, beautiful, would seem, objectively, to need no additional positive reinforcement. Still she loved it.

She more than loved it; it transformed her. It gave her a new spark. A new vitality. She was suddenly a wicked tease, a temptress. Passionate to the point of hunger. Reckless, gambling, eyes sparkling and chest heaving. Explosive. Lusty.

A little scary. Maybe even a lot.

It was an indescribable thrill to see her, my wife, the mother of my children, my best friend, suddenly turning into someone else. Someone crazy and sexy and wild, and fuck, it is hard to explain, but someone so... fucking... alive.

It began with a revelation about an old boyfriend, and quickly progressed through a torrid affair with him. It was terrifying and amazingly exciting. We broke it off with Chucky because he was too dangerous. His ability to connect with Terri too much of a threat. Her ability to resist him too much in question. And yet neither Terri nor I had been able or willing to completely forsake the rush.

Once I'd seen what she became with Chucky, it felt like trying to hide that side of her was akin to caging a tiger. Still beautiful to look at, and yet, tragic. It isn't so much that I got off on the idea of her being with

another man, but rather I got off on the idea of her getting off on it. And anyway, I couldn't bring myself to deny it to her.

Even still, it was complicated. It made me so fucking jealous to think of another man even flirting with her. Dealing with her actually being with another man... men... was devastating. Just brutal. And yet. Fuck. Fuck, it was hot.

I almost wish I was wired differently. It would be so convenient if I were actually into it; although, I suspect it would be less exciting. I don't know, but that sort of, what, swinger outlook, has always struck me as sort of sad. Like you don't care enough about the other person to be jealous.

Well, that wasn't my problem. No. I was jealous alright. But I was also hooked. Fuck me, was I ever hooked

Now, I don't want to make it seem like Terri was constantly out and about fucking other men. Soon after Chucky there had been a fling with a sexy, French Army colonel. Away from home and safe, it was a way for us to reassert our control over the situation without Chucky. And that had been it. But it was enough. A small dose of that goes a long way, especially with Terri's skill at parceling out her revelations, at *suddenly* remembering a new detail, a new sensation, and most of all at teasing me.

Teasing *me*. That is what made it tolerable, ultimately, knowing that whatever had happened, whatever would happen, she'd always come back to me. The flings were just that. Passing moments. Impermanent. With Chucky out of the picture, it was, in a way that was weird, but no less real as a consequence, about *us*.

Did I ever tell you about the night Jean-Pierre made love to me out on his balcony?

I was rock hard. She impaled herself on me, her pussy sloppy wet right from the beginning.

I was a little nervous being outside, Baby. So, at first, we were almost fully clothed. He just bent me over the railing, slid my panties aside, and took me from behind. It was amazing. Looking out over Paris. Seeing the Eiffel Tower glittering across the river. The whole City of Lights spread out before us. People laughing and drinking in the café right beneath us.

Every girl should get fucked at least once in her life on a Paris balcony by a sexy Frenchman. I'd love to do it again.

Bam. That was all I could stand. Before I knew it, I was shooting my come inside her. I started to apologize, but she just shushed me. Pressing her body fully against mine, she continued writhing on top of me, feeding me more luscious details.

Once I relaxed a little, he started stripping me. First, he just lifted up my dress. Higher and higher. Exposing my thighs. And then my ass. Remember that I'd bought those sexy, white, lace garter-belt and stockings for him? That's what I was wearing. They were almost glowing in the moonlight.

My cock began to stiffen again as she continued her breathy recollections.

I looked at the buildings across the square. Full of people and life. No one was looking at us, but they might at any moment. Then he pulled my dress completely off, over my head. He threw it inside his apartment, and now I was just in my lingerie, bent over the railing. Having me like that excited him. I know because he started fucking me harder. Not faster, honey, but harder. You know what I mean?

I just nodded. I couldn't really speak. I was fully erect again. She adjusted herself slightly, and I slid back inside her pussy, hot, loose, full of my come.

Let me show you.

She gathered her knees beneath her and sat upright on top of me. Then, slowly, slowly she rose up, letting my cock slip out of her a millimeter at a time, until after the longest time, I had only the tip inside her. She paused. And when I almost couldn't take it. When I was about ready to thrust up inside her, she dropped back down, hard, impaling herself on me. She ground against me for a moment, and then lifted herself up again.

It was just like that. Slow and hard at the same time. Anticipation, anticipation, and then relief, but not enough to satisfy, just enough to make me want more. Does it turn you on to think of me like that? Half-naked and on display. Getting fucked by a virtual stranger. Whimpering for his cock. Mewling in delight when he speared me. Do you like that?

"Yes," I grunted.

Good. I liked it too. So much. And then he unsnapped my bra and slid it off as well. And now with each hard thrust I could feel my tits swaying beneath me. He grabbed my hair and pulled my head up, putting my boobs on display. I looked across at the other apartment building, and now I saw a man. And then another. And a couple. All looking at us. At me. Jean-Pierre reached around and started playing with my nipples. They were hard, sensitive, and his touch was almost too much, but also delicious. Every time he tweaked them, my pussy twitched with excitement.

She paused and looked down at her bare breasts. It took me a moment, but I got the idea. I reached up and began rolling her swollen nipples between my fingers.

That's it, Baby, that just how Jean-Pierre did it. And then he stepped back and his cock came out. I begged him not to stop. Begged him to put it back in. But then I felt him start pulling down my panties. I tried to stop him. I know it sounds crazy. He was already fucking me. I was already almost naked. But that little wisp of fabric was my last bastion of modesty. And as I felt it come off, felt the cool Paris air against my wet, shaved pussy, I felt so dirty. I felt like such a slut. They slipped to the floor, and I stepped out of them. He picked them up and held them aloft. One of the men across the way was stroking himself. Another let out a yelp. The couple were just grinning. And then, suddenly, he thrust back inside me. I gasped.

She gasped for me as well, and now she started bouncing up and down on my prick faster and faster.

He fucked me harder and harder. His big cock pounding into me again and again and again. Like a machine. And I started screaming. I couldn't help it. It just came out. He'd taught me some French. Ah oui, c'est bon.

Yes, that's good.

Baise-moi! Baise-moi, papa!

Fuck me. Fuck me, daddy!

Encule moi!

Fuck my ass. My balls tightened. I grunted. I began to come inside her. At the same moment, she threw her head back and growled. Her pussy clenching on my shaft again.

Oh God. Oh God, Baby. He made me come so hard. You both make me come sooo hard. And then he came inside me. It felt so good, so good.

She fell forward onto my chest. A strand of her sweaty hair draped across my face. She nuzzled her chin against my shoulder. Her hot breath gasping in my ear.

They cheered us. The people across the way. And some at the café downstairs who were now looking up at us.

Even still, after nearly a year, it almost felt as if we'd gone back to normal. Until....

CHAPTER ONE

“... and a coupe of champagne for the pretty lady,” the bartender added as he poured her glass.

Terri giggled. “I bet you say that to all the girls.”

She batted her eyelashes at him.

“Only the beautiful ones.”

“I’m right here, you know,” I commented without taking my eyes from the TV. Studied indifference. Was I trying to prove I was cool? Or was I egging her on?

I could feel him sizing me up. It wasn’t really fair. He was fifteen years younger and seemed to spend his time equally between the gym and the tattoo parlor, though his face had an open, innocent appeal, big blue eyes and thick, wavy hair.

She placed a hand on my forearm. “Don’t worry about my husband. He’s very open-minded.”

He grinned. “Well, that’s good to hear....”

“Terri,” she answered, holding out her hand.

“I’m Brian,” he replied. “I’ll be right back. Just let me know if you need *anything*.”

“Oh, I will,” she cooed.

Once he was out of earshot, I said, “I didn’t realize you liked tattoos so much.”

She nodded thoughtfully. “I’d never get one myself, of course, but you have to admit, it works on him. Maybe it is just all those muscles.”

“Are you really into him? Or are you just punishing me for wanting to watch the end of this game?”

I’m not a sports nut, but once in a blue moon, I do get wrapped up in something. In this case, it was the Premier League, and I just wanted to catch the conclusion of this game.

She batted her eyelashes at me now. “Why not both?”

Oh God.

I’m completely paranoid about being late, and we’d left early for dinner at Marlin Malin, which I think is French for smart fish or something. Anyway, new place, trendy, expensive, hard to get a reservation especially

on a Friday night, and traffic is usually a nightmare. But like Moses parting the Red Sea, there always seemed to be an open lane, and all the traffic lights aligned. We decided to get a drink at the brass-railed, dark-wood bar next door. A jazz trio playing. Men in tailored suits. Women in clingy dresses. A happy hour crowd, but a place where people change to get more dressed up after work before going.

“Terri, you know our reservation isn’t even for an hour.”

“So I have to find something to keep me busy while you watch the game.”

“You could watch it too.”

“Problem is, seeing all those sweaty, athletic men on the field....”

She trailed off as Brain returned.

“I know *you’re* an athlete,” she cooed at him, flicking a strand of blond hair from her eyes. “You don’t just watch it on TV.”

I rolled my eyes. She ignored me, eyes on him.

He seemed to have gotten over whatever hesitations he’d had.

“I played football in college.”

“Oooh,” she gushed.

“Now I mostly work out.”

“I can tell.”

He leaned forward over the bar.

“You look like you work out too,” he said.

She rose out of her seat to give him a better view. She was wearing a long, blue, satin dress that hugged her body. And what a body. Tall and slender with full breasts and an amazing butt. Classic American beauty. Blake Lively. Heather Graham. Amber Heard. That kind of look.

“Oh, I do a little yoga.”

I chuckled as she sat back down.

“What?” she asked, mock offended.

Brian discretely ducked away from the potential confrontation.

“You trying to get him to picture you in yoga pants or in Downward Dog?”

“I was thinking more Cow.”

I groaned. Hands and knees. Head up. Why did I know yoga poses? And why was it so easy to picture my wife presenting herself to another man like that?

“Doesn’t sound as sexy,” I protested.

“You’re right. Anyway, I think I’d want to be able to watch him....”
Fucking me, I filled in the ellipses in my head.

“Terri –“

“He reminds me a little of Chucky,” she interrupted pointedly.

I groaned. She grinned.

Brian returned, a bottle in each hand. He refilled her champagne and my Maker’s Mark.

“We didn’t –“ I protested.

“On the house,” he replied.

“How will I *ever* repay you?” she flirted.

He smiled and walked away. I followed him with my eyes. Cocky young fuck. Powerful shoulders rolling confidently. Not even a glance back.

I turned back to find Terri grinning at me.

“So, should I fuck him?” she asked.

“Terri.... I....”

She laughed. A soft, lilting trill. Amused but not mocking. “What’s the matter Bill? Cat got your tongue?”

“I don’t know. It’s –“

“Not a hard question,” she interrupted.

I stammered for an answer, but I couldn’t seem to form any coherent sounds.

“Or is it?” she mused.

Yes. No. Maybe. *Fuck. Fuck!*

“It has been a while since anything new has happened,” she noted.

“Any new adventures.”

I still couldn’t speak.

She seemed happy to continue her monologue. “I wouldn’t want you to get bored with me.”

I never could, I thought. But why couldn’t I say it? Anyway, my bigger worry was that she’d one day be bored with me.

“I think you want me to,” she said. “Fuck him, I mean.”

“I’m... I’m not the boss of you,” I replied awkwardly, finally.

She chuckled. “No. You’re not.”

I nodded, as if something had been settled. And maybe it had.

A surge of sound drew my attention to the TV. I watched the replay of the goal I’d missed, a crazy cross from the sideline, arcing, slicing, the striker making a mad dash through three defenders, a desperately

outstretched leg, the ball redirected off an exposed shin, a diving keeper, fingertips on the ball, but not enough to keep it from slicing into the corner of the goal. A beautiful, graceful, athletic play.

“I’m going on break.”

It was Brian, standing beside us now, tall, and buff, and full of confidence.

“Want to join me?” he asked my wife, his hand extended.

She didn’t answer right away. Her twinkling eyes were fixed on mine. She was dragging it out. My mind raced. Terri naked on her hands and knees. Brian looming her rear, his muscular, tattooed arm reaching out to seize a handful of her thick hair, as he pounded her from behind. Then on her back, legs up and spread in an inviting V, Brian’s powerful ass clenching as he fucked her hard. Standing up now, her leg wrapped around his waist, arms clenching at his thick neck, moaning with sloppy, deep kisses.

No. No. No! I screamed inside my head.

A sly smile spread across her face, mouth curling just at the corners, lowering her chin to gaze at me through a loose strand of blond hair. How did she do that? Get just a small strand of her locks to slide across her face. Just the right amount to flick away or peer through sexily as the mood struck her. She was a master of those small, feminine gestures that are, oddly, sometimes even sexier than anything big and showy.

She knew she had me hooked. Her lips parted slightly, a small flash of pink as she ran her tongue across teeth. Instinctively it made me think of her other set of lips, pink, damp with excitement. I wanted to grab her and yank her toward me, kiss her wetly, drag her from the bar and, frankly, fuck her brains out.

But I didn’t move. Not a muscle. My inaction was an invitation to Brian, encouragement to Terri.

He curled his fingertips slightly, an almost imperceptible gesture. But she responded. I watched in slow motion as my wife reached out and placed her left hand in his palm, and I watched as his fist closed over her hand, covering her engagement and wedding rings. He wore a thumb ring that called attention to his thick fingers. It was unambiguously phallic, and that was probably the point.

Had Terri noticed it too? Of course. She’d been thinking of screwing the muscular asshole and his big prick from the moment he came over to

take our order. I felt a surge of rage at him. At men like him and Chucky who could cast a spell on women, on my wife.

And then we were back in real time as she hopped off the barstool. He turned and I watched as he led my wife away from me. She trailed behind him for a moment, eyes still locked on mine, her grin widening until he pulled her to his side and wrapped his powerful arm possessively around her waist. She look away from me and toward him. I saw him speak, heard her throaty laugh, and then they were gone.

I reached behind me and closed my hand on my drink. Without looking, I brought it to my lips and gulped. My throat burned, my head spun, my stomach rumbled, and I found myself gripping the bar for support. I slammed the glass down on the bar, and when the other bartender looked over, I nodded and he wordlessly came over to refill it.

I couldn't look in his eyes. He *knew*. Of course he did. I could hear Brian's deep voice in my head.

Hey buddy, cover me for a few. I need to fuck this hot blonde at the bar.

I watched the TV without seeing it. It was just a random flash of movement and colors. All I could think about was my wife. Well, no, that's not quite right. I wasn't *thinking*. There were no organized thoughts. Just a jumble of images and emotions.

Terri kissing Brian's throat. His hands cupping her ass. Her painted fingernails running across his muscular chest. His fingers winding into her thick hair. Biting her lip. Lifting up her dress, his strong hand sliding into her thin panties. Her tongue teasing the underside of his hard cock. Could I hear her moaning? Was that just my imagination? *Fucking slut*. I wished I could stop her. And then I remembered that I could. I just had to say the word. But either I couldn't, or didn't want to.

Fuck, fuck, fuck. I didn't want her to be with another man, but I loved that she was the kind of woman who would... just... follow her appetites like that. A woman who was confident enough to throw convention, and our wedding vows, to the wind.

I should hate her for it, but I didn't. Instead, all I could think of was the look on her face as he first entered her. Fucking a young, handsome stranger while her husband waited at the bar. A smirk turning into a satisfied grin. But as good as it felt, I knew she was thinking about me just as I was of her. Maybe not as obsessively. She had a pressing distraction, after all. A

fat cock pounding up inside her, driving her wild. But even still, I knew she was thinking of me. Not doing it for me, per se, but in a weird way because of me. Because of how it would inflame me. No, I wasn't naïve enough to think that it was all about my pleasure. She'd told me too often how good it made *her* feel. But I knew she was thinking of me. And in a weird way, that's what made it alright, knowing that I was in her mind even as another man was inside her.

The strangest thing about all of this was how normal – heck, bland – we'd been before. Before Chucky: Vanilla. In a decade together, we'd had shower sex twice, both times on vacation. Once, very early on in our relationship, watching a movie on TV had turned into a passionate make-out session, and then awkward, clothes-half-on sex on the sofa.

The closest thing to crazy had been after a New Year's Eve party. A night of drinking and dancing. We'd walked home unsteadily. God, she'd been so sexy, in spiky heels, with her long, blond hair in loose spiral curls. I remember thinking that she looked so hot that night, the sexiest chick at the party, and that other men had noticed. Knowing she was mine had definitely gotten me charged up. And I remember being jealous. It had made me more, I don't know, aggressive maybe? Possessive at least. Holding her tight. Kissing her openly. Showing off a little.

We were living in an apartment at the time, and I'll always remember the elevator ride. The powerful sexual energy of it. We couldn't quite look each other in the eye. I just wanted to tear off her clothes and fuck her like an animal. But we didn't do that. That was not our *thing*. But it felt different that night. I can't explain it. I realized I was breathing hard. As crude as it sounds, it was as if I could smell her excitement.

The elevator door opened and she hurried out. I followed behind her, my eyes glued to her swiveling ass. She was walking so rapidly that I wondered for a second whether she was trying to get away from me, but then I realized she was just desperate to get behind a locked door. I closed the distance in a heartbeat and pressed against her just as she flung the door open. We stumbled inside. I kicked the door shut.

When I thought about it after, I couldn't shake the image of an atomic explosion. Our two bodies came together and we were suddenly at

critical mass. She sucked on my neck until I grunted in pain, but it didn't slow me from tearing at her blouse to get at her tits. I mashed them hard, pushing up her bra. Instead of objecting, she gave as good as she got, jerking my hard cock roughly through my pants. She jammed her tongue down my throat. I ran my hand up her inner thigh, hot and moist to my touch.

Then suddenly she shoved me away. Hard. I slammed into the wall. But before I could take offense or even process it, she reached up under her skirt and yanked down her panties, stepping out of them gracefully despite her high-heels. She turned and faced the wall and raised her skirt. Her perfect little ass gyrated seductively. I stepped in close.

I don't even remember dropping my pants. What I do remember is plunging inside her from behind. Hearing her sultry moan. Seeing her palms slide up the wall to steady herself. She was so wet and so hot and so excited. She fucked me as hard as I fucked her. Feral, desperate, wild.

She threw her head back and moaned. I sucked on her neck as I came inside her.

And then the fever broke. Instantly, it felt awkward. I couldn't find the words to tell her how amazing it had been. In the face of my stunned silence, she fled to the bathroom to get cleaned up and changed into her flannels.

It had been amazing and yet wrong. I'm not sure why. Was that a fork in a road that we might have taken that night? I don't know.

As it turned out, it was a fork. I spent a couple of weeks convincing myself that I *wanted* to talk about it. And then another couple working up the courage to broach the topic. But then the night I had planned for the *talk*, she beat me to the punch with her own revelation.

You can never be sure about these things, but when we did the math later, it seemed likely that we'd conceived Braden that night.

CHAPTER TWO

If it was rough seeing my wife walk away with another man, it was infinitely worse seeing them walk back, hand-in-hand, a big goofy smile on her face. She was glowing, a little flush, a couple of strands of hair sticking to her forehead. And that fucker Brian was grinning like the fucking Cheshire cat, the fucking fucker.

He saw me and smiled even wider.

I just fucked the living shit out of your wife.

This was the part I'd never been able to deal with. Chucky had thrown it in my face once, but for the most part I'd dealt with my wife's infidelity through her, through her excited recollections. But I also knew she filtered it for me. Calibrated her disclosures to maximize my excitement and minimize my suffering.

As they approached, I braced myself. He was a buff, handsome guy, and I was a... a pathetic, weak cuckold. He'd taken my wife. Picked her up right in front of me. Led her away and fucked her. And I'd done nothing to stop it.

His and my eyes met. I tried to steel myself, even though I felt fragile. It was a bluff, and happily he didn't call it. He gave me a quick nod. I watched as he leaned in and kissed Terri on the cheek. A word in her ear. She smiled. His hand lingered on her arm, their eyes met, a moment passed between them, and then he was back behind the bar as if nothing had happened.

Terri hopped up onto her barstool. She took her glass and took a slow sip of her still-chilled champagne.

"Did you have fun?" I asked.

My voice was tight. Jealous. Snippy.

She took another sip before answering.

"Would it be better if I hadn't?"

I thought about it.

"No," I replied resignedly.

Fuck me, but I didn't want that. I wanted her to enjoy it. Fuck me.

She read my turmoil. She put her hand on my arm reassuringly, but then smiled at me teasingly.

“Well, good. Because I did.”

“Good,” I grumbled.

She giggled. “You don’t seem convinced. Are you sure you’re happy,” she leaned in close, her voice a sultry whisper, “that he made... me... come... so... hard?”

I stared at her speechless.

She twisted the knife. “Because I did.... Soooo..... hard.”

“Terri,” I moaned.

“Bill?” she grinned. “Are you okay? You look a little... peaked.”

I threw three twenties on the bar. “Let’s go.”

Outside, I yanked at her arm. She turned toward me, still with that fucking, infuriating, sexy, confident, lewd, self-satisfied grin.

“Home or dinner?” I groaned.

“Neither,” she replied, grinning more widely.

In response to my quizzical expression, she replied, “Car.”

Wordlessly I dragged her toward the lot in which I’d parked. I unlocked the door and she released my hand and slipped into the passenger seat. I dropped heavily behind the steering wheel.

She didn’t hesitate. She dropped her head into my lap and wrestled my zipper open. I heard voices from outside. I peered through the rearview mirror to see a group of people walking behind our car, talking, laughing, on their way to dinner themselves. She swallowed my cock whole. I let out a loud, gasping moan. She slurped me wetly.

“You like that?” she asked.

“God yes.”

“So did Brian.”

I groaned as it hit me that she’d had another man’s cock in her mouth less than fifteen minutes earlier. She smiled and again lowered herself on my prick, her tongue swirling my shaft as she’d so recently teased his.

She reached around and began reclining my seat. Oh God, was she really thinking of doing it right here? I couldn’t see in the rearview mirror, but out the side mirror I saw a car driving behind us. Still, I knew in her mood she wouldn’t be gainsaid, and anyway, I knew I wanted her too.

As my seat reached its limit, she threw herself over me, her lithe body writhing on me. She kissed me hard. I could taste saltiness on her tongue. Mine? Or his? It didn't matter. Her hand was between us, stroking my cock, and then suddenly I was inside her hot, tight snatch.

"Oh God, you're so wet," I moaned.

"Hmmm," she replied, pumping her hips. "I thought he'd left a big load in there."

She rose up slightly so I could see her face, and more importantly so she could see mine. I could see her scanning me for signs of disapproval or anger. What I think she saw was shock, and lust. Lots of lust.

"Really?"

She leaned forward again and began grinding against me. Her face was buried in the crook of my neck. I could feel her hot breath. Her whispered teases.

"I was going to swallow it. But it felt too good. So hard. And so big...."

"Big?"

"Uh huh, baby. Biggest I've ever had. I couldn't resist. I had to let him come inside me."

"You're such a slut, Terri."

"Mmm-hmm, I am. And you love it."

She wasn't taunting me maliciously. I could hear the smile in her voice. And anyway, she was right, so right. I squeezed her hard ass, thrust upward into her soaking wet pussy, gushing from both her excitement and another man's come. I could feel her large breasts squished against my chest. I longed to play with them, to suck her prominent nipples into my mouth, but we were too tightly packed into the driver's seat. I wondered....

"Did he play with your tits?"

"No, baby, we didn't have the time. After I sucked him hard, he just sat me up on a stack of boxes, spread my legs, and shoved his big, fat cock inside me."

"And you liked that? No foreplay, nothing."

"Foreplay was letting him pick me up right in front of you. By the time we got back there, I was dripping wet and ready for anything."

Ready for anything. Just like with Chucky. Like flipping a switch and this other side of my sweet wife would come out. I knew it was more complicated than that, that she was saying what she knew I wanted to hear

as well, but it didn't matter. All of it. Her lewdness, her words, her gasping breaths against my neck, but most of all the sensation of her hot, sloppy pussy bouncing on my cock.

"Oh God, I'm close," I warned.

"Good. I want another load of come inside me."

Bam. That was it. I exploded, gasping and grunting. She continued grinding against me, harder, knowing she was now on the clock. I could feel myself begin to soften, but with a gasp, I felt her pussy clenching against my slimy prick.

She laughed softly. "We're a mess, you know that?"

I knew she meant more than the fluids dripping onto my car seat. But she was wrong. We were just right.

"What now?" I asked.

"Dinner, of course," she replied. "Fucking two men has made me hungry." She paused to let that sink in. "Can we still make our reservation?"

I looked at my watch. I'd missed the end of the match. She'd fucked another man. But yes, we still had time to make our reservation.

You want to know what is weird? Weird is having dinner with your wife in a swanky restaurant knowing that her pussy is leaking another man's come. That is weird. And disturbing. Somehow, knowing my own was mixed in there was not a great source of satisfaction.

She giggled at my sour expression. "You don't look like a man who just had sex."

"No," I grumbled, "I'm a man whose wife has just made love to another man."

"Oh Bill, that is so not true," she cooed. "There was no making love." She paused and milked it, which was surprisingly effective even though I knew what was coming. "We just fucked."

I groaned despite myself. She grinned.

"Yeah, I'm a sucker," I admitted.

"No, I'm the sucker." I imagined her red lips around a fat cock.

"Terri..."

She laughed. "Too much?"

"Just a little."

She took a sip of her wine.

I thought about Brian's fat prick. "There was nothing little about it," I said suddenly.

She almost choked on her Chardonnay, and then chuckled at me.

"Feeding me lines, now?"

Puns swirled in my head. *You've been fed plenty already. Well, we know you're good at swallowing things.*

She seemed to read my mind and grinned at me.

"This is crazy," I said.

She shrugged. "Just having a little fun, aren't we?"

"Why do I enjoy it?" I asked.

"Why do you think?"

"You're not allowed to answer a question with a question. That's the rule."

"I like to break the rules," she noted.

Our waiter came over. He was a tall and slender, dark-haired and handsome, dark scruff on his face as befitting a waiter at a place aiming for trendy over conventional.

"Good evening. May I tell you our specials?"

"You can tell me anything," my wife cooed.

He shifted uncomfortably. I felt my cock twitch in my pants. *Jesus, was she going to go for three cocks in one night?* She winked at me.

"Erm..." he struggled with his composure, and finally stammered through his spiel before hurriedly retreating.

"Great," I commented. "Now we'll be lucky to get him to come back to take our order."

"If they scare away that easily then they aren't going to be any good in bed anyway."

"How did you get so, ah, experienced in all of this?"

"I thought we were talking about you," she noted.

"We were, but you're more interesting. So, seriously, what --"

"I wasn't a virgin when we met."

My cock twitched as I thought about her and Chucky. I'd heard a lot of stories about him. How he'd picked her up in a nightclub and scored with her in the bathroom. Their passionate relationship. The night he'd shared her with Jason, a light-skinned, black man who'd been her *biggest* until apparently just now. And I'd actually instigated their recent reunion, which

had proceeded through various encounters, and even had a threesome with the two of them that was equally scaldingly hot and scaldingly dangerous. So I knew all about Chucky.

And I knew about her other men. We'd had that talk, though oddly it took her revelations about Chucky to bring it on. But that had been a list. It was enough at the time, but as I looked back on it, I realized it had been unsatisfying. A lot of half-truths on my side, and I suspected as many on hers. So, I knew she wasn't a virgin when we met. I knew she'd been with precisely seven men before me, and with our recent adventures, two more men since. But I suspected there was more to her story.

"I know *that*," I replied. "But I still don't understand things."

She shrugged. "What is there to understand?"

"I don't know Terri. It's not something I ever realized before, but something I'm finally seeing now."

"Uh oh, that doesn't sound good."

"No. It's just. I don't think I've ever really gotten it. You've told me your stories. I know about Chucky. And Alex," the nineteen year-old wannabe rocker who'd taken her virginity, "and Gary," the older married man she'd first screwed on his desk, or was it her desk, in the office, "but..."

"But what?"

I hesitated, trying to put the sensation I was feeling into words. "But, I think I've been in denial. I've been thinking of the rawness, the thrill seeking, the... whatever.... I've been thinking of it as, you know, something that just, sometimes, comes out like a... like a..."

"Like a split personality?" she prompted. "That sounds about right, I guess."

I thought of the white... grey... lies she'd told me about Chucky and how they'd almost caused a crisis between us. I thought of that, but also of more.

"But that's not what I think anymore," I said.

"Oh? And why is that? You think I've been hiding away a secret life? I'm an escort on the side, maybe?"

I groaned. God, that was a disturbingly sexy thought.

She grinned.

"That would be pretty hot, don't you think?" she continued. "Would you like me to sit at the bar and see if a man offers me money for —"

“Terri, no, don’t,” I interrupted before adding, “not yet.”

I knew how easily she could derail me. How quickly she could spin a story of sex-for-hire that would have me desperate to hear more, to drag her from the restaurant and fuck her. And I knew I’d want her to do just that. Later, though. Not until we’d had this conversation.

“You sure, because –“

“Terri,” I said simply.

She stopped and nodded, like she knew her power over me, but was willing to refrain from using it... *for now*. That too was part of the puzzle. She looked at me expectantly.

“Terri,” I began again, “how’d you get so good at this?”

“At what?”

“Wrapping me around your little finger.”

“Is that how you see me?”

I laughed. “I admit, you don’t abuse your powers, but you do have them.”

“My *powers*, eh? I don’t think I’ve ever been compared to a superhero before.”

I shrugged.

She regarded me pensively. “Okay, Bill, I’ll play. We *have* been together a long time. And especially recently, you’ve given me plenty of ammunition.”

“It’s not just me,” I replied. “I see the effect you have on other men.”

“They’re called boobs, Bill. No superpowers involved. Just lumps of flesh.”

“No, it’s more than that.”

“We’ve had this conversation before as well,” she noted. “Men are easy, and almost conditioned by society to value *this*.” She gestured at herself with both hands. “Have you seen Fox News?”

“No,” I persisted. “It’s not just the blond hair.”

“Bill –“

I interrupted her. “It’s the way you flick the hair away from your face. The way you tap your red fingernails against a wine glass. The way you tilt your head and make a sly comment while peering through your eyelashes. The way you run the tip of your tongue over teeth, letting it just peek out between your lips. I could go on.”

“Are you calling me a flirt?”

“You are.”

“Sometimes,” she admitted.

“More than sometimes. I just realized it.”

“Bill, what are you saying?” she replied a little hotly.

Happily, the waiter returned to halt the escalation. We ordered. And I noticed Terri’s deliberate gravity. She had to work at not being a flirt. When he left, she looked up at me again, still angry.

“They say men think about sex every seven seconds on average,” I noted.

“Sounds about right,” she replied tersely, but I could see a glimmer of amusement returning to her eyes.

“It isn’t,” I replied. “Not literally so, of course. But it works as apocrypha.”

“Do you have a point beyond trying to impress me with your knowledge of obscure nouns?”

“Is it working?”

“Oddly enough, Brian didn’t need to use any Latin on me,” she replied.

“I bet he’d have liked to use Greek.”

She shook her head and chuckled. “Ouch. Too big.”

I smiled at her, pleased that the moment of tension had passed.

“So?” she prompted.

“I think you’re a much more sexual person than I ever realized.”

“I like sex.”

“It’s not something that just comes out periodically. It’s more... organic.”

She hesitated. Then came a look of scandalized realization. “Bill, I swear, I’ve never cheated –“

I put up my hand to stop her. “I’m not accusing you of that.”

“You sure? Because that’s where it feels like this is going.”

“But, I think you’ve thought about it.”

Another paused. “I’ve never...”

“I know. Cheated. But I think you think about other men.”

“Bill...”

“It’s okay. I fantasize about other women.”

“You bastard!” she teased.

“So, I’m right?”

“I’m still not sure what you’re asking.”

“I think you think about other men. Often. It’s not just a blue moon kind of situation. And it’s not just because it turns me on.”

“What do you want me to say?”

“I just want you to help me see the world through your eyes.”

“I... I like men. I like sex. I like the way it makes me feel when I can see a man wants me. And if I find a man attractive, I guess I do sometimes like to see if I can get a rise out of him. I’ve never really thought of it that way, but is that wrong?”

I shook my head. “I didn’t say it was wrong. I just want to understand you better.” I paused. I knew what I wanted to ask, but even still, it was weird saying it. I decided to plow ahead. “And what happens when you get that rise?”

She looked at me quizzically.

“Does it turn you on?”

She giggled. “Do I get aroused?”

“Well, do you?”

“Sometimes. I guess.”

“Sometimes?”

She blushed. She actually blushed. Less than an hour earlier she’d seduced another man right in front of me. But she was embarrassed by this discussion. She took a sip of wine. Buying time, obviously, and thinking. She seemed to make a decision.

“Okay Bill. I guess the answer is yes. Yes. I often see men who turn me on. I imagine having sex with them. What they’d do to me, and what I’d do to them. And when I see that they’re interested too, that it would just be a matter of letting go, letting things happen, then yes, it does turn me on. And I do get aroused.”

“Tell me more.”

“Like what?” She tilted her head slightly and peered through her eyelashes. “Like the way it makes my skin so tingly and sensitive that I almost want to tear my clothes off? The way my nipples get hard and rub against the fabric of my bra? The way I can feel my panties moisten? Like that?”

I had to adjust my erection to keep it from being too conspicuous. My mouth was suddenly dry, and my concentration shot.

“Um, something like that,” I choked out.

“What else do you need to know?” she asked.

“Did you feel that way with Brian?”

“You know I did.”

“Would you even if I hadn’t been there?”

She blushed again. “Yes. I wouldn’t have done anything with him if you hadn’t been there to enjoy it. But yes, I probably would have flirted with him, and if he’d flirted back –“

“Which he would have....”

She nodded in agreement. “Then, yes, I’d have probably let my mind wander. Let myself imagine being with him. Enjoyed the guilty thrill my excitement provided.”

It was only what I had expected. Yet it sent me reeling. My wife wasn’t a werewolf, rendered mad only in rare circumstances. There weren’t two sides of Terri. There was just Terri, and beneath the surface, just barely constrained was a churning volcano of passion.

I was speaking now without even thinking. The words just emerging from my mouth as if by an irresistible compulsion.

“What if I didn’t have to be there to enjoy it? What if it was only about you?”

“But it isn’t,” she noted simply.

“It could be.”

She took another sip of wine. More buying time.

“You should be careful what you wish for, Bill.”

“I’m not wishing for anything in particular.”

She gave me a small smirk. “Next time, we should talk about you instead, then. But let’s leave that for another time. Time to think. Time to reconsider.”

“I don’t need that,” I assured her with a bravado that I didn’t really feel.

“I do,” she said firmly.

The waiter arrived with our orders, putting a period to the end of our discussion.

CHAPTER THREE

We didn't get around to fantasizing the escort scenario. In fact, we barely had a real conversation over our meal. Instead, we spoke in the way long-time couples do. Work, news and kids. Sharing information, coordinating schedules.

The car ride home was virtually silent. We paid the babysitter and checked on the sleeping kids. We made our way to the bedroom and began to undress.

"Should I get cleaned up?" Terri asked.

"No."

She finished removing her clothes and dropped onto the bed. Her legs were slightly apart and I caught a glimpse of her shaved pussy, swollen and glistening. As I joined her on the bed naked, she turned out the lights.

I moved on top of her, and she lifted her legs high into the air in a V. I entered her easily. Heat and wetness and very little friction. Was it excitement? Or was she still dripping with the combined come of two men? It didn't matter. It felt amazing. Slutty. Raw.

We didn't speak and barely kissed. The sex was oddly distant. Me relishing a wet hole. She enjoying a thrusting cock. Oddly distant because despite the lack of communication, I knew we were thinking about exactly the same thing: all the men who'd turned her on over the years of our marriage. About how different everything would be if she took me up on my impetuous offer.

I knew that through her mind were spinning faces and bodies, names and situations. The myriad situations and sex acts she'd fantasized about.

For me, it was more indistinct. From her work as a health care advisor, I knew her surroundings. Hospitals and doctor's offices, conferences, client meetings, and lunches with contacts and referrals. So I had impressions of the men who she probably met on a daily basis. The muscular bad-boys: hospital orderlies, personal trainers, waiters, and repairmen. The distinguished gentlemen: doctors, financial planners, and clients.

She moaned softly, getting closer. Her eyes were shut tight in concentration. She was far, far away, with another man. I thrust in harder.

She gasped. And then her pussy clenched my cock again and again. Another hard thrust and I was done as well, coming inside her, knowing that in her mind, this was the third different man to complete the act with her in a single day.

There is nothing wrong with white lies. Heck, I doubt any relationship can survive without them.

Do these jeans make me look fat? Mind if I have another beer? Are you upset I forgot to do the laundry?

We use them even more in our sex lives.

Did you come? Are you attracted to my sister? Does size matter? How many one-night stands have you had?

Anyone who thinks they've gotten the straight answer to any of those questions is hopelessly naïve.

I'd told my share of white lies. When the situation with Chucky had begun, Terri and I had finally had *the talk* about our sexual past. I felt that since we seemed to be moving in the direction of a new chapter in our lives, it probably made sense to be clear on the prologue.

I told her about my first. April. That she and I had dated the summer before college, and never quite got around to having sex. That we were both virgins and she wasn't ready. And that with college right around the corner, I wasn't desperate. That I'd finally managed to get some pity sex off her around Thanksgiving.

I'd told Terri all of this, and even mentioned that April had lost her own virginity at college before taking mine later in the semester.

So, Terri had the outlines. Had I lied about anything outright? No. But it wasn't the whole story, of course.

I hadn't been that into April over the summer. She was a pale skinned ginger. She wore glasses. She had this really thick hair that turned into a rat's nest at the slightest hint of humidity. She had this annoying laugh. I was almost embarrassed to be seen with her.

All of that, in retrospect, was crazy. She had a very pretty face, and big green eyes. And her body, which at the time didn't seem skinny enough or something, was actually gorgeous. But the truth is, I felt she was beneath me, which probably explains why I never got her into bed.

It didn't help that I was selfish. She'd come over one night, and we were watching TV and making out, and listening for my parents who didn't seem particularly inclined to give us any privacy. Even still, I'd managed to get my hand into her pants, and then her panties. I remember feeling my way through her full bush, touching her wetness for the first time. I pressed a finger inside her, too hard, and she tensed, but she didn't push me away. I didn't recalibrate. I thrust inside her a couple more times, thinking about how nice it would feel to have my dick in there, and not once thinking about how to make it feel nice for her. My dad rumbled down the basement steps, and I quickly withdrew my hand. She buttoned her jeans back up.

That was the closest we'd come to sex.

But I didn't care. College was in a couple of weeks.

Of course, I was quickly taught the lesson that most freshman boys eventually learn. When you get to school, you're low man on the totem pole. Freshman girls want older guys, and the older guys are eager to get their hands on the fresh meat. At least that is how it felt to me at the time, which I recognize now was part of the problem. It's not so much that freshman girls want older guys. They're just turned off by that stench of desperate, predatory, misogyny freshman boys give off. Not that older guys are much better, but they do hide it more effectively.

I'd barely thought of April the first week. Pinged her once the second. But by the third, I was emailing her a couple of times a day.

She'd put me into the "friend zone," although I was in denial about it. Again, that is clear more in retrospect. At the time, I didn't see that there was a plan in the way she brought up the other boys she'd met or hung out with. I didn't cotton to the fact that it probably wasn't a good sign for my romantic prospects that she was asking my advice about other guys. I thought she might actually just be trying to make me jealous.

Then, in late September, after a weekend during which I'd heard nothing from her, she broke the news.

Billy, remember that guy I told you about? Well, we hooked up this weekend. Hope you're having fun too. April.

Or something like that. Brief. Terse even. I parsed every word. Which guy? There'd been several. But I *knew*. She'd mentioned him most recently. Danny. He was a *junior*. A *business major*. He had a *car*. He was, in short, to my mind, an asshole.

Hooked up seemed ambiguous. Did she mean they'd just made out?
No. Fuck.

Having fun too. Too. That meant she'd enjoyed it. It had been *fun*.

I felt sick to my stomach. Some asshole was fucking *my girl*.

Angry too. I fired off a reply.

You whore.

I regretted it almost right away. Some manipulative instinct kicked in and it occurred to me. *Well, now that she's not a virgin...*

I wrote again.

J/k. Good for you!! I'm getting close to this girl here too. Guess it's time for me to make my move. Any tips?

She didn't reply. *Fucking whore.* Maybe she was too busy fucking Danny to check her email. *Stupid, slutty, whore.*

I'd seen enough porn. I understood the mechanics. I wondered, had she sucked his cock? How had he fucked her? Doggy-style, with her big tits flopping back and forth. Did he come on her back? On her face?

I remembered the tight, hot, slick wetness of her pussy. The feel of her tits as I mashed them. *My girl. My fucking girl, and some other guy was fucking her.*

I couldn't get them out of my mind. My roommate had gone out a while earlier, but he might be back at any moment.

With one eye on the door, I thought of April. Slutty, stupid, fucking April getting rammed by some stupid, smug, preppy bastard. Mauling her tits. Coming all over her ass. I reached into my jeans. Just the touch of my fingertip was enough to set me off. I filled my pants with come, and immediately felt the burning combination of shame and disgust. What the fuck was wrong with me?

But no sooner had I changed than I was thinking of them again. I checked my email obsessively. Nothing. I was angry and yet relieved. I couldn't get her out of my mind. A few weeks earlier, I was just as happy to be moving on. I'd recently been having second thoughts, but even then, I was thinking of her as a fallback. Maybe at Thanksgiving, if we were back home, and I didn't have anything, or anyone, better to do.... Now, suddenly, I couldn't stop thinking of her. She was fucking another guy. Actually, no shit, *fucking him*. I was disgusted. *Dumb slut spreading her legs for some guy she just met.* And so, so aroused. The worst, and weirdest part, was that I wasn't just suddenly appreciating her and lusting after her. What was

making me nuts was less the idea of fucking her myself than the fact that she was banging another guy.

Every night, in bed, as quietly as possible, just separated from my roommate by a few meters, I played with my cock. It was hard, again, aching and raw from all the attention I'd been paying to it almost nonstop since her revelation. I'd tried to distract myself from it by watching porn and thinking of other girls. But April kept forcing herself into my fantasies. And not just April, but April *and* Danny.

I imagined him using her in the most abject and degrading ways. Face fucking her and coming down her throat. Fucking her plump titties and coming all over her face. Taking her up the ass and then making her go ass-to-mouth. I imagined him passing her around to his friends, bending her over and letting his buddies pull a train on her. Through it all, I pictured her taking it happily, eagerly, except in those cases where my dark thoughts required her to be whining or crying in pain when he forced her to service the pizza guy or traded her ass for a bag of weed.

At the same time that I was rubbing the skin off my cock, I was also emailing her, often one-handed. Apologies. Jokes. Movie recommendations. Idle gossip. Until finally she let me back into her life.

I'm really sorry I got weird there for a while. Midterms had me stressed.

She was skeptical, but finally relented.

It's okay. I'm sorry I dropped that on you.

And then I really went to work. I was *happy* to be friend-zoned. I just wanted someone to *talk* to.

And hey, there's this cool band playing up in Springfield that I'm going to see with some friends, so maybe I could just stop by to say hi.

She responded she was pretty busy. I didn't let her off the hook. I didn't even acknowledge her attempted blow-off. I powered ahead.

Yeah, yeah, I hear you. But we'll just grab a quick coffee. Doesn't make sense not to say hi if I'm in town.

So I drove up. She'd agreed to meet midmorning, at the campus center. She had classes later that day.

"So where are your friends?" she asked.

“Oh, they just wanted to walk around the campus.”

I gave her an awkward hug. Like we were adults or something. I tried to look for evidence in her appearance of her changed status, of the wanton woman I knew now inhabited her body. There was nothing there. Nothing I could see.

After a few minutes of idle chit-chat, she tried to leave. I wouldn't let her.

“Oh come on, I drove up to see you, and you can't give me a few minutes?”

She was too nice to call me on my changing story. She sat back down with a sigh.

“So, tell me more about this *Danny*,” I asked in my best *innocent friend* tone.

“He... um... he's a really nice guy....”

Something about how they'd met at some organizational meeting for the campus sustainable agriculture initiative. Other stuff. Blah blah.

I can't remember any of it because even as she was talking, I was picturing him using all of her wet, dirty holes. When my distraction caused the conversation to flag, she tried again to extricate herself.

Now I tried sad.

“Yeah, I'm having trouble getting used to things, you know.”

She resented the sympathy play, but let it hook her anyway. She consoled me and tried to give me cheery advice.

“You're a great guy. Just be yourself.”

More bumper stickers and new-age, feel-good bullshit. But even as she was saying *all the right things*, I was wondering if even now she could taste his come on her lips, feel it dripping from her surely sore and stretched asshole.

She was letting her sentences drift off, inviting me to release her from my company. I bit down harder.

I'd now kept her through lunch.

“So, Billy, this was great. But, like I told you before, I have class this afternoon, and....”

“When?”

She wasn't quick enough to lie. “Two-thirty...” she saw the opening she'd given me and immediately tried to walk it back. “But, I need to get my books and finish an assignment.”

“Cool,” I replied. “I’ll walk you to your dorm.”

“No, you don’t have to.”

“I want to. Anyway, I want to check out your housing. I’m thinking of transferring here, and....”

I didn’t even finish my transparent line of bullshit. Her shoulders had slumped and I knew she was resigned to putting up with me until her class.

She tried to ditch me at the front door. I told her I needed to use the bathroom. She was on her phone when I got out, but instead of excusing myself as she expected, I remained, awkwardly looking at her until she hung up.

She was exasperated. I pretended not to notice.

“I’ve missed you.”

She sighed. “I have a boyfriend, and –“

“I feel like you owe me.”

“What?”

She seemed genuinely shocked.

“I mean, I was saving myself for you,” I said.

No matter that this line didn’t match up with my previous play for sympathy.

I added accusingly, “And then you went ahead and, like, cheated on me.”

“We’re... we’re not even, like, a couple.”

“I thought we were.”

“I’m sorry,” she replied.

“Look,” I said as I reached out and grabbed her hand. She tried to pull away, but not very hard, and anyway, I wasn’t letting go. “You should at least, you know, make this right.”

“What?” Perplexed now.

“I mean, what’s the big deal. You barely know this guy, and you’re not even a virgin anymore.”

“Billy, what are you saying? You want to...?”

She trailed off, too shocked to even say it. I kissed her. It was awkward. She didn’t kiss back. And didn’t really pull away.

“It’s the least you can do,” I argued. “It’ll be fun. And you invited me back to your room.”

“Billy –“

I cut her off with a kiss. Her shoulders slumped. My dick felt like it was going to burst. I kissed her again and grabbed for her crotch. She pushed my hand away. I let her, but continued to kiss her, pressing my tongue into her mouth. I reached for her zipper again. She tried to push me away, but half-heartedly. I let myself think I'd won her over.

It was mercifully quick. We stripped. I rolled on a condom. She didn't even look at me, though in the final moment she's the one who took my prick at slid it into her pussy, though I know it was mostly to get it over with.

As I entered her, I gasped at the sensation. So hot, so tight. I thrust in awkwardly. *Whore*. I thought of her fucking Danny. *Slut*. Another half-thrust, and I was done.

I ground against her for a few more moments, until she pushed me away, forcefully this time.

"Okay, we're square," she grumbled.

"What?" I asked innocently. "I thought we were just having a little fun."

"I have to go to class," she noted morosely.

This time, I didn't object. I dressed quickly.

"That was great," I said in a chipper tone.

"You need to go," she replied.

I kissed her on the cheek. "You're the best."

I left. Drove home. And never spoke to her again.

But I did think of her. All the time for months to come. Never of the *sex* I'd had with her, but always of her and Danny, and other men, all sorts of men. I couldn't get enough of that fantasy.

So, I'd told Terri the truth. But was it the whole truth? Of course not.

I sometimes beat myself up over April. I was a shit. No doubt. I was also eighteen. And she never actually said, "no." That's a weak technicality. I was a shit. But then again, sad as it is to say, I suspect my story is far from unique.

CHAPTER FOUR

Saturday morning dawned. I woke up and felt Terri beginning to stir beside me. She looked over at me, her hair a tangled mess, and yet still so alluring. We exchanged sheepish smiles.

That was normal. The day after each one of our adventures had been about the same. No real regrets, just a little embarrassment. I was happy to see this was true again this particular morning.

After all, our evening had ended peculiarly. Every other time we'd "played" – a term that still felt odd even to think... had we become swingers? Every other time we'd "experimented," it had ended in explosive passion. We'd gotten that out of the way in the car, of course, but even still, our later coupling had been, not passionless, but different. Charged, but without Terri driving it along with recounted tales of her sordid acts.

She leaned over and kissed me softly. Her breath was a little sour, a welcome reminder that she was human after all, not a perfect, sexual goddess.

"You still love me?" she asked.

"Of course," I replied. "Jeez, why?"

"I think of other men. I have *sex* with other men."

"Only when I suggest it."

She laughed. "That makes it sound like you pass me around to your friends."

I felt myself recoil slightly. She read me perfectly.

She laughed again. "Oh God, Bill, you do have crazy fantasies, don't you?"

She reached for me and confidently gripped my rapidly growing erection.

"I... I don't fantasize about that," I croaked.

"Uh huh." She stroked me faster. "So how would that work? Would you just tell me where to go? Or have me naked here and invite Herb and Sai to take a turn?"

Herb and Sai? Had she been thinking of them sexually? Or was she just that quick?

The sound of Braden jumping out of bed put an end to our banter.

“To be continued,” Terri chimed. She gave my cock another firm squeeze and then hopped out of bed, calling after our son, “Good morning, Sweetheart.”

It took me a minute before my erection subsided enough to follow.

Braden had soccer. “Soccer” I should say. I’m not sure a pack of seven year-olds chasing after a ball counts as soccer normally. Annabelle was sitting in the grass playing with another little girl. It was a sunny spring day.

I tried to enjoy these moments. I knew that in a few years, just watching the kids play would be stressful. Over-involved parents, obsessive coaches, the lunatic competitiveness that we tend to inflict on our kids when they should just be being kids. Even now, there were a couple of dads who couldn’t resist yelling from the sidelines. *Get ahead of the ball. Get back into position. Pass it, pass it, pass it!*

It annoyed me that I knew I’d be one of those guys soon enough. Even now, it was a struggle to shut up and just let Braden chase after the ball like a mindless puppy. That’s one of the curses of being even a little self-aware, the realization that despite our best intentions, we’re at the mercy of instinct, impulse, conditioning.

I shook my head. Terri... man, did that woman know how to push my buttons. All morning I’d been thinking about her... and Herb... and Sai, which, judging by the way she kept giving me knowing grins was exactly what she wanted. Or fuck, was she smirking at me over last night instead? Or maybe it was just that she kept catching me staring at her ass, something that was impossible to resist, her cheeks looking like perfect, ripe apples in her obscenely tight yoga pants? And it wasn’t just me who had noticed. I kept catching the other dads taking a peek, at least when they weren’t bellowing at the kids to *cover your man* and *get back onside*.

Or maybe, she *was* just grinning.

“Yo, Bud, Braden playing now?”

I startled at Herb’s voice. Now things were getting really awkward.

“Whoa, you okay?” he asked.

“Yeah. What... what are you doing here?”

I looked over at Terri, who blushed and giggled with a hand over her mouth.

“Soccer. Trev’s game is next.”

I looked down at his tousle-headed son squirming impatiently beside him. I gave the kid a smile. It seemed to frighten him.

“Oh, cool. We’re almost finished.”

“What’s the score?”

I shrugged my shoulders. “Who knows?”

He laughed. “Terri here?”

I nodded in her direction. He gave her a lingering look.

Was he her type? The kind of man she imagined seducing, who by reciprocating her attention would stiffen her nipples and moisten her panties. He was my age, round faced with thinning hair, but tall and broad shouldered. Powerful.

Did my wife fantasize about having sex with him? Had she already done it? He lived in the neighborhood. We had barbecues together. He and Melody sometimes came over for dinner parties. So many opportunities to be alone with Terri. Had the two of them ever disappeared together? I imagined them slipping away, ducking into the seldom-used bathroom in the addition. Terri, bending over, hands on the sink, her lovely cleavage on display. And him behind her, lifting her dress, pulling down her panties until they stretched across her slender thighs. Her eyes closed, licking her lips....

“Daddy, kick the ball with meeee.”

“Sure thing big guy,” he replied. He clapped me on the shoulder before walking off to play with his son. “Tell Terri I said hi.”

Why did that sound like a taunt? Or was it all in my head? Of course it was. Except, it was now harder for me to remain firm on that. After Chucky and Jean-Pierre and now Brian I was a bit at sea.

The final whistle blew. As Braden gathered with his teammates for post-game snacks, Terri came over to me.

“You okay, honey? You’re as pale as a ghost.”

“I was just talking to Herb.”

“I saw.”

“So....”

“So... what?” she asked with a smirk.

“So... you and Herb?”

She just looked at me amused.

“I mean,” I continued, “you mentioned him this morning.”

“I mentioned Sai too.”

“So... is there... something going on?”

She laughed. “No. Silly. They just popped into my head. Probably because we were just talking the other day about Sai going back to India to see family, and because Melody invited us over for brunch tomorrow.”

“So you’re not attracted to them?”

“Should I be?” She batted her eyelashes at me. “Would you like me to seduce your friends?”

“No,” I rumbled. Though... did I? No. No, I didn’t.

“Good,” she replied. “They’re not really my type.”

“And what is your type?”

“You know.”

“Tell me.”

She leaned in close. “As we used to say, Baddies and Daddies.”

Used to say? And who was *we*?

But before I could ask for clarification, she had turned and joined the other parents clustered around the soccer players.

CHAPTER FIVE

Since we'd been out the night before, we had dinner with the kids. Terri made Frenched lamb chops and decorated the ends with silly, frilly paper tips.

"Lollipops!" Braden cried out enthusiastically when he saw them.

Seared potatoes and a salad completed the meal. Kids had milk. We had a glass of wine, a rich Cab that seemed almost decadent.

Braden and Annabelle competed for attention, getting louder and louder in the process, talking over each other. I took a deep swig of wine and let Terri arbitrate.

As much as I enjoyed family time, I was looking forward, even more, to adult time after. The encounter with Brian had kicked up all sorts of issues, which were now beginning to stack up. We need to clear the deck.

That said, I was under no illusion that we'd actually do that. I was beginning to see through Terri's ploys. The thing with Herb and Sai was a tip-off. She liked to deflect my questions with sex talk. I wondered what she was hiding.

After we'd both read to the kids and Terri had given them lights-out, I was waiting for her downstairs with a glass of red wine. I cracked open a second bottle just in case.

"Trying to get me drunk?" She asked. "You don't need to do that. You know I'm easy."

Bingo!

"Terri, ever notice how you sometimes use sex to avoid talking about issues?"

She gave me a small pout. "You see right through me. That's why I love you. Most men would be all too happy to just drag me off to bed and ravage me."

I shifted uneasily as I felt my cock stiffen. She grinned.

"I'm serious," I said.

She sat down beside me, curled up gracefully, catlike, a leg folded beneath her. She flicked a loose strand of hair from her face.

"Too serious," she noted. "This is supposed to be fun."

"For who?"

“You’re not having fun with this anymore?” she asked.

“I’m not sure what *this* is.”

“*This* is the fact that it turns you on to think of me with other men, and that if we want to keep that alive, we periodically need to throw another log on the fire.”

I hesitated, thinking about her words. *It turns you on....*

She continued. “Now, that is metaphorically speaking, of course. By log, I mean dick. And by fire, I mean my pussy. Or did I misread the vibe at the bar the other night?” She paused as if suddenly concerned. “Are you upset about what happened with Brian?”

But she’d read me right.

“No.” I replied.

“Good!” She took a sip of wine and grinned. “So, did I mention that he was so big that I could only get the tip of it in my mouth and barely get my hands around it?”

I groaned as I pictured it. My lovely, blond wife on her knees, her painted lips stretched around a fat cock, both hands encircling and pumping his thick shaft. I was rock hard now, my prick poking at the fabric of my khakis.

“Should I demonstrate?” she continued, her voice husky. “Would you like to see how I sucked Brian’s hard cock?”

She began to lean forward. God, it was so tempting to let her go ahead. I could see it in her smile that she was just starting in on me. She had a whole evening’s worth of details to convey, mixed in with opportunities to sample her physical charms. Why was I overthinking it? Why not let go? Let her pull me into her fantasy world. Enjoy, a night of wild passion with a beautiful, master storyteller. Closer, closer, she approached.

“Terri, wait....”

She stopped and looked up at me. She was a little disappointed, perhaps, but I could see she was also amused. I was going to be more of a challenge than usual.

“Okay, Bill.... What do you want to do?”

“Talk.”

She bit back the temptation to call me a wuss, but I could see it in her eyes. *Chucky wouldn’t have wanted to talk. Neither would Brian.*

“Okay,” she replied.

I sighed. I wasn't even sure what I was looking for in a conversation. It just felt as if there were something out there. Just a matter of reaching out and grasping it. But I didn't know what it was. I wasn't sure what I wanted out of our game. Just good sex for me? Fun? Maybe, but not quite. It felt as if Terri must surely know it, whatever *it* was. She was so confident, so possessed of some private knowledge that it almost seemed as if she were deliberately holding out on me.

She waited patiently as my mind churned.

The thought finally crystallized. "You keep making this seem as if it is about me," I said.

She shrugged. "No. It is definitely about *us*," she replied. "Or perhaps what *you* think of *us*."

"But not about *you*?"

"Me?"

I laughed. "Is there another *you* here?"

"I don't know. It feels like you're talking in riddles."

I sighed again.

She nodded, getting it. "Bill, this isn't really about me. You heard something about my past, and... and it got under your skin. I'm not quite sure why, but it did. So, I was a little crazy when I was young. Big deal. But you can't let go of it because you don't want to let go of it."

"You could?"

"I did."

"Except once you got back with Chucky –"

"Things got a little crazy," she admitted. "I'm sorry about that. I did warn you, though. But okay, that's on me too."

"Things got crazy because it filled a hole."

She gave me a saucy smirk that ineluctably made me recall the sight of his cock sliding into her eager, wet twat.

"I don't mean it like that," I protested.

She chuckled. "Okay, so what did you mean?"

"That you are doing this because you want it too. Not just because of how it affects me."

"Do I get a say?" she asked. She waited until I nodded in the affirmative before continuing. "I think you're engaging in projection... or maybe I mean transference? My Intro to Psych is rusty."

I shrugged.

“What I mean,” she said, “is that you want this to mean more than it does to me because it means more to you than you want to admit.”

“Or maybe you’re in denial,” I proposed.

But even as I was saying it, I knew I wasn’t being completely honest. There were still white lies, grey lies between us, and not just about April. Maybe she was right. Maybe it was just me... except, how could that be?

Terri wanted me to believe that the sex was meaningless. Pleasurable, but meaningless. That she could either take it or leave it. But I didn’t believe that. I may not know a lot about women, but one thing I do know is that for women, sex isn’t just sex. If it hadn’t been more than that, she wouldn’t have allowed things to go beyond just the fantasy, even if that meant that over time the excitement of it faded.

I was willing to accept that Jean-Pierre and Brian hadn’t meant as much to her as Chucky. In fact, I was sure of it. But that still left a lot of room for meaning.

“Well, honey, I think we’re going around in circles. Maybe I am in denial,” she admitted. “Arguing against that is sort of like trying to prove a negative.”

I took her hand. “Just humor me for a minute, will you?”

She laughed. “I was hoping to do a lot more than that.”

“Okay, so this is a small ask. I... I want to talk some more about what it’s like for you when you flirt with other men.”

She grinned. “Should we start at the beginning? Or pick up at the point where my nipples are hard and my pussy wet?”

My cock twitched. “That works for me.”

“Well, with Brian, that’s when I started really thinking about it. I mean, it has been almost a year since Jean-Pierre, and I figured –“

“Let’s come back to Brian, okay?”

She sighed, exasperated.

“We’ll come back to that, I promise. I really do want to hear all about it.”

And I did. That wasn’t a lie. I can’t explain it, but I wanted to hear about every last detail. About how good he felt, and how hard he made her come. What he’d said to her, and said about me. But not yet.

“Just, think about a different man,” I proposed. “You’ve flirted with a few over the past year, right?”

“A few,” she replied coquettishly.

“And at least a few have responded to you.” She nodded. “So, think of one of those.”

“Okay... done. So, you want me to tell you about him?”

I hadn’t really been thinking we’d talk about a specific situation. But then again, why not?

“Um, sure.”

“Okay. So, his name is Mike Coates. He’s an insurance guy. He came by to talk to us about this hybrid long-term health care insurance that also served as an investment instrument. Think whole life meets long-term care.”

“Got it. Young guy?”

“Actually no. Silver fox. Probably mid-50s. Really, really put-together. You know, custom tailored grey suit, soft blue shirt the exact color of his eyes. Shoes gleaming. One of those fancy watches.”

“Rolex?” I suggested.

“Maybe? I don’t know. Classier than one of those big gaudy things you see at clubs.” She continued. “Deep, confident voice. Gleam in his eye. Funny. Believe me, I wasn’t the only one with damp panties.”

“But you’re the one he flirted with.” I’d meant it as a question, but it came out as a statement, and Terri didn’t contradict me.

“Not openly, no. But yeah, he handed me the first brochure he gave out, and then when he wanted to provide an example, he asked me if I had any clients I thought this might be appropriate for. He lingered on the handshake. He wrote his cell on the back of his card and made sure I knew I could call him *anytime* if I had any questions. But it was a business meeting and he was looking to move product, so you know, it wasn’t too obvious, I guess.”

“Do you still have it?”

She gave me a puzzled expression.

“The card,” I clarified.

She blushed. “Maybe?”

Which meant definitely. And not only that, she probably knew exactly where it was.

“So, did you call him? For, you know, *clarifications*?”

“No!”

“What did you do?”

She shrugged. "Went back to my office. Let my mind wander a bit. Before we moved to glass walls, I might have played with myself a little. But I was a good girl."

"And that's it?"

"Well, Bill, as a matter of fact, it wasn't. As I recall, that night I screwed your brains out. You might remember it. I'm pretty sure it was the night I told you about my balcony time with Jean-Pierre."

That was an evening I'd never forget. Terri had been on fire. She'd made me come before she even really got into the story, and then made me climax as a second when she did.

Baise-moi, papa! Fuck me, daddy!

The memory of the story really got my blood pumping. I shook my head to clear it.

"Okay.... That was fun," I admitted.

"See? That's all this is about."

"Hold on. So, that night it worked out. You got riled up. I was there and available. But what happens when I'm not? Or when I'm in not in the mood?"

She blushed and hesitated. I knew I'd hit on something. Even with all our craziness, we were still an old married couple. Weeknight sex was pretty rare, and most of her flirting encounters were surely during business hours.

"Do you really want to know?"

I nodded.

"Okay. Come with me."

She took my hand and pulled me toward the stairs. I resisted. It felt like I was onto something, and I didn't want her to get out of an honest discussion by dragging me to bed.

"Come on, honey. I won't bite."

She gave me the sort of smile that let me know that, actually, she'd be more than happy to bite if she thought it'd get a rise out of me.

We walked cautiously up the stairs; we were each still holding a glass of wine. She dragged me down the hallway, past the bedrooms where our kids lay sleeping, past all the pictures of us as a family that adorned the walls. Terri and kids hiking in the woods. Terri brushing Annabelle's long, blond hair. Me lying in the grass with the kids on my back. Terri and I holding hands in front of a perfect sunset on our honeymoon. All so normal.

All so far away from Terri fucking a hot bartender in a storeroom. Or Terri naked on a Paris balcony getting hammered from behind.

In the bedroom, Terri patted the bed to make me sit down. She put down her own wine glass and went to the lingerie drawer of her dresser. I groaned. I wanted to talk, but I knew that the moment she pulled out one of those little wisps of fabric and began spinning a tale, I'd be lost. But instead of a distraction, I got another surprise.

She turned, and in her hand she held two items. One was a long, thick, dark dildo. The other looked like a small egg. I nodded toward the second.

"What's that?"

She gave it a quick twist, and it emitted a high-pitched buzz.

"Sex toys?"

"Can't get anything past you," she teased.

I guess I shouldn't have been surprised, but I was. We'd never incorporated that into our sex lives. I chuckled to myself. She and I had shared a scene where'd she'd sat in my lap, impaled on my cock, while her ex-boyfriend reamed her ass from behind, but I'd never used a vibrator on her.

"I didn't know you used those."

"Are you scandalized?"

I laughed. "It sounds like the least scandalous thing you do. I'm just surprised. You've never told me about it."

"I guess I've always been a little protective of my shameful habit," she joked. "I've had *friends* since I was a teen."

I was suddenly embarrassed. "I'm sorry, honey. I didn't mean to pry."

"It's okay." She grinned shyly. "So, would you like to watch?"

I eyed the huge phallus. "Um, sure."

She laughed. "You don't sound so sure."

"I'm trying to play it cool."

"That would be easier if you weren't pitching a tent."

I looked and sure enough, I was on display. When I looked up, I saw Terri had placed the toys on the bed, and was pulling her sweater over her head. Her full breasts bounced delightfully in her casual, striped bra.

"That's not helping," I noted.

"How about this, then?" she asked as she deftly slipped off her bra.

At some level, I'm still a thirteen-year-old boy inside. My eyes went right to her tits, fixated on her dark red nipples, her pale pink areolas, and slight sag of her perfect teardrop boobs. Like a moth to a flame, I moved toward her.

She draped an arm across her chest and wagged her finger at me. "Nuh, uh, mister. This is about me showing you that I don't need a man. Now go lock the door."

I rose and, half bent-over to contain my erection, went over to the door. She giggled. I locked it and turned to see her flop back onto the bed and yank off her jeans and panties. She scooted back up the bed and with an impressive, casual confidence spread her legs apart, giving me a view of her delectable, shaved pussy. Again, I couldn't help myself. I just stared at her raised mound, just a hint of glistening pink visible.

"Uh, what do I do?"

"Come closer," she suggested. "And take off your shirt. It'll make me feel less like I'm working at a peep show."

I eased myself onto the end of the bed and stripped off my top as ordered.

"Have you ever done this before? I mean, for another man?"

She chuckled.

"What?" I asked.

"You're a funny man, Bill. You have a naked woman in front of you with sex toys, and you want to know about other men."

I felt my cheeks burn in shame. "It's just... It's just..."

She softened. "It's just that you're wired that way. At some point we're going to need to look under the hood, don't you think?"

"I don't know," I replied.

"Not now, though."

She raised her hand to her mouth and wet her fingers and then reached down and began rubbing her pussy in slow circles. I was again transfixed. There is something incredibly beautiful about seeing a woman's long, slender fingers massaging a gorgeous shaved pussy. With every revolution, I could see her lips swelling and parting, a little more pink.

"No," she said suddenly.

"What?" I asked befuddled.

"No, I've never masturbated for another man."

"Oh."

“Oooh,” she echoed, lengthening the “o” and giving it a whole other meaning.

It was mesmerizing. Resting her palm on her abdomen, she moved her fingertip over her sex. She alternated between clockwise and counterclockwise motions, between small circles and large. She paused for a second, and I instantly looked up. Our eyes met. She grinned, and I noticed she was holding the egg in her other hand. With a flick of her thumb it buzzed to life.

She licked her lips and slowly trailed the vibrating egg down her midline, from her throat to the valley between her breasts. Slowly, she circled a nipple with the vibrator. The sensitive red nub trembled and hardened visibly. It was all I could do to prevent myself from lunging at her and sucking it into my mouth. She seemed to notice and when she removed the egg, she circled it with a moistened fingertip, making it glisten and throb. She did the same with the other nipple before resuming the path of the vibrator from her cleavage, down over her belly, and closer, closer to her swollen, juicy snatch.

The pulsation must have transmitted through her abdomen because once she was within a couple of inches of her clit, her breathing quickened, and her hips began gyrating slowly.

“You have no idea how nice this feels,” she cooed, eyes closed now.

“Tell me.”

“Hmm, palpable anticipation. Like that feeling you get when you’re being hauled to the top of a roller coaster.”

“What are you thinking about?” I asked. Then before she could reply. “Who are you thinking about?”

She hesitated. I could almost read her mind, working through the possible responses. A challenge: *It always come back to that, doesn’t it Bill?* Or a white lie: *Just you and that tent in your pants.* Or the truth....

“Brian,” she sighed. “I’m thinking of how it felt when I was walking with him, away from the bar, knowing I’d be giving myself to him.”

She reached down with her other hand and ran a painted fingertip along her slit. It cleaved open, pink and very wet. She slowly slid her finger up and down between her puffy labia. She moved the egg closer to her clit and moaned softly.

“Mmm, that little push he gave me into the storeroom. Hearing the door shut, and the lock click.” She sighed. “Oh God, I’m so close.”

“Do it,” I groaned.

“Nah uh, Honey. You’re going to get the whole enchilada.”

She flicked the vibrator off and reached down for the black dildo. She lifted it to her mouth and licked the tip. It was huge, scary.

“I bought this one to remind me about Jason’s cock.” She licked around the top of it wetly. “Now I’m going to have to buy a bigger one in white to remind me of Brian’s.”

“Bigger.” I repeated softly.

“I told you it was the biggest I ever had. I couldn’t even get it in my mouth.” She tongued the now apparently inadequate, but still immense, phallus. “Do you want to see what my pussy looks like when it is stretched around a really big cock?”

I nodded dumbly.

“Good. Because thinking of Brian has me craving that feeling of being completely filled.”

My mouth was too dry to talk. I was staring at the sex toy, which was now glistening with her spit. She lowered the phallus from her mouth and rubbed the tip against a distended nipple. She moaned softly.

She looked at me and chuckled softly. “You should see the look on your face.”

“What look?”

“Not sure if you’re appalled or in love.”

I chuckled. “Both?”

“Hmmm, then I wonder what you’ll think about this...”

I felt my mouth sag as I watched her move the dildo to her pussy. She rubbed the tip against her twat. Her wet lips seemed to swell and begin to grip the smooth surface of the fake cock. Her pussy seemed almost hungry for it, desperate for that thick phallus. Up and down, up and down, the toy gradually entering her, and now moving in and out, in and out, deeper and deeper.

Terri let out a low, guttural moan. Suddenly the buzzing resumed. I tore my eyes away from my wife’s stretched cunt to see her holding the egg. She brought it down to her crotch. No playing this time. She pressed the vibrator to her clit even as she continued to ram herself with the dildo.

“Oh fuck. Oh fuck, Brian, that’s so good,” she moaned. “Oh God, you’re sooo big.”

There was a sheen of perspiration on her body, and her hips were pumping lewdly. Her big tits shook with excitement. Her gasps and sighs melded with the obscene squishing of her pussy and the buzzing of the vibrator in a pornographic symphony.

Then she grunted and nearly doubled over, her whole body twitching as she was wracked with waves of passion. I felt heat and wetness bloom in my pants. It took me a moment to realize that in my excitement I'd been rubbing myself as well.

She flicked off the egg and slowly withdrew the phallus from her pussy. She looked up at me, wild-eyed, through a disheveled mass of hair. Bringing the dildo to her lips, she licked around the tip. My cock twitched.

"See, no man necessary."

"Huh?"

"If you're not around, I am perfectly capable of taking care of myself. Some day I'll show you what I can do with a massaging showerhead and a bar of soap."

"Oh God," I groaned. "Okay. You win."

Terri laughed. "Alright, I think *you* need to get cleaned up. I'll be waiting in bed."

She deposited the toys in her bedside table, grabbed the covers and pulled them up. I couldn't help but notice that she was still naked underneath. I took a hurried shower, and pulled on some PJ bottoms. She'd turned out the lights and I climbed into bed with her.

I edged closer, wrapping my arms around her naked body, spooning her. God, she felt delicious. Her body was warm, her ass hard against my crotch, my hand wedged between her full, soft breasts.

"So, are you convinced," she asked, "that just because I like to flirt sometimes, it doesn't mean I have to act on it?"

"I guess."

"To tell you the truth, dick is overrated. Nice. But not the be all and end all."

She was in a bit of a weird mood. She sometimes got that way post-orgasm. Chatty and vaguely philosophical.

"Oh, is that why you keep a toy around to remind you of the biggest one you've ever had?"

"That's my point. That part of it is easily replaceable. It's not even the most exciting part of being with a man."

“And what would that be?”

“Strength. With Brian, it was the way he wrapped his arm around me and pulled me against him. The way he sort of shoved me into the storeroom. How he picked me up, light as a feather, and sat me on that stack of boxes. The way he forced my legs apart with his body.”

“Sounds a little rapey,” I suggested.

“I was more than willing,” she giggled. “But, yeah, I guess, a little. But still hot. Just that sense that he couldn’t wait. There is something sexy about being taken by someone you’d have given it to anyway.”

Baddies and daddies. It hit me what those kinds of men had in common. A dominant sexuality. Would any of the men who got Terri going have been willing to be just a spectator when she played with herself? Chucky who’d dragged her into a club bathroom and fucked her within hours of meeting her? Jean-Pierre who’d stripped her naked on a Paris balcony while screwing her from behind? Mike Coates who’d shamelessly flirted with a married woman in front of a roomful of her colleagues? Brian, who’d seduced her right in front of me and taken her away and banged her in a storeroom?

None of those men would have watched her, enthralled, and blown a load in their pants. They’d have had her flat on her back, ankles pinned by her ears, and fucked her until she screamed in passion.

Maybe Terri didn’t need a dick, but she craved that kind of dominant male. The kind of man who wouldn’t just hold her as she drifted off to sleep. And cravings like that don’t just hibernate until a convenient moment.

CHAPTER SIX

Terri kept telling me she didn't need more. I knew better. That seems arrogant. It smacks of "mansplaining." *Listen here, little lady, what you really want is....* And maybe I didn't know what I was talking about. But millions of years of evolution have honed our instincts about certain things, and what is more evolutionarily relevant than the threat of losing one's woman?

Okay, so that is a crazy thought. Surely, I was trying to justify my obsessions, to explain them away. Terri kept hinting that was the case; that it was all in my head. She had a point. I *was* weirdly obsessed with the thought of her and other men.

Still, she'd given me reasons to be suspicious. There was so much that she'd apparently been keeping to herself about her sexuality. Forget about the fire that blazed when we'd brought other men into the mix; the revelations about getting aroused from flirting and her use of sex toys was enough to get any man thinking.

"Seriously, Terri, you don't think there is anything weird about keeping and using a dildo that you picked specifically to remind you of another man?"

She scrunched up her nose. "I hate that word. Dildo. It sounds so crude."

"What's a better word for an oversized piece of plastic you put in your pussy?"

"Phallus. And it's rubber. And, at least, it isn't a realistic one with balls and veins and stuff. So, it could, you know, be cruder."

"Uh huh," I replied skeptically.

"What do you think of that one?"

She pointed out a beige sofa with large, rounded armrests.

"Seems a little bulky."

"We do have the space in the living room," she noted. "Plus, think how nice I'd look bent over the cushions."

"I thought we were shopping for furniture."

"We are, but you're the one who brought up my toys."

"I still don't feel like I'm getting the whole story."

“No, you’re not getting the story you want to hear.”

I opened my mouth to reply, but she sashayed away and was looking at a different couch. This one was cut in sharp, straight lines, with a dark, geometric pattern.

“How about this one?” she asked.

“It’s nothing like the other one.”

She shrugged. “Why is that an issue? If we’re redoing the room, we can build around any style we want.”

“You’re very flexible.”

She raised an eyebrow at me.

“I didn’t mean it that way.”

“I know,” she replied. “When did you lose your sense of humor?”

I sighed. “I’m sorry. It’s just –“

“That you think I’m holding out on you.”

“Something like that,” I said.

“You know, I wouldn’t have messed around with Brian if I’d known it would throw you for such a loop.”

“See, that my point. You keep making it sound like you’re doing it just for me.”

“No. I’m just saying that I wouldn’t do it if I didn’t think you liked it.”

Around and around. It was beginning to feel pointless. I threw up my hands. She looked at me, hands on hips.

“Well?” she asked.

“I hate the sofa,” I replied.

She hesitated then laughed. “Is that code for, you want a divorce?”

“Yes. Precisely.”

She swatted my arm. “Idiot.”

I gave her a light spank on the ass. “Slut.”

“Okay, so, what about a sectional?”

So, one challenge in all of this is that there really isn’t anyone to talk to when things get a little weird. Terri could tease me about seducing Herb, but I couldn’t go to Herb myself and get his advice. Hard to even imagine how that conversation would go.

So, Herb, can I ask you a question? Terri and I are sort of into swinging. Well, not really, it's just that she periodically has sex with other men, and it's lots of fun, but it's raised a few issues....

There are an impressively large number of online sites devoted to discussing this sort of lifestyle, but I didn't feel comfortable going there either. Part of it was that I had trouble identifying myself as being into the whole *cuckold* thing. Another part of it is that everyone online just seemed so damn happy about the whole thing, so completely unconflicted. The only guys who seemed dissatisfied were the ones who couldn't get their wives to fulfill the fantasy for them.

Boo hoo. I totally want my wife to fuck other dudes, but she won't.

That wasn't me.... Or was it? What was I most troubled about? Was it that Terri was into other men? Was it that she had indulged those desires? Or was it that I felt, if she were honest, she'd want to do it more? And if so, so what? I still couldn't quite put my finger on what was getting under my skin.

In the meantime it was getting between Terri and me. There was nothing overt. We got along fine. But she was clearly a little anxious about my emotional state, and that manifested itself in a reticence to tease me in bed.

We were still having regular sex, and as they say, even mediocre sex is good, an insight which is particularly true when your partner is beautiful and very sensual. But after the past year, it left me wanting more. Even when I prompted her, the most she would do was revisit, in increasingly vague terms, stories she'd already told me.

Somehow, we were drifting back into pre-Chucky territory, and it was all my fault. Me and my stupid overactive mind.

CHAPTER SEVEN

If it were up to me, we'd have held the line, and not traveled on Thanksgiving. But Terri is a peacemaker, and faced with my mom's guilt-tripping – *who knows how many more Thanksgivings I'll be able to host?* – Terri agreed for us to go.

It was, as expected, a miserable drive. The traffic was awful. It rained. Except, once we got off the highway and wound our way through the back roads, the rain stopped, the sun came out, and we got to admire the last of the fall leaves.

My folks live in New Hampshire. Dad used to teach at Dartmouth. They actually have a lovely house. Old fashioned, white painted wood, big windows, a huge porch, surrounded by trees, most of them now bare, but still impressive. It's even more lovely at Christmas, with snow on the ground, and an ever-present plume of white smoke coming from the chimney.

Yes, I was raised in a Norman Rockwell painting. And my family fit right in, with my beautiful blond wife, angelic daughter, and rough and tumble little boy. My older sister, Brenda, was there with her husband, Pete, and her kids, two surly teenage boys so constantly involved with their phones that they seemed almost autistic. Even still, Braden was enthralled with them and happy to just watch them play video games. Various other aunts and uncles, and a couple of cousins, drifted in over the course of the day, as well.

Even though my folks are liberals – they love Elizabeth Warren – Thanksgiving in our family has very clear gender roles. The women -- my mom, Terri, Brenda, and my mom's sisters, Aunt Mary and Aunt Lacy -- go into the kitchen and cook. The men sit in front of the TV and watch football.

Dad has always had a fraught relationship with his brothers-in-law. Dad deals with that by acting as if he's absolutely engrossed with football, so much so that he can't be bothered to make conversation. Mary's husband Greg was there and just as happy to stare at the TV while making methodical trips into the kitchen to refresh his beer. With the older generation grumpily staring at the TV, and the younger generation

engrossed in their phones, I was happy to have Pete around. I like Pete well enough, although since his interests seem to revolve wholly around TV, we quickly ran out of topics. Still, listening to him drone on about Game of Thrones, The Walking Dead, and Homeland was a relatively low-stress form of interaction. It passed the time until dinner was served.

My mom has this triangle that she breaks out only at Thanksgiving to chime us to the dining room. It's the kind of thing that should be charming, but isn't quite.

As I approached the table, Terri sidled over to me. "Okay, you were right, we don't need to do this anymore."

"What happened?"

She rolled her eyes. "Pies."

I knew exactly what she was talking about. My mom had previously pulled the same stunt at Thanksgiving, talking up the pie-making skills of my ex-girlfriend, Melanie.

"Again?"

"Yup. *Billy used to date this lovely girl, Melanie, who made the most amazing pies,*" she replied in my mom's thin, papery voice.

I laughed at her dead-on impression. "You're good at that."

"Too bad, I can't bake, huh?"

I reach down and tweaked her ass. "You have other skills."

She chuckled. "Should we tell your mom that? About my mad skills with the cock?"

"Um, no, that's probably not such a good idea."

"Terri, can you help with the broccoli?" my mom called impatiently from the kitchen.

My wife shook her head. "I'm going to need more wine."

I probably should have said something to my mom, except I knew it would only make things worse. Mom wouldn't understand why mentioning an ex-girlfriend should matter, and at best she'd be sullen about it. At worst, she'd want to discuss it with Terri.

But not talking about it meant that, sure enough, when the pies came out at dessert, Melanie came back up.

As she handed me a slice of strawberry/rhubarb pie, my mom noted, “Not as good as Melanie’s, but I think it came out well.”

I glanced over at Terri, who just rolled her eyes.

My dad, who’d spend most of dinner scowling at Greg because his brother-in-law had had the temerity to take the second drumstick, suddenly perked up.

“How is Melanie?” he asked the table vaguely before turning his attention to me. “She was such a nice girl.”

“How would I know?” I replied.

“You don’t stay in touch? You were together a long time,” my mom suggested.

I looked over at Terri, who proceeding to drain her glass. “Please pass the wine,” she said softly.

“Um, no,” I replied to my mom, even as I passed the wine to my wife.

She clicked her tongue in response. “Well, I’m sure she’s doing great, a girl like her.”

Terri filled her glass to the brim.

I’m sorry, I mouthed in her direction. She took a gulp and gave me a thin smile.

“You gonna eat all of that?” It was my dad, suddenly angry, snapping at Greg for taking too much pie.

“Oh, take it easy, Honey,” my mom said. “We have more.”

My dad grumbled unhappily, and then Pete jumped in to ask what people thought of Gotham, which didn’t go very far, but which at least got us away from Melanie and the fucking pies.

Aside from pies and traffic, the biggest problem with going to my folks’ was the sleeping accommodations. There were plenty of bedrooms, as long as the kids were young enough to stack like cordwood, but at some point, older folks stop updating the mattresses in their homes. For my folks, this had occurred sometime in the mid-1990s. Though they had cleared out most of my stuff from high school, there remained the now-lumpy, always-squeaky, full-size bed I’d slept in as a teen.

Terri had followed through on her stated intention, and had drunk enough wine to be a little silly. She's a delightful drunk. Goofy, just a little clumsy, her breath moist and boozy, her smile a little crooked.

"I'm sorry about that," I said once we were in my old bedroom.

"I told you she hated me."

"She doesn't."

Terri giggled. "No, but she does think I'm the kind of girl you bang, not the kind you marry. And maybe she's right."

"She's not."

"Your mom, Bill, is probably the only person in the world who wouldn't be surprised if we told her what we've been up to. *Told you so, Billy,*" she added in my mom's voice.

"That's not sexy, you know."

She smirked and continued imitating my mom, "*Oh Billy, fuck me, fuck me hard Billy.*"

"That's creepy."

"Good."

She grabbed a hand towel and went out into the hallway bathroom to brush her teeth.

When she returned, she changed into a flannel nightgown – not exactly the sexiest sleepwear in the world, but appropriate, I guess, for a chilly New Hampshire evening. I was waiting for her under the covers as she climbed into bed. It squeaked. Loudly.

"So much for fooling around," she noted. Thankfully, she was now speaking in her normal voice again.

"We could do it on the floor."

"Too hard."

"Standing up?"

"Is that how you did it with Melanie?" she asked.

"What?"

"You slept with her in this bed when you two visited during college, right?"

"Um, yeah."

"So you two were young and horny. Surely, you must have...."

"I don't remember."

She laughed. "Really Bill?"

"I... I..."

“Oh, so my sexual exploits are grist for the mill, but yours are too private to share?”

“What the hell *is* grist?” I asked.

“No way, mister. No changing the subject. Tell me, did you bang that little pie-baking whore in this very bed?”

“Maybe?”

“I’ll take that as a yes,” Terri said. “So tell me more. What was she like in the sack? No, no, no, wait. First, tell me what she looked like.”

“You’ve seen her picture,” I protested.

“Yes, how could I not? Your mom had it on display until Braden was born.”

I groaned. Terri always brought that up. And she was right to do so, because it really was unforgivable. Not so much of my mom, but of me. Why hadn’t I told my mom to put it away? Probably, I thought miserably, because I sort of liked the idea of reminding Terri I’d had other women before her, which I probably felt I needed to do because she was so out of my league that it made me feel insecure.

Terri continued, “She had a cute face. Not sure about the bangs, but nice eyes, sexy full-lips....”

Wow, Terri had studied that picture more than I had realized.

“But I don’t really have any idea about the rest of her. Nice boobies? How about her ass?”

“I don’t know, Terri. I mean, she was a cute girl. Yeah, I guess, nice boobs. Big, I guess. Maybe the same as yours, but you’re skinnier, so yours are... more impressive.”

“How about her nipples?”

“Yours are definitely better,” I replied quickly. “She.... This is weird to say, but hers didn’t really get hard. I don’t know, it always made me feel like she wasn’t completely into it with me, and....”

I trailed off. That was the first time I’d put that thought into words.

“Okay, and the rest of her?”

“I... I don’t know. I mean, I guess she was built a little thicker than you. Not fat or anything, but like... cruvy, you know.”

Terri nodded. “Did she have her bush?”

“Yeah, actually, yeah. That was, what, seventeen years ago? So right on the cusp of shaving getting really popular.”

“Okay, so, now that we have that out of the way, tell me what sex was like with this cute, solid, big breasted, soft nipped, full lipped, pie making genius?”

“I’m not, unlike you, a good story teller. And anyway, I’m not sure there is much to tell. I really don’t remember if we had sex here. Maybe. Probably, but if so it wasn’t very memorable. We just didn’t... or maybe, I just didn’t....”

It’s weird how having a conversation can trigger new thoughts or old memories. It is as if the act of speaking forces the brain to make new connections.

Terri sensed it too. “Didn’t what?” she asked forcefully.

I hesitated, but her sudden intensity drew it out of me.

“I couldn’t... I don’t know, maybe I wasn’t... maybe I’m not... a very good lover.”

“Oh Bill, that is so not true. Why would you say that?”

“I... I don’t know.”

She grabbed my hand and squeezed it tight. “Bill, what is going on?”

“Okay.... Okay, so, there was this evening. And... look... for all I know, it was nothing.”

She chuckled. “Oh, for fuck’s sake, out with it.”

I sighed.

“Does it have to do with pies?” Terri asked.

I laughed, and it broke the tension.

“No. No pies. It wasn’t even at Thanksgiving. It was back at school. Senior year. Maybe right after winter break. Melanie and I....” I laughed.

“Oh God, Terri, you’re going to like this.”

“Don’t build it up too much.”

“So, we went to this house party. I had these buddies who’d rented a big old Victorian, and there were like a dozen guys living in there. It was like a mini-frat minus the hair gel and homoeroticism. They’d have these parties all the time, and it was sort of one of our go-tos. We’d go out for dinner, watch some street performers, and then head over for a few beers, maybe a little weed, before going back to my place.”

Terri laughed. “College in other words.”

I nodded. I was unsure if I wanted to continue. Yet somehow, now that I’d started, it felt important to get it all out.

“There was this guy who lived there. Tommy. Toby. Something like that. Big guy, rasta vibe, even though he was pale as a ghost, blond dreads, wore those John Lennon glasses. He was basically everyone’s source for pot. I’m not even sure he was a student. Maybe he had been once.

“Anyway, he had this thing for Melanie. He’d call her Melle Mel and then do the rap from I Feel for You, which didn’t make any sense, but it was like their thing. He was a character. Always high. I always thought she was just, you know, humoring him, or whatever. But you know, they’d talk. He was always going on about something. Music. Politics. Real stream of consciousness.”

“Uh huh,” Terri interjected. “He sounds *interesting*.”

“I don’t know. Wow. I can’t believe I’m....”

“Just get it out.”

She seemed to know where this was going.

“So you’re at this house party...” she prompted.

“...and it’s getting late. We’d had a bunch of beers. I don’t know if I lost track of time, or what. But I’m thinking it’s time to go, and I start looking for Melanie. And I can’t find her. And I’m going up and down these rickety stairs. There are people on all the landings. Half the rooms are open with people sitting on futons or listening to music or whatever. And I’m, like, sure I’ll spot her any second.”

“But you didn’t.”

“No. I couldn’t find her anywhere. I’m asking people, and no one has seen her, no one knows whether she’s gone. And I go up another flight of stairs, and now I’m in this converted attic, with this low ceiling, and a bunch of closed doors leading to these little dormer-style rooms. There is music coming from downstairs, but I can hear sounds coming from one of the rooms.

“So I walk over, and it’s people going at it. Real loud. The girl in particular is just squealing and grunting, and....”

It was more than that. It was this sort of desperately passionate keening. Not frenzied, but focused and soulful.

“Melanie?” Terri suggested.

I shook my head. “No. It... It couldn’t have been. She’d never.... She wasn’t a screamer.”

I could see Terri’s skeptical expression in the dim moonlight coming through the window.

“Did you ever find Melanie?”

“No.”

“And Tommy Toby?”

“No.”

“So, um, what happened?”

“I left. I figured, she must have gotten tired and gone home. I don’t know. This was before we all had cell phones.”

“So what do you really think happened?”

“I don’t know.”

“What did she tell you?”

“That she was there. That we’d just missed each other or something.”

“Was she upset?” Terri probed.

“No.”

My wife regarded me skeptically. I had, of course, had the same thought over the years. If I had just left without her, she’d normally have been pissed. She wasn’t, so....

“Bill.... What do you think happened?”

“I think she hooked up with him.”

“But you never said anything to her about it.”

“No.”

“But you thought about it?”

I groaned. “I don’t know.”

I’d suppressed it for so long, and now, suddenly it was churning inside me, desperate to burst out.

“Bill....”

“Yes. All the fucking time. I had no proof, and I didn’t want any either. So it was all in my mind, I guess.”

“Which allowed you to deny it, but even still, it affected you,” she noted. Then after a pause, “How did it make you feel?”

“Angry. Jealous. Betrayed....”

“Horny?”

“Terri.... I....”

“Bill, it’s okay. You know I won’t judge.”

I remained mute.

“You fantasized about them, didn’t you?”

“Yes.”

“Tell me.”

“It’s not like I planned to consciously. It’s just that I couldn’t stop thinking about it. About those sounds. What was he doing to her to make her squeal like that? Was it just that he was huge? Was he putting it in her butt? Whatever it was, he was pushing her buttons like I never had.”

She laughed softly. “Or maybe it was just the novelty of being with someone new. Or the thrill of the illicit, cheating on her boyfriend while he was roaming around looking for her.”

“Maybe,” I replied doubtfully.

“Or maybe it wasn’t even her.”

I nodded.

Terri continued. “A lot to unpack here. Why do you think you never mentioned this to me?”

I shrugged. “It’s embarrassing to admit that your girlfriend cheated on you. That another man could fuck her better than I ever could.”

I felt my eyes sting. I hoped Terri couldn’t see the tears I could feel forming. But I couldn’t help it, because in that moment I wasn’t really thinking about Melanie, I was thinking about Terri.

If she noticed, she didn’t comment on it. Instead, she said, “And part of you worried that she wouldn’t be able to resist going back to a man who could make her scream that way.” She paused. When I didn’t contradict her, she asked, “Is that part of why you guys broke up?”

“Maybe.”

She squeezed my hand tighter.

“Okay, Bill. So here’s what we’re going to do. I’m going to suck your cock –“

“Terri, no, I feel weird about –“

She put her finger to my lip. “Shhh.”

When she was sure I was going to be quiet, she continued. “I’ll always be here for you. Remember that. But now, I’m going to suck your cock. You can think of anything you want. Think about playing with Melanie’s big tits. Think about her fucking Tommy Toby. Think about me with Chucky or Jean-Pierre or Brian. Think about Scarlett Johansson. Or just focus on how it feels. Just let go.”

“Terri, you don’t need to do this.”

“I know. I want to.”

She gave me a quick peck on the lips and disappeared beneath the covers. She untied my PJ bottoms and yanked them down. Her cool, slender fingers cupped my balls. She kissed my rapidly stiffening cock up and down. Her silky hair tickled my belly and thighs. And then she swallowed me whole. I gasped in delight.

I wanted to just focus on the experience. Terri is a very talented cocksucker, her mouth soft and very wet. She swirled her tongue around my shaft and the head of my cock. Her hand gently kneaded my balls. I wanted to just focus on that, but I couldn't. My mind was roiling.

Melanie wailing in passion. All those scenarios I envisaged flooding back. In his arms, bouncing up and down on his huge prick. Or bent over, her tits swaying beneath her as he slammed her from behind. And then to Terri, on the Paris balcony, getting fucked to the cheers of onlookers. Terri, in my lap, grunting and wheezing as Chucky sodomized her. Melanie on her back, squealing, with Tommy plowing his cock into her ass.

Terri's mouth felt so good, and yet made me oddly angry. She was a whore too. They all were.

And then shame. Shame at my thoughts. Shame about being excited about other men with my women. Shame. Shame. Shame. Anger. Excitement. Churning, churning.

I realized I was close... more than close... over the line. I tried to grunt a warning, but it was too late. I was spurting hot seed into my wife's mouth. She didn't even flinch. Instead, she continued to stroke my cock and gulp down my come.

For a moment, all my anxieties were gone. Just bliss.

Terri made her way back up. She was sweaty from being beneath the covers. Her breath had the musky odor of my come. She kissed my cheek.

"We'll talk about this more tomorrow. Okay?"

I nodded. "Okay."

She turned over and I cuddled her. And in just a few minutes, I felt her body soften, her breaths become softer and more regular as she drifted off to sleep.

She might have drifted off easily, but I didn't. After an hour of tossing and turning, I finally decided to get up. Everyone else was in bed, so

I had the house to myself. I crept quietly across the old, creaky wood floors to avoid making noise.

I made my way into the family room, and approached the towering bookshelf that lined an entire wall of the room. Most of it was filled with books from my dad's academic career as an economic historian, but one column had always belonged to my mom and was filled with an endless series of photo albums, all in order, all neatly labeled by date.

I ran my finger along the spines of the correct volumes, and pulled out the one I was looking for. I carried it over to the fireplace, where the remaining embers glowed red and inviting. I sat down with the heat at my back and began thumbing through.

Labor Day at the lake. My old Corolla. Brenda and her then-boyfriend Lucas, who, last I heard, was a multimillionaire out in Silicon Valley. I wondered if my sister ever thought of him, or whether maybe Pete did. My dad, his beard dyed dark; around the time of his midlife crisis, when he'd gotten into running and fitness. It had never occurred to me before, but I suddenly wondered if he'd had an affair at the time. Maybe with a sexy, young undergrad? No, that didn't seem his style, but then again, he'd surely be surprised by how things were with Terri and me nowadays.

Pictures of changing leaves shot from the top of Mount Monadnock. The first dusting of snow sprinkled over the old wood bridge at the end of Johnson's Meadow. Our old dog, Daisy, the friendliest, dumbest mutt in the world. She always wanted to curl up beside you, which would have been great except for her penchant for rolling around in dead things.

Then finally the pictures I was looking for. Melanie and me. Smiling. Holding hands as we walked in the woods. Of course, a shot of her in the kitchen, working on a pie. Sitting on my lap in the big leather armchair. I looked over and there it was, in the same spot it had occupied since I was a kid.

She was very cute. Twenty at the time, but looking younger in jeans and a flannel shirt. She was bright eyed, and Terri was right, she had lovely, plump, full lips. I didn't appreciate her like I should have. There was always some other girl turning my head. I imagined that she didn't notice, but she must have. I was twenty-one myself, and not really in touch with my own emotions. I don't think I pushed her away, but nor did I hold her close.

More fundamentally, I took her for granted. It never occurred to me that she might leave me or stray. If anything, I was the one who needed to “work at it.” I was the one who was always chaffing for freedom, whether it was to spend time with my buddies, or flirt with other girls. Why? I don’t know. It’s not like I was a stud back then, but somehow the lesson of April, that a girl who I might (unfairly) consider plain might still be attractive to others, had been lost on me.

Did I know for sure that Melanie was the woman screaming in passion in the attic room in the old Victorian? No. But that was surely because I didn’t want to know. I never confronted her about it. Worse, I did nothing to prevent it from happening again. We continued to move in the same circles. We continued to see Toby around on a regular basis – and yes, his name was Toby, even if I pretended with Terri not to be sure. He continued to flirt with her, although she now seemed more embarrassed by it.

And he was increasingly bumptious. Snide asides. A dismissive tone. It was easy to play off to others. He was a college dropout. A cut-rate pot dealer still living in a group house in his mid-twenties. But I never called him out on it directly because I knew he could nuke me in response.

You’re just a loser, Toby.

Yeah, but I’m balling your old lady, aren’t I?

I knew he was. I could see it in his face. That cocky smirk and challenging gaze. Primordial. An assertion of dominance.

I’m fucking your woman. What are you going to do about it?

I knew that look well now. I’d gotten it from Chucky. And Brian. And even from Jean-Pierre, though he wasn’t aggressive about it. But even so, I recognized it.

I fucked her again. Dropped a load right in her tight little pussy. What are you going to do about it?

I slammed the photo album shut. What was I going to do about it? Nothing. Nothing because I was too much of a wimp to put an end to it.

Worse, I didn’t do anything about it because it turned me on.

CHAPTER EIGHT

Terri didn't actually bring things back up the next day. Or the day after that. I think she sensed that things were too raw for a productive discussion. Indeed, for the next couple of weeks, we both did an admirable job of ignoring the elephant in the room, no matter how much he snorted and stomped about looking for attention.

But finally, one evening, a couple of weeks later, after the kids were in bed, and Terri and I were finishing off trimming the Christmas tree, we had the conversation we'd been avoiding. It began, surprisingly enough, with a discussion about my Amazon wishlist.

"It's empty," she noted.

"Is not." I had just checked it.

"Socks and salad tongs are not a Christmas list, Bill."

"Surprise me, then."

"Oh, I am perfectly happy to do that, but I'd like to be sure you'll like it." Her face was a mask, but her lilting tone was suggestive.

I hesitated. "Are we still talking about my Amazon wishlist?"

"What else would we be talking about?"

She gave me a challenging look. *You ready to talk yet?*

"Terri...."

"Bill...."

I stayed silent.

She continued, "Okay, so we know each other's names. Now what?"

More silence for me.

"You know we need to talk about it at some point."

Despite myself, I nodded.

"Who have you been fantasizing about more the last couple of weeks? Me? Or Melanie?"

I blushed. Fuck Terri and her ability to see right through me.

"Okay, so, both," she concluded.

"Do I need to be here?" I asked. "You seem perfectly capable of carrying on both ends of the conversation."

"Yes, Honey, I could, but.... Please pass me the tinsel.... But I think we'll both get more out of it if you participate."

Reaching into the box of decorations, I pulled out the hideous angel with which we'd traditionally topped the tree. Creepy oversized eyes. "Can we throw this thing away?"

Terri took it from my hand and deftly lobbed it in with the box of broken ornaments we were planning to discard. "All you have to do is ask."

"It's not always that simple," I noted.

"No," Terri replied. "I should think not. Not when the affairs of the heart run headlong into the disruptions of the mind."

"Disruptions? Is this my mind we're talking about, or yours?"

Terri laughed. "I'm kinky. I admit it. But you're tormented. So we need to deal with that."

"I'm tormented *because* you're kinky. Because you've got a thing for *baddies and daddies*, and I'm neither one of those."

"And what do you think that implies?"

I shrugged. *Isn't it obvious?*

"I promise, I won't get mad. Say it," she insisted.

I sighed. "It means that some day you're going to...." I trailed off.

"What? Leave you? For a *Chucky*? A *Brian*?"

I nodded. "Something like that."

She smiled but seemed to catch herself. "I'm tempted to laugh, but I won't. We've been together for over ten years. We have kids. A home. A life together. It's... it's crazy."

"Terri –"

"Ah ah, no, Bill, let *me* finish. It's crazy, but I get that that is your fear. And, I think that is what makes it exciting for you too."

"How do you figure?"

"Well, you *do* fear it, and it *does* excite you. I mean, we know both those things. But those aren't as inconsistent as they seem. It turns out, we often eroticize our own fears."

"Oh?"

"I did some research on it."

It annoyed me that she was psychoanalyzing me. It annoyed me even more that her diagnosis rang true. I decided to turn it back on her.

"So, does that explain your bad boy kink?"

She shrugged. "I don't know. Maybe.... It is a little scary when you're a young girl and suddenly, um, blossoming. The way men start to look at you. And of course, it's the bad boy types who don't bother hiding

it. So, yeah, I don't know. Maybe. Or maybe it's just evolution. Lots of women are subconsciously attracted to men who can act as a protector, even if consciously we want partners instead."

"So, I'm a partner rather than a protector?"

"And I'm a sexed-up floozy who can't keep her legs together when there is a jerk or a silver fox around?"

"I didn't say that," I interjected.

"Of course you did. But I know you don't mean it. Or maybe you mean it, but not in a bad way." She laughed softly, more to herself than anything else.

She grabbed a handful of ornaments and resumed dressing the tree. I watched her, noting the precisely calibrated casualness of her movements.

"Okay, so... I still don't know what we do about this," I said.

Terri remained silent. I could sense she had more to say, but I could also see that she wanted me to make the first move.

I groaned, and then slowly began to think out loud. "I wish I wasn't turned on by it... but I am. And I wish I didn't fear losing you... but I do. So... I guess... there is only one plausible course of action."

She couldn't contain herself any longer. She turned to face me.

"And that is?"

"I need to turn you loose... "

She raised an eyebrow at that.

I continued, "...until you or I or both of us get bored of it and until I learn from experience that no matter what you do with other men, you won't leave me."

She just looked at me. Not judging, but curious. Not eager, but confident.

"What I mean, by 'turn you loose' is that I don't want to be in on this anymore. I don't want you to feel like you need my permission, or prior approval."

"Why not? I mean, that's worked out fine. It feeds your obsession, but still gives you some control over things."

"The illusion of control. And it lets you deny how much you're driving the train."

"So, your proposal is to just make me the conductor and let me set my own timetables," she countered.

I nodded, swallowing the bile that was threatening to choke me. “And then we’ll see for sure where the tracks take us.”

She suddenly snapped. “Fuck the train analogy! Let’s put this plainly. You want me to go ahead and have sex with any man who catches my eye because if I do that and stay with you it will erase your fear that I will someday leave you. But I can’t just be monogamous because if I do *that*, you’ll suspect that I secretly want to cheat, and you can’t live with the anxiety that provokes in you.”

It sounded crazy, but it also made sense to me. I nodded.

“And I’m the one in denial?” she asked rhetorically. “You don’t see how this is just a way for you to get what you want without taking responsibility?”

“What do you mean?”

“You want me to fool around with other men, but in this construction, it has nothing to do with you, it’s all about my so-called uncontrollable impulses.”

“I don’t mean it in a bad way. I mean, just like I can’t control the fact that it turns me on, you can’t control that —“

“I’m a raging slut.”

“A sensuous, exciting woman,” I said.

“Ha! You’re insane, you know that?”

“I’m not. It’s—“

She strode toward me suddenly. “You’re full of shit,” she hissed as she shoved me hard in the chest with both hands.

I stumbled backward onto the sofa. She launched herself at me. For a second, I thought she might hit me, but instead, she climbed into my lap, straddling me.

“I should give you what you’re asking for. Just go out there and screw any man I find hot. That’s what you really want isn’t it? Never knowing what I’m up to? That constant, omnipresent thought that any time I’m out of your sight, I could be...” she ground against my erection with each word, “right then... fucking... another... man.”

I opened my mouth to speak, but she put her finger to my lips to quiet me.

“Don’t deny it, Husband. That woody in your pants is confirmation enough.” She thrust against me again. “I wasn’t doing it enough for you.

Well, how much *is* enough? How many new cocks a week is going to satisfy you?"

"How many is going to satisfy you?" I shot back.

"Oh, I can't be satisfied," she growled. She thrust her hips faster. I thought I could feel her heat and wetness, but since there were four layers of clothes separating us, it was most likely my imagination. She leaned forward and breathed in my ear. "I'm insatiable. But for you, Honey, I'm going to try. You better get used to sloppy seconds, Bill."

"Oh fuck," I hissed as I exploded in my pants.

"Oh well," she sighed. "Looks like it's toys for me tonight. Or maybe...." She grinned lewdly. "Or maybe I should get started on our project." She rose suddenly. "Yeah, that's *exactly* what I should do."

Having just come, I was suddenly ambivalent. "Terri...."

She stalked over to the closet and grabbed her jacket and car keys. "Don't wait up."

And before I knew it, she was out the door. I heard her car start and the wheels squeak as she accelerated out of the driveway and turned down the street.

"Oh fuck." I said to myself. *What have I done?*

CHAPTER NINE

Had she left on good terms with me, or bad? I wasn't sure. It occurred to me that it didn't really matter. Either we were on the same page, or she was angry and looking to spite me. In both cases, it meant that her final taunt had been serious. She'd gone out looking to get laid.

I wondered where she would go. To Brian's bar? I could picture her walking up, noting which side of the bar he was working. Sitting quietly and ordering a white wine. Just a small smile to let him know that, yes, she was here for repeat performance.

Would he take an immediate break, drag her into the back room and bend her over for a quickie? Or would he wait until his shift was over and take her back to his place so he could give her a proper fucking? I thought of him. Young, cocky, wildly-hung bastard. Probably both. A quickie just to get warmed up, and then back home after to make her scream with his big prick.

Or maybe, she was calling Mike Coates, the insurance guy. Inviting him out for a coffee. Flirting over lattes before letting him take her home. Older guy, ladies' man, he'd probably take his time with her. Strip her naked and really enjoy her body. Slowly finger-fucking her shaved pussy while he sucked on her erect nipples. Slowly, slowly, until she came again and again, until she begged him for his cock.

Or maybe she'd want to save those two for another time, and tonight was just about some strange cock. Even in jeans, a ponytail, and a winter jacket, I knew Terri could walk into just about anywhere and find men willing... eager... to fuck her silly.

The come in my pants had cooled into an unpleasant, sticky mess. I went upstairs, tossed them into the hamper and took a quick shower. In the time it took me to wash up and change into my PJs, my dick recovered enough to stiffen.

I took a deep breath and tried to calm myself. I had to learn to live with this. Terri now had a free pass, and anytime she wasn't with me, she was potentially with another man, sucking cock, getting screwed silly. It was exciting, but I knew I couldn't walk around all day with a hard-on. I

had to get my imagination under control. But I couldn't. Not yet. Not with all of this so fresh in my mind.

Was she with another man already? I dialed her number. It went almost immediately to voicemail. What did that mean? That she was already getting fucked? Or that she just didn't want to talk to me? The latter was more realistic, and yet my mind flashed to a scene of Terri naked, riding a faceless man, her big tits bouncing up and down as she impaled herself over and over on his fat prick.

I reached into my bottoms. Just a few quick strokes, and... bam, I made another mess.

I changed, but didn't bother to shower this time. Odds are I'd be creaming my pants again before the night was through.

She didn't come home too, too late. I was in bed, tossing and turning, when a car pulled up to the curb a little before 1:00am. I heard a car door open and then slam shut and the vehicle drove away.

Even if I hadn't been in a rare state, that would have gotten me worked up. Terri, I knew, had gone out in her own car. It took me less than second to conjure up an explanation. She'd gone out. Had a few drinks. Met a man. He'd offered to drive her home, and on the way, they'd stopped. I could almost see them. Terri with her blouse open, bra pulled down, tits on display, leaning into his lap, sucking some stranger's cock into her mouth as he gripped her ponytail and guided her head up and down on his shaft.

I heard her come in the front door and put her coat into the foyer closet. I heard her walk into the kitchen and open the fridge. A glass of water to clear the taste of jism from her mouth, surely. Or maybe to rehydrate after a vigorous backseat banging by some rich 'daddy' with a roomy sedan. Terri naked and straddling his prick, his hands mauling her ass, finger probing her anus as she moaned in pleasure.

Then I heard her slowly climbing the stairs. Was she just being considerate? Or walking tenderly after being bent over and fucked up the ass by some big dick'd jerk who loved hearing her screams?

And then she was in our doorway, backlit by the nightlight in the hallway bathroom. She waited a moment, looking at me, until I moved.

“I figured you’d be awake,” she said. Her voice was rough, a little slurred.

“Get a ride home?” I asked.

“Took a cab.”

“So, did you meet a man?”

She closed the door behind her and walked over to her closet. She causally began stripping off her clothes. Her blouse, then her bra. I’d been sitting in the dark for a while, so even the ambient light was enough for me to see her pretty well, but not well enough to tell if...

“So?” I pressed.

“I met many men.”

She pulled off her jeans and her panties, and stood there a few moments, completely naked. Had she been like this with someone else tonight as well? Had another man had the opportunity to admire her perfect body before ravaging her?

“I mean –“

“Did I fuck anyone?” She slipped on her flannel nightie. “Oh, I know you don’t want to hear the conclusion before the beginning, now, do you Honey?”

“Terri, you have to tell me.”

She had a free pass, which meant she didn’t need permission from me, but that didn’t mean she didn’t have to tell me about it if something happened.

She chuckled and climbed into bed. “I don’t *have* to do anything, Bill. But I will tell you about tonight--”

I thought of clarifying the point, but I was too curious about tonight to get distracted.

“So, did you?”

“In my own time,” she explained. “See, either I’m driving this train, or I’m not.”

“I thought you didn’t like the train analogy.”

She giggled. “Maybe I’m coming around on it.”

She paused, and I had to bite back the urge to press her again.

Finally she smiled. “I went to Bardos.”

Bardos. I hate that place. Loud. Fifteen dollar martinis, except they don’t have actual martinis on the menu. Everything is apples, peach, mint, coffee, or whatever flavored. Awful music on a quick loop. Stay an hour

and you'll hear the current top-five three times. Everyone just trying way too hard to be hip or cool or relevant. All of that explaining why she'd gone. A shot across the bow. *If we do this, I might end up with guys you don't like.*

She'd have been underdressed, but I knew well enough how Terri would deal with that. Unbutton her blouse a little more, tighten her bra, and voila, an expanse of showy cleavage to distract attention from her old jeans and flats.

"And you met a lot of men," I noted.

"Well, that's the idea, isn't it? Meet guys. And if I like one... or more than one... fuck them. Right, Honey, that's what you want me to do, isn't it?"

"If that is what you want."

"Well, I wasn't sure what I wanted. So, I figured, why not see what they had to offer?"

I felt the color drain from my face. "So, you... what? You...."

She grinned. "Oh, this is good. What are you imagining?"

"You, um, checked their, um, packages?"

She laughed. "Oh God, Bill. You think I care that much about size?"

"Says the woman with a dildo... phallus, I mean, the size and color of her biggest lover."

She laughed. "Which reminds me, I need to order a Brian-sized one. Though I probably need to arrange a second viewing just to be sure."

"Bring a ruler," I grumbled

"A measuring tape will be more useful. What I really want to get right is the girth, not the length. That's what *really* makes the difference." She paused. "But anyway, no I wasn't looking for the biggest tool, but rather, the most creative plan for how to use it."

"Um... how did you ascertain that?"

"I just asked them, Silly." I must have gaped at her because she asked, "Why do you look so shocked? Surely, if you don't mind me sleeping with other men, you can't be upset about me talking about sex with strangers."

"What... what did you say?"

"Well, I pretty much came right out with it. Guys would buy me a drink or come over and chat. You know, the usual bullshit. *Come here often? Are you alone?* All that stuff. And if he was cute enough, I'd work into it."

“How?”

“Oh come on, Bill, this is the boring part. *Yes, I’m married. No, he’s not here. Yes, I would like a little company. No, I’m not ready to leave yet, but what did you have in mind?*”

“And guys, just, what? Told you... what?”

She laughed. “Honey, men love nothing more than an invitation to talk sex with a woman.”

“I don’t.”

“Well, I meant the kind of man who tries to pick up married women in bars loves nothing more.”

“Assholes, in other words.”

She gave me a small shrug. *Whatevs*. “Let’s play a game. Which of these do you think I found most appealing?”

She didn’t give me a chance to respond. Instead she plowed ahead.

“First up, Rusty. Tall, late-30s. Really slim, but fit. Zero-body fat, triathlete type. Dark hair. The kind of guy who has five o’clock shadow by noon.”

A testosterone factory.

“He took a little prompting. At first all he was willing to offer was *a good time*, but I told him I needed more details. He invited me back to his place. Condo with a view and fireplace. He took massage lessons, and offered to give me a naked massage in front of the fire. Getting me nice and oiled up. Then wrapped in a warm bathrobe, making out, taking our time. That’s what he really stressed. *No rush Baby, I can go all night. Tantric.*”

“Did he really say tantric?”

She giggled. “He did. Very intense guy. And like I said, a really long, lean body, angular almost, but sexy.”

“Um, okay, so –“

“Door number two,” she continued. “Chad. Mid-30s. Former frat boy. Looks like he traded in his ballcap for a suit. A bit doughy, puffy. Too much drinking and not enough sleep. But even still, boy-next-door, blond hair, blue eyes. He was the most enthusiastic about my question. *I love to eat pussy*. He wagged his tongue at me for emphasis.”

“Charming.”

“I wasn’t looking for charm. I was looking for good in bed. He was very graphic. *I’m going to lick your lips, and suck on your clit. Then I’m*

gonna eat your ass until you burst out of your skin. He told me how he was going to finger me. He asked me if I liked a finger in my butt.”

“What did you tell him?”

“The truth. *Of course, Baby, who doesn’t?*”

“He must have loved that.”

She laughed. “Actually, I think he was a little disappointed. I think he was hoping I’d be shocked, and intrigued. I guess you’re right about me. I’m such a dirty little slut that even guys in bars looking for a hookup think I’m too much.”

“I’m still pretty sure he’d have gladly banged you,” I noted.

“Who says he didn’t?” She paused to let that sink in.

She continued, “Okay, option number three. Te’ron. Younger than the others. Tall, well-built, black guy. Real dark skinned too, not like Jason, so something of a first for me. Real deep voice, almost rumbling. Real confident. He had his hand on my knee almost immediately, his thumb making small circles on my inner thigh. He thought about it for a second when I asked him, then he told me he’d drag me into the alley. *Shove you up against the wall, pin your hands above your head, and go to town on that sweet ass of yours.*

“So,” she continued, “which do you think I liked best?”

Was she really playing a game with me? I wasn’t sure. It didn’t matter, though, because whatever my conscious mind thought, my imagination was running wild. I pictured Rusty, sitting on the floor, criss-cross, naked, his corded muscles taut, and Terri, naked as well, sitting in his lap, impaled on his cock, her big tits pressed against his muscular chest, both of their bodies glistening with sweat and oil, kissing wetly. And then my wife on her back, hands behind her knees, holding herself open, while Chad pumped his fingers inside her. Two in her pussy, one in her ass. His tongue swirling around her clit, and Terri, red faced, gasping in passion. Now in a darkened alley. Terri’s face pressed up against cold brick. Her jeans down just enough to expose her ass. Te’ron’s long, thick cock pounding into her from behind, lifting her off the ground with each savage thrust.

“Te’ron,” I groaned.

She grinned. “I knew you’d pick him.”

“So, did you?” I asked.

“Did I what?” she replied innocently.

My throat was almost too dry to speak. "Go with him."

"Did I let him shove his big, black dick in my little, pink pussy? Did he make me come so hard I thought I'd faint. Did I beg him to put a load of his jism inside me?"

"Yes."

She turned away from me, and I thought she was ending the conversation, leaving me hanging. Instead, she thrust her ass toward me, and I realized she'd pulled up her nightie, her bare bottom grinding against my PJs. Despite coming three times already, I was hard again.

"Go ahead, put it in, unless... you're not ready." It would have come off as a taunt, except she surely knew I was hard. Instead I recognized it as a tease. *I knew you'd be hard thinking of me getting fucked by another man.*

I freed my cock and spooned her. I rubbed the head of my prick against her, finding her slit, excited and ready. She was so wet that I entered her smoothly, frictionlessly. We moaned together as I buried myself inside her.

"That feels nice, Baby," she cooed. "Can you feel his come?"

I thought I could. She was drenched, and her pussy felt freshly fucked, loose, slick, swollen.

"Yes," I groaned.

She chuckled softly. "I'm not so sure. He put it in real deep."

He's bigger than you.

I imagined his long, thick, black pole plunging into her again and again. Terri on her tip-toes, impaled on his prick, shuddering orgasmically as she felt him splash come against her cervix.

She seemed to feel my excitement. "Make me come first," she growled.

I stopped thrusting and took a deep breath. I tried to purge the image of my wife being taken from behind by a complete stranger. No dice, but I was at least able to adjust my vision so that now he was giving it to her slow and deep. I thrust in time with her lover. At the same time, I reached around and placed my hand on her belly, feeling her body undulate as she moved to meet my thrusts. I moved downward until my fingertip found her slick, swollen clit.

She moaned. "Oh, yeah, like that, like that."

We moved rhythmically, our bodies coming together and separating. I sped up a little, and rubbed her button in quick, tight circles.

“Oh yeah,” she groaned. “Oh yeah, Tony, make me come again. Make me cream on your big, black cock.”

She gasped, and I felt her pussy clench my shaft. I was already so close to the edge that her climax pushed me over. I added my load to her gooey cunt.

And then it hit me. “Tony? I thought his name was Te’ron?”

She rolled over to face me. “What difference does it make?”

“Because he’s not real?”

She smiled enigmatically. “Oh, no, he was a real.”

“But you didn’t screw him, did you?”

“No. I’m not sure what his name was. A black guy did come over and make a clumsy pass at me. A couple of other guys did too.”

“But you didn’t invite them to wax lyrical about what they’d like to do to you.”

She scrunched up her nose. “Really, Bill? Is that really what you want from me? To go out and, what, just throw myself at the first man who buys me a drink.”

“But those stories.”

“Just stories, Bill. I have an imagination too, you know.”

“So... you *are* thinking those thoughts. You saw, Te’ron or Tony or whatever. And the others. And even if they didn’t say those things... even if you didn’t give them the opportunity to say those things, when you let your imagination run wild, that’s what you came up with.”

“Because it makes you nuts, and *that’s* what turns me on.”

“I’m not the only thing that turns you on, though.”

“No, you’re not,” she admitted.

“And that’s all I’m saying. When someone does turn you on, I don’t want you to stop just because of me.”

“Bill, even if I am willing to go along with this, it isn’t going to be like you imagine. I’m not interested in bedding down the first passable man who comes along. Or even the first man I happen to speculate idly about.”

“That’s fine,” I replied.

“You sure? Because, given your reaction just now, I get the sense that your real fantasy is for me to be doing this all the time.”

“It’s not.”

“And you’re not going to be disappointed if months go by and –“

“I won’t,” I insisted.

She seemed a little skeptical. And if I probed my emotions deeply enough, I suspected she was right to be dubious. How would I really feel if months went by with no stories?

“And you don’t want to know about it beforehand, because you don’t want me to feel like I need to ask your permission?”

“That’s right.”

She paused, thinking. “So, I guess this is an offer I can’t refuse. No pressure on me if nothing happens, and no guilt if something does.”

“Exactly.”

“You’re sure about this?”

“Yes.”

Another pause.

“Then... I guess we have an arrangement.”

CHAPTER TEN

I have to admit, I had never really clearly thought through how all of this would work, nor how it would affect me. It wasn't just that I'd given her permission to see other men, but I'd also insisted that she not tell me beforehand if she was thinking of doing anything. As a matter of logic, it made a weird sort of sense. What I came to realize is that it also served another purpose. One that Terri would not be surprised to hear me acknowledge.

The simple fact was that we were now in a situation where, literally, any day she might come home and announce that she'd done it, been with another man. No warning. No time to prepare. Just the sudden realization that my beautiful wife had given herself to someone else. That he'd explored her body with his hands. Kissed her passionately. Thrust himself inside and taken his pleasure... and given pleasure to her as well. It was an exciting thought, and it did make me wonder if she was right that all of this was more about serving my fantasies rather than hers.

She was right about the fact that it was disappointing when nothing happened. I remain convinced that I don't really like the idea of my wife with other men. And yet, when she came home, day after day, with nothing to confess, it annoyed me. No, annoyed is too strong. Frustrated, perhaps? That's not quite right either. It confounded my expectations at the very least.

The other thing it did was make me hypersensitive to any deviations from routine. I didn't know whether or when she'd take advantage of her new freedom. But it hung over everything. By the terms of our agreement, literally, any moment when she wasn't with me, was a moment when she might be with another man.

If I texted her during the day and she didn't respond immediately, my mind inevitably pictured her in a compromising position. On her knees with her blouse open and breasts exposed, sucking on a great, big cock. Bent over a heavy wooden desk, skirt bunched around her waist, panties stretched tight across her thighs, getting fucked from behind.

And even when she finally responded to my text, I would work that into my fantasy. On her back, legs over a stranger's shoulders, sending me a

grocery list even as a thick cock churned in and out of her tight pussy. His deep, masculine voice suggesting, *Send him a picture of us*. And I'd stare at the phone. *Milk. Bread. Bananas. Green veggies. Juice boxes for Braden*. As each new text arrived, I'd grow increasingly convinced that the next would be of her swollen, pink snatch clinging to another man's cock. *Oh, and assorted fruit yogurts*.

If I came home before her, those moments of waiting until she arrived dragged out. Even as I played with the kids and helped with homework, I couldn't help but imagine their mother in a hotel room. Half-empty champagne glasses on the bedside table. Terri, hands bound together above her head with a bathrobe belt, legs wrapped around the waist of a slender man, his muscular ass clenching as he drove into her again and again and again.

If her phone buzzed with an incoming text, I imagined it was an image of a hard throbbing cock, a response to a picture she'd sent earlier of her shaved pussy, a part of a flirtation that would soon lead to her coming home with torn panties and a thighs wet with another man's seed.

I was, in short, imbuing every little thing she did, or didn't do, with some sexual meaning. If she hadn't already been my wife, my behavior would have been weird, stalkerish, obsessive. It probably was all those things anyway, but she tolerated it with good grace.

It probably didn't hurt that I couldn't keep my hands off her. Spending all day, every day, imagining her being defiled by an endless series of hungry, powerful men kept me in a state of barely contained arousal. All it took was one of her sexy giggles, flirty glances, a flash of cleavage, a glimpse of her ass in yoga pants to set me off.

But I had to keep my distance until the kids were in bed. Forcing myself to be calm and attentive to them. Deep breaths when their mother was in the room. Finally bidding them good night. Then I'd be upon her. Pressing in close. Hands, mouth exploring. Was that a bite mark on her shoulder? Aromas, tastes. A whiff of a man's cologne? The salty tang of dried sweat? I was consumed by my jealousy and lust, convinced that one day, any day now, I'd discover the damning evidence of some other man on, or in, her.

“How was your day?” I asked as I nuzzled her neck from behind, checking to see if there were any bruises where there shouldn’t be.

She’d just sat down at her desk, and was going over the bills.

She giggled. “Bill, you have to let me do some chores.”

“Later.”

I rubbed her shoulders, and then slid a hand down to palm her flat belly.

“Look, a past due notice.” She waved an envelope at me.

“Later.”

God, her hair smelled so delicious, orange and vanilla wafting into my nostrils. Had she washed it recently? Maybe after a late afternoon tryst in a convenient bachelor pad downtown. She turned toward me and kissed me with a sudden, desperate intensity. Too sudden. Too desperate. Too passionate to be meaningless.

“Oh God, Terri, you did, didn’t you?” I gasped.

“Did what?” she teased. “Are you accusing me of having an afternoon assignation?”

“Not... not accusing. Just asking.”

She spun her head around to face me. I had the awkward choice of bending over double or.... I dropped to my knees so we could be face to face. She smirked and ran her hand through my hair.

“Well,” she began. “My afternoon appointment *did* cancel at the last minute. So there I was, out of the office, with *nothing* to do. Didn’t make sense to just go all the way back to my office, so I thought about how I might... occupy myself.”

I stared at her, rapt. That strand of silky hair across her cheek. Her red fingernails resting on her thighs. Her blue eyes sparkling with amusement.

“At first, I thought I might just go down to Starbucks, have a coffee and read a book. But then I decided I wanted to do something... more... physical.”

“Who?”

“With whom did I spent my afternoon?” she asked innocently.

I nodded.

“Maybe it was Brian,” she suggested. “Mid-afternoon. Between the lunch rush and happy hour. Plenty of time for a rendezvous.”

I pictured her in his powerful arms, legs wrapped around his waist as he roughly bounced her up and down on his oversized prick, her head thrown back, crying out in passion.

“Did you?”

She smiled. “No. Though I do still *need* to pay him a visit. I promised him I would after the last time, and the longer I wait, the worse it’ll be for me.” She paused. “Though maybe that’s a feature and not a bug, right Bill?”

I nodded, dry mouthed, head spinning.

Terri kneeling before his naked form, his hard prick jutting out obscenely, fist clenching at her hair. *You stayed away too long. Now you have to pay.*

“Or maybe Herb,” she continued. “I was right by his office.”

Why did he keep coming up? Did she have a thing for him? Or was it just that she knew it would get under my skin? Or did the fact that she *knew* it would get under my skin encourage her?

“You didn’t.” I said with less confidence that I had planned.

She smiled. “Is that a question or a statement?”

“A statement?”

She laughed. I did as well. She knew so well how to make me nuts. Too well.

“No,” she admitted. “I could never do that to Melody.”

“But you would otherwise?”

She grinned again. Bam. I’d walked right into her trap.

“*Maaayyybe.*” She said it in a way that clearly indicated *yes*.

“Melody let slip one night that he’s *very* sexual. Not that she needed to. I can see it in his eyes.”

“His eyes?”

She nodded. “He’s kinky, that one. He doesn’t just check me out. He’s, um, making plans.... And, he does have a great, big cock.”

I gasped. “You’ve seen it?”

“At the pool. You guys put more on display than you often realize.”

I blushed at the thought that other neighborhood woman had been assessing me that way as well.

“So who?” I asked.

“Why are you so sure I did?” she asked.

“Your hair. You took a late shower. And —“

She laughed. "I had a couple of hours off and I went to a yoga class. Then I took a shower at the gym."

"Oh."

She caressed my cheek. "You're so silly."

"I'm not. I just..."

"Tell you what, Honey. Let me finish paying these bills, and tonight you get to make up a story about me and we'll act it out together."

I nodded and got to my feet. She turned back around and went back to work on her tidy pile of bills. I just watched her for a moment, feeling again that disconnect between the two Terris. The one, a normal married woman with kids and responsibilities, the other a sexy vixen lurking inside. Not two separate women, of course, but each, as I imagined it, vying continually for dominance.

I retreated to the living room and busied myself with taking the decorations off the tree. If it had been up to the kids, we'd keep the thing up until March, but it was already shedding needles at an alarming rate, and dry enough that it was more kindling than tree.

If Terri was living with an internal struggle, then in some way, so too was I. I had decided to put my hand on the scale in favor of slutty Terri. In part, it was because I had a sense that that Terri was more authentic, but she was right. That wasn't all of it. The truth was, I was drawn to that conception of her. Fiery, exciting, a sexual rollercoaster. Irresistible, even if, in the back of my mind I suspected that if she ever really let go, I would lose her simply because I couldn't keep up with her needs and desires.

I'd never have a ten inch prick and bulging muscles. Even more importantly, I'd never have the gall to bend her over a sink in a nightclub bathroom, or strip her naked and fuck her on a balcony overlooking a busy street, or share her with one of my buddies.

"You ready to go upstairs?"

I startled and looked back to see Terri leaning up against the entry to the living room. Back-arched, hand gripping the lintel, foot pressed against the frame. A femme fatale out of an old *film noir*. *You know how to whistle, don't you, Steve? You just put your lips together and... blow.*

"Um, sure."

I rose. She held out her hand, and I took it. She led me upstairs, my eyes drawn to her ass. What an ass. I looked up and she was grinning at me.

She shooed me into the bedroom and loudly locked the door behind us. I sat on the bed. She slid over to the closet.

“So, what was I wearing?” she asked.

I looked at her quizzically. “Not what you have on now?”

“I changed when I got home.”

“So what were you wearing before?”

“You tell me.”

I shook my head, still not understanding.

“This is your story,” she reminded me.

“I... I don’t know. A dress?”

She reached into her closet and pulled out her slinky black dress, the dress she’d been wearing at her birthday celebration when her first revelation had started all of this.

“Surely not this one. Not midday.”

I nodded. “No,” I agreed. “How about... how about that clingy silvery one.”

“The sweater dress?”

She took it out and held it in front of her. It was shapeless by itself, but I knew that it clung to her every, delicious curve. It had a turtleneck collar, but was short, stopping at mid-thigh.

“Yeah.”

“Okay. What about underneath?”

“What would you usually wear?”

“Depends on the weather. In winter, usually tights. Otherwise bra and panties.”

Dressing her was oddly exciting. Like playing with a real life Barbie.

“No bra,” I replied.

“I’d always wear a bra.”

“No bra,” I insisted. “And... no panties.”

She grinned. “So tights?”

“No tights.”

She laughed. “It’s pretty short. If I sit down anywhere, I’ll be showing vag.”

“That’s okay.”

“Hmmm. Okay,” she echoed. “Shoes?” she asked.

“Heels?”

She thought about it. “Boots?” She reached into the closet. “These ones?”

Knee-high, black leather with a heel.

I nodded.

“Okay, any other requests?”

“Like what?”

“Hair, makeup? Ponytail, loose, up in a bun? Freshen up the makeup? Nightclub? Whore?”

I laughed. I knew she was making a Simpsons joke, *Homer, you’ve got it set on whore*.

“I’ll defer to your judgment.”

“Okay, one transformation coming up... *stranger*.” She ducked into the bathroom.

I shuddered. When she came back out, I wasn’t Bill anymore. I was someone else, but who?

I needed a drink to pull this off. I hustled out of the bedroom and down the stairs. I took a bottle of white from the fridge and a couple of glasses and started back upstairs. She was still in the bathroom when I returned. I poured us each a glass. I took a sip. Who, who, who?

Brian. He was the obvious choice. She’d actually been with him. It would be easy for me to work up my role.

Back for more, Baby? I knew you couldn’t resist this.

Would I grab my crotch then? No. Too crude. That was the thing about an attractive *baddie*, they managed to walk that fine line between menacing and charming. I wasn’t sure I could pull it off.

Okay, so, maybe Jean-Pierre. Happens to be in town. *What a coincidence*, I tried my best French accent. Except my best French accent isn’t really much different from my worst. Silly. Too out of the blue.

Te’ron? No. I still wasn’t sure he even existed. How could I impersonate a figment of her imagination?

Which left... Herb.

I’d never really thought much about Herb and Terri before. But she’d mentioned him a few times now, and I was seeing him in a different light. In my mind, he was no longer the genial neighbor, a wide-faced, harmless goof. He was now powerful, broad-shouldered, wolfish. I’d underestimated Toby, and he’d made Melanie scream. Would Herb do the same to Terri?

Had he already? Could she really see kinkiness in his eyes? His prick through his swim suit? Or had she experienced both in real life?

The door to the bathroom creaked open. I gasped.

“You like?” she grinned.

I couldn’t quite speak. Is your spouse of a decade still supposed to be able to do that to you? The dress clung to her body obscenely, every curve, every swell highlighted by the silver-threaded knit. She had added a long, silver chain that draped over the swell of her breasts, drawing my eyes to the outline of her plump nipples. The dress was short, leaving a gap of milky, white thigh before disappearing into those high, leather boots. She’d touched up the makeup around her eyes, making them sparkle, and added a layer of shiny gloss to her full, red, lips. Hair down, enhanced with a few loose waves.

I nodded.

She regarded me expectantly. The ball was in my court. My instinct was to tell her how beautiful she was. To take her in my arms. Kiss her mouth, her face. Drop to my knees and lift up her dress. Bury my face in her bare, shaved snatch. But that was Bill, and right now, I wasn’t supposed to be Bill, I was....

“I should buy that dress for Melody.”

Terri grinned. “Don’t you dare, Herb. I don’t want anyone stealing my thunder.”

“Don’t worry. I can’t imagine anyone stealing your thunder.”

Terri acted shocked. “What would your wife think about you saying that?”

“We, um, have an arrangement.”

Terri approached me slowly.

“An arrangement that lets you flirt with your neighbors?”

“What happens, happens.”

“And does Melody get the same dispensation?”

I sensed an edge in the query. We’d never actually spoken about me, and whether me letting Terri “off the leash” meant that I, too, was free to fool around.

“No.”

She examined me thoughtfully. I had answered as Herb, but I could tell from her expression that she’d gotten my dual meaning.

“That doesn’t seem very fair,” she noted. “You get to cat around and she has to stay home and, what, watch the kids?”

“It... it works for us.”

“Do you at least tell her about it?”

I smiled at her. “Let me buy you a drink and I’ll tell you all about it.”

I handed her a glass of wine. I led her over to the seldom-used sitting area by the bay windows. Indeed the last time I’d sat in one of these chairs was the night of my birthday party, the night Terri had brought Chucky over to give me a birthday surprise. She grinned as she ran her hand over the back of the armchair, and I knew that she, like me, was thinking back to that moment when, while impaled on my prick, Chucky had come up from behind and pressed his hard tool into her ass.

We sat.

“So, you were telling me about your arrangement with Melody,” she prompted.

“I’d rather talk about you.”

“What about me?” she asked innocently.

“What would Bill think about us sharing a glass of wine together?”

“It is just a glass of wine.”

“And what if it was more?”

She took a sip of wine and let her tongue linger for a moment on the rim. “What he doesn’t know won’t hurt him.”

It was just a game, but I was pleased with her response. Unlike with Chucky, Jean-Pierre, and Brian, Herb was part of our lives. We’d see him at parties and the pool and just around the neighborhood. With him, it would be a discreet, under-the-radar fling. I knew he wouldn’t be able to keep it out of his eyes when he looked at me. That smug, triumphant, *I just fucked your woman*, expression was impossible to suppress fully, but at least it would be *sub rosa*, unacknowledged.

“Have you done this before?” Terri brought me back to the present.

“Do you really care?”

She looked at me pointedly. *Stay in character*. I nodded slightly. That was a Bill question, not a Herb one. Or at least, not the Herb we were constructing here in our bedroom.

“Would you like some more wine?” I asked instead.

“Yes please.”

She leaned forward, uncrossing, and then recrossing her legs. I caught a flash of her shaved pussy. I poured her a glass, struggling to keep my composure. *Think like Herb.*

“I like a woman who is confident enough to go without panties.”

She took a sip to cover her smile.

“I like a man who is confident enough to comment on it.”

I felt a shiver of realization. Her sometimes aggressive flirting was about provoking a reaction. What had she said that night at dinner? *If they scare away that easily then they aren't going to be any good in bed anyway.*

I imagined our mock encounter. A meeting on the street. A little banter. Retire to a bar for a mid-afternoon drink. And now, time to close the deal.

“How about a man who is confident enough to invite you upstairs for a little fun?”

She slowly sipped her wine.

“You have a place downtown?”

“Keys to the corporate condo.”

“Very convenient,” she cooed.

“Very convenient,” I agreed.

I helped her to her feet, enjoying another flash of beaver. She caught me looking, but I didn't apologize.

“I knew you'd be shaved.”

“Why's that?”

“Because you're a dirty girl.”

She laughed. “You have no idea.”

I walked her over to the bed, my hand on her lower back, fingertips edging down over her ass. As we approached the bed, I pulled her into an embrace. We kissed, softly at first, perhaps like two strangers for the first time.

“I've always wanted to do this,” I sighed.

She looked at me a little disappointed. Bad boys didn't express unrequited longings. What was I going to do next, express my love?

“What else did you imagine?” she asked.

I pictured how she'd look with Herb. He was much taller and broader than me. She'd melt against him. He'd engulf her. Dominate her.

“I imagined you on your knees.”

Her eyes flashed. *That's more like it.*

She gracefully slid down, her fingertips trailing over my body. She looked up at me through her lashes.

“Like this?” she cooed submissively.

A frisson of excitement rushed through me. My prick went from chubby to hard in an instant. I wanted to lift her to her feet and take her in my arms. But no, that wasn’t what *Herb* would do.

“No, like this,” I gasped with as much bravado as I could muster.

I yanked down my zipper and pulled out my prick. What I wouldn’t have given right then for a *great, big cock* like the real Herb apparently had, much less a pussy-shredding monster like Jason or Brian. Not that it seemed to matter to Terri. She immediately leaned forward and swallowed me deep into her hot, wet mouth.

“Oh God, that’s nice,” I moaned.

I caressed her cheek. She looked up at me expectantly, her mouth stretched around my prick. She wanted something more, but all I could think of was how good her mouth felt, how grateful I was for her. I tried to put myself into the role again.

“Um, suck it, slut,” I added uncertainly.

She smiled around my prick, but she did pick up the pace, taking me balls deep, and nuzzling her face in my trimmed pubes. She bobbed up and down on me, now swirling her tongue around my cock head, her hands massaging my balls. So good, so good. It was perfect. I never wanted it to end.

She slowed a little and again peered up at me. I could sense that I was letting her down. But how did bad boys do it? How did they maintain that demanding and angry edge when a beautiful woman was enthusiastically giving head?

Terri let my cock slip from her mouth. I thought she might call an end to the game now that I was floundering, but instead she threw me a lifeline.

“Should I lift up my dress so you can see my ass?”

I nodded, then added as an afterthought. “Yeah, show me your ass.”

She choked back a laugh, but proceeded to slowly, slowly pull up her clingy dress, inch by inch, until her hard, round ass was exposed. She resumed sucking on my prick, and as she bobbed up and down, it was glorious seeing that perfect butt rising and falling in time with her mouth on

my cock. Why hadn't I thought to ask for that? I gasped as she swallowed me whole. I wished this would never end.

Again, she rose off me.

"So, *Herb*," she said pointedly. "Are you going to come in my mouth or do you want to fuck me?"

"Fuck you?"

She chuckled. "You're not sure?"

I groaned. "I'm sure."

But I was kicking myself. She shouldn't have to prompt me. And anyway, was that the right answer. Would it have been better to come in her mouth?

"How do you want me?"

"On the bed?"

She sighed.

"On your back," I corrected myself. "No, hands and knees?"

Fuck, fuck, fuck. I didn't uptalk normally.

"Hands and knees," I repeated more firmly. "And lose the dress. Keep the boots, Baby."

No uptalk that time, but suddenly I was talking like a member of the Rat Pack. *Ring-a-ding-ding, Dollface.*

"Sure thing, Big Boy," she teased back.

She yanked the dress up over her head with surprising grace and hopped up onto the bed. She waved her ass at me. Naked, save for her high boots, she was a seductive vision. I stared at her pretty, little pussy.

"Are you ready?" I asked.

"See for yourself," she suggested.

I reached out to find her slit, hot and very wet.

Why was I asking permission? She'd said it herself. *There is something sexy about being taken by someone you'd have given it to anyway.* I should have just grabbed a handful of her hair, spit-lubed my cock, and shoved it in.

But even now, I proceeded slowly, easing into her, relishing the sensation of her tight pussy on my prick. She thrust back against me. I palmed her ass and massaged her back. It felt amazing, but the fantasy was fading. This was just me and Terri, making love, as usual.

Terri sensed it too. Suddenly she stopped moving. I paused as well.

"Lie on the bed, Baby. I'm going to give you a treat," she proposed.

I did as I was told. She moved between my legs and licked my wet prick.

“I bet Melody never does this for you,” she said.

She spun around and straddled me, squeezing me between her leather-clad legs. She grabbed my prick and confidently impaled herself on me. I gasped with pleasure. Sitting upright, she rode me with hard, firm strokes. She grabbed my balls and massaged them in time with her movements.

She was so exquisite. That perfect ass rising and falling on me. Her slender waist. The rounded curves of her full breasts swaying gently. A mane of long, silky blond hair.

She leaned forward, lower, lower until she was almost prone against my legs. Her hard nipples rubbed against my thighs as she rolled her hips, fucking me with her gorgeous pussy. In that position, she was completely exposed, her tight, little asshole winking at me.

Was she offering it to me? Did it matter? A real man wouldn't hesitate. He'd let his wet prick slide from her pussy, grab a hold of her hips, and confidently shove his cock into her invitingly available ass. But I couldn't do that. I couldn't even bring myself to finger her there, not without permission, and even as *Herb* I was too timid to ask.

Terri was no longer talking. I suspected she had her eyes closed and was imagining herself somewhere else, with someone other than her milquetoast husband. With a man who could actually handle her.

As if responding to some unheard command, she rose up again. Sitting upright, and then arching her back. She grabbed her own heels and began thrusting against me hard, her tits pointing toward the ceiling, her long hair dangling into my face. I was just a prop for now, one likely not quite as satisfying as her oversized dildo, and even though she was making no sounds other than gasps and grunts, I knew for sure she was far away. Chucky, Jean-Pierre, Brian... or someone else. Herb.... Jason.... Some mysterious stranger. One of them. Or all of them. Circling her. Waiting their turn. A gangbang by all the men who'd fucked her the way she deserved to be fucked.

I gasped at the thought, suddenly past the point of no return. She felt me shiver and ground against me roughly. And then, she too, began to shake and gasp as she came.

She cautiously untangled herself and rolled over beside me.

“Not bad, Herb. Melody’s a lucky girl.”

I suppressed a sigh.

“Not as lucky as Bill.”

Terri gave me a grin, and we kissed. It had been fun. But I felt like I’d let her down, and it made me feel sad.

CHAPTER ELEVEN

My son is seven, but even still, in our neighborhood, it is considered almost a crime to give the kid time off from sports. *He'll fall behind. All the other kids are doing it. If you let him skip winter soccer, he'll never make travel.*

So, like an idiot, I was sitting on a hardwood floor on a Saturday afternoon, in an overheated gym, watching a dozen second graders playing some half-assed version of soccer on a basketball court.

"Hey, man, Terri talk you into this?"

I startled at Herb's voice.

He laughed. "Jumpy today?"

I smiled and shook his hand.

"Trevor playing too?"

He nodded in the direction of his own son running out onto the floor to join the others.

"I'm hoping for a soccer scholarship."

"Aren't we all?" I replied, looking around at the other overly involved parents. "How was your break?" I asked, changing the topic.

He rolled his eyes. "Two sets of divorced and remarried parents. So, we have four fucking Christmases to attend. Spent the whole time driving from one house to another, from one lumpy, creaky guest room bed to another."

"Well, the kids must have liked it."

"Kids are idiots," he noted.

As if to demonstrate the point, I looked up see Braden and Trevor spinning each other around in the middle of the court like they were in a ballroom dancing class rather than indoor soccer. I laughed.

"Remember when winter break was a chance to go south?" he asked. "Find some sun, get the wife into a bikini, enjoy nice, firm, non-creaky, hotel mattresses?"

Was he thinking of his own wife in a bikini or mine? We'd never vacationed together, but saw each other at the pool. Melody looked nice in a bikini. With her big Katy Perry tits and big Katy Perry eyes, she was sexy,

even if she wasn't super slim. Terri, though, looked like a swimsuit model. I knew he checked her out, and now I knew she checked him out as well.

"We still have three months of winter. Let's ditch the kids and find a nice, clothing optional island," I suggested.

He hesitated, wondering what *that* was all about. There were three options. One was that I wanted to see his wife naked. Two was that I wanted him to see my wife naked. Three was that I wanted to see *him* naked. I'd backed myself into a corner where the best case was that he'd assume I wanted to get a glimpse of Melody's naked tits. Which, I did. But even more, I wanted....

He forced an awkward laugh. "As long as *optional* means you and I can keep our suits on. Don't take it the wrong way, but seeing your schlong would make the next decade of soccer games awkward."

"Deal," I replied.

He checked his watch. "We'll be out of here in time for the game, I think."

Divisional playoffs

I nodded. "Yeah. But the late game is going to be the one to see. They always play each other close."

"And bad blood," he added. "Sucks to lose like that on a blown call. Broncs will definitely be looking for revenge."

"Want to come over to watch?"

I felt a chill as I said it. It sounded like a perfectly normal suggestion, but given the game Terri and I had been playing, it felt like anything but normal in practice. But if he suspected I was secretly inviting him over to bone my wife, he didn't let on.

"Sure. I'll bring over a six pack," he offered.

"Then what will you drink?"

He clapped me on the shoulder with a chuckle and stood up. "Alright, I need to pretend to pay attention. Trevor gets very upset if I miss him scoring a goal. See you later."

"Later."

I peered onto the court. Braden was spinning around like a top as the rest of the boys played around him. So much for a soccer scholarship.

There is nothing wrong or weird about inviting a friend over to watch a football game. So, why was it so hard to mention it?

I watched Terri standing in front of the stovetop. Even in jeans and a fluffy sweater, she still made a delightful impression. It also helped that the stew smelled delicious. Beef, wine, tomatoes, onions, garlic. A big pot of water was boiling in preparation for ribbons of thick, egg noodles.

I sighed and plastered a smile on my face. At least I hoped it was a smile rather than a grin or a smirk. I didn't want to send the wrong message.

"Um, honey? So, I hope you don't mind, but I invited Herb over to watch the game tonight."

Terri stopped mid-stir.

"Herb, huh?"

She resumed stirring.

"Yeah. He was at soccer. And we got to talking about the game. And... I invited him over.... What? He's been over here a million times."

"I didn't say anything. Why are you so defensive?"

She lifted the wooden spoon to her mouth and tasted. She added a little more salt and resumed her stirring.

"I'm not," I replied. "It's just. You know. After last night."

She turned to face me.

"Last night?" She gave me a puzzled look. Then a nod. "Oh, you mean, last *night* when we play-acted Herb seducing me. The same Herb you invited over to-*night*."

"He's a friend."

"Is Melody coming?" When I didn't answer right away, she answered for me. "Oh, no probably not. Kids and all. And anyway, this is just to watch the game, right?"

"Right."

She approached me. Her hand found my crotch.

"So, not once since this happened have you fantasized that I might end up riding Herb's big prick?"

She gave me a squeeze and grinned as her palm closed on my erection.

"What do you expect if you fondle me?" I asked.

"Uh, huh."

"What?"

"Remember, Bill," she said. "Be careful what you wish for."

“I’m not wishing for anything.”

She turned and went back to the stove. Was that an extra swivel in her step? An amused humming? Was she busting my chops? Or licking her lips in anticipation of the sensation of Herb’s fat tool sliding into her wet pussy?

I did dishes as Terri put the kids to bed. They’re young enough that even on Saturday we get them off to sleep at a reasonable time. I’d go up a little later to give them lights out.

I put the dishes into the dishwasher and scraped and seasoned the Dutch oven. I had one eye on the clock, though, as it inexorably ticked forward to the moment when Herb would arrive. And then what?

Nothing, of course. I’d just invited him to watch football. Nothing weird about that.

But then I thought about how wet Terri had been last night, even before I’d touched her, just from the fantasy of an afternoon tryst with Herb. Not that that was really surprising. She was the one who first mentioned Herb’s name in a sexual context. I was just responding to her. And yet, she was right. I did sort of want to see it. To see what kinky Herb with his great, big cock did to my sexy, little wife.

She cleared her throat from across the room. I jumped. She chuckled.

“Lost in thought, are we?”

I edged closer to the counter so she wouldn’t see that I was tenting up my jeans.

“Just finishing the dishes.”

“So, Bill...” I startled again. She was now right behind me. “What’s the game?”

“Broncos-Pats –“

“No, Honey, I mean with Herb. How does this go down?”

I didn’t answer.

She continued, “You planning to make a reckless bet that I need to pay off?”

My dick was so hard it ached

“Or maybe, you’re thinking I’ll dig out my old cheerleader outfit and shake my ass in his face?”

I groaned. She'd shown it to me once when we first moved in together. In retrospect, she'd probably been offering to model it for me. Why had I never had the guts to take her up on her implicit offer?

"You're not thinking of a half-time beer run, where you sneak around back and watch me seduce him, are you? That one really seems like a cliché."

I still couldn't answer.

The doorbell rang.

"Hmm, well, I guess I'll just have to play it by ear, won't I? I'll let Herb in. You say goodnight to the kids."

I grunted my assent.

She left the kitchen. I forced myself to breathe deeply as I ran my hands under freezing cold water until I was in some semblance of control.

I went upstairs. First to Braden, and then to Annabelle. Each had me read them a short book before letting me tuck them in and turn out their lights, all of which took longer than I had anticipated.

I closed my daughter's door softly and checked my watch. I'd missed the kickoff. And then it hit me.... Had I missed the *kickoff*?

I walked down the steps slowly, as quietly as possible. I wasn't sure I wanted them to know I was there because I knew, with absolute certainty, what I would find: My wife naked in my friend's lap. Her pretty, little pussy stretched around his fat prick as she rode him up and down. Him sucking hard on one of her big tits, mauling the other. His other hand wedged between her ass cheeks, his thick middle finger churning into her ass.

And the noises. Terri's high pitched squeals. His loud slurping at her tit. The sound of her pussy squishing wetly as his huge cock filled her again and again.

It was such a searing vision that I actually had to blink my eyes in disbelief as I peered into the family room. What they were doing was even more incredible. They were... just sitting there... watching the game... and chatting.

Herb looked at me curiously. "You okay, man? Look like you seen a ghost."

Terri was just grinning at me.

"Um... yeah," I muttered.

Terri stood. "We were just waiting for you to get started."

I groaned. Of course. So much the better to both torment and delight me. If Terri was going to fuck another man in front of me, she was going to milk it for everything she could. I'd see the flirt and the first kiss. His hand on her chest and hers on his crotch. The moment when her top came off and he admired her perfect breasts. The instant when she freed his prick from his pants and swallowed it into her hungry mouth. And, of course, the long, drawn-out culmination as his swollen member forced its way into her tight snatch.

I pictured her walking over to him. *I have something for you.*

A sudden discontinuity. "I have something for you," she said.

But she wasn't standing before him, fingers drawing attention to her cleavage. Instead, she was... handing me a beer?

He twisted off the top of his. Terri angled hers toward me. They were waiting for me to crack open the beers?

"Good return," he said. "But then three and out for the Pats. Manning's two for two with two first downs. Gonna be a long night for New England if they can't get pressure on him."

I sat down shakily beside my grinning wife, and turned my attention to the screen.

It was weird. I'd been so sure. The image of the two of them going at it so crisp and clear, that in a strange way, it was the prosaic reality of the game that seemed surreal in comparison.

My heart was pounding in my chest. I couldn't shake the sensation that at any moment I would look over and see them going at it. Even with Terri sitting with me on the sofa, and Herb in the armchair, it was still somehow more surprising to me that when I looked over she was still beside me and not naked in his lap.

I know I made conversation, but I can't remember anything I said or they said. Probably, we talked about football and the kids and maybe the weather.

Another first down over the middle.

It wasn't going to be just a long night for the Pats.

CHAPTER TWELVE

After I escorted Herb to the door, I went upstairs and found Terri in our bedroom.

She'd stripped off her jeans and sweater, and was now walking around the room topless as she brushed out her long, blonde hair. There was something so over-the-top erotic about her, even though she wasn't doing anything out of the ordinary. Or was she? She didn't prance around topless every night. How much of this was calculated? How much was just in my head?

There were times when it embarrassed me. Or perhaps, left me ashamed. Ever since her 33rd birthday, when Janet had peeled back the curtain on Terri's past, I'd seen my wife in a different light. After over a decade together, it was probably a good thing that she could still make me so crazy. Yet, at the same time, was it really healthy to so thoroughly sexualize her?

"Are you disappointed?" she asked.

"What?"

She rolled her eyes. *Really, Bill?* "Are you disappointed that I didn't fuck Herb tonight?"

I laughed anxiously. "No. Don't be silly?"

She looked at me skeptically even as I tried to parse why I'd added a question mark to the end of that sentence.

I sighed and caved. "Maybe a little. Why didn't you?"

She chuckled. "Besides the fact that it would kill Mel and would make us pariahs in the neighborhood if anyone found out, I didn't want to."

"But the idea so turns you on," I insisted.

She stopped brushing and flipped her hair back over her shoulders. I stared at her teardrop breasts. "It does?"

"Last night –"

"Forget about last night," she interrupted. "That was *us* playing a game."

"Okay, then what about today?"

"Huh?"

“Today? When you spun out all those scenarios? Me betting you. You flouncing around in your cheerleader outfit. Me making a beer run and leaving you alone. You obviously gave a lot of thought to how you might end up screwing Herb. Those all came from you.”

She laughed. Seeing my hurt expression, she softened and approached me. She placed a soft hand on my chest. “Oh, Bill, those didn’t come from me. They came from the Internet. I told you I researched our, um, situation.”

“Huh?” I said in my turn.

“Wife as escort. Picking up guys in a bar. Betting the wife. Wife seduces friend. Husband goes on beer run or work call. All popular cuck... hotwife scenarios. That’s your fantasy right? I’m a hotwife who can’t get enough.”

“I... I’m not sure I get it.”

She grinned. She made circles on my chest with her fingertip. “I fuck your boss for a promotion. We take a second honeymoon in Jamaica and I get seduced and taken by a wildly hung, black stud. We go camping and I get gangbanged by a bunch of young, buff hikers. Shall I go on?”

I wished she would. As she’d listed the scenarios, I caught a glimpse of each in my mind. Searing hot flashes of my gorgeous spouse in a series of disturbing, yet glorious, compromising situations.

“But, it’s not just fantasies. Chuck—“

“Chucky. Jean-Pierre. Brian. And yes, I fantasize about other men. And yes, I understand that you have given me permission to pursue those fantasies. Maybe I will. I’m not saying no. But it is not all about me. It is also about you, and what you want. And about us. The minute we bring others into it, things get complicated. But when it is just us, we can be anything.”

“I know, but —“

“It isn’t either or. Just because we have bedroom games, doesn’t mean I won’t....”

She trailed off and looked at me expectantly. I didn’t quite know how to proceed.

She filled the silence. “Do you want to be Herb who comes by Monday to check on me when I’m working from home?”

I shook my head. I’d had enough of Herb.

“Or maybe you’re a cop who offers me a very special way to avoid a speeding ticket.”

I swallowed hard.

“Or maybe,” she said with a grin, “maybe you’re a burglar who walks in on me like this.”

My eyes scanned her nearly naked body hungrily. She smirked.

“Please, please, Mister,” she whined miserably. “I’ll give you anything you want. I’ll do anything you say. Just don’t hurt me and don’t wake the children.”

“Terri—“

“If you know my name, you must know my husband is out of town. He can’t help me... or stop you. I won’t resist. You can do anything you want to me.”

It was so tempting to force her to her knees, roughly fuck her face with my hard prick. Order her to drape herself over the bed. Make her beg for me to fuck her up the ass.

It wasn’t just tempting. It was... what she wanted. Or something close enough. If it wasn’t her actually fantasy, it was an echo that we could share. But it just felt wrong. I couldn’t do that to her.

I took her in my arms.

“Shh, not tonight,” I muttered.

“Nothing?” she asked.

I laughed. “I didn’t say that.”

I pulled her over toward the bed and turned out the lights. I kicked off my jeans and sweatshirt and we slid beneath the covers, nestled close together in the warm embrace of our thick, flannel sheets.

I kissed her gently. She pressed her body against me. I relished the sensation of her soft, heavy breasts mashed against my chest. She kissed me more passionately. I wondered if she was thinking of me or another man. I drove that thought from my mind. *Not now. Not tonight.* Even if she was with another man, I was going to be with her.

I loved the way she kissed. Her lips were so soft, her tongue delicate and playful, but then a gasp and a sudden hunger would burst through and for a moment it felt like she wanted to devour me. And then the tenderness would return.

I slid my hand into her panties and squeezed her firm ass. She ground against me. I could feel the heat from her shaved pussy against my

erect shaft. Her hands were on my head, in my hair. I slid my hand between her legs from behind, my fingers dipping into her slick wetness. She moaned into my mouth.

She yanked at my boxers. We broke our embrace long enough for me to strip naked, and when we pressed together again, I found she'd also shed her panties. I pulled her on top of me. We kissed deeper. She squirmed against me, her hard nipples tickling my chest, her wet slit rubbing against my prick. I explored her body, relishing her slender form, her tiny waist, the curve of her hips, the firmness of her ass. She nuzzled into the crook of my neck, kissing, licking, moist, excited gasps in my ear.

She edged upward, and my cock slipped between her legs. Then downward again and I was inside her. She moaned softly. For me, heaven on earth as her tight, hot sleeve enveloped my shaft.

I slowly churned inside her. Our kissing becoming more urgent, deeper. She ground against me, harder, harder. She threw her head back and I kissed her neck. I felt her pussy squeeze my cock. I thrust into her harder, and a moment later I finished as well.

She collapsed on top of me. I knew that she, like me, had a big smile on her face.

That should have been enough for anyone, shouldn't it? Then why wasn't it?

My alarm woke me up early the next morning. The holiday season was officially over, and I had a hectic day of meetings ahead of me. I took a moment to look at over my wife. Asleep, she looked like an angel.

I rose and crept into the bathroom. I liked to set my alarm a few minutes early to give myself more time in the shower. Part of it was that I liked to shave in the shower, but even more I just liked to stand under the hot water, letting it flow over me, cleansing, relaxing. I'd even sprung for an extra-high-capacity water heater a couple of years back to enable my habit.

By the time I got out, Terri was up. She was standing in her closet, going through her outfits. I liked to watch her, trying to imagine what was going through her mind with each. I knew any and all of them would look

amazing on her. But then again, you could dress her in a burlap sack and she'd still turn heads.

"Morning, Honey," she said.

I kissed her neck. "What's your day like?"

She shrugged. "You're tied up all day, right?"

When I nodded, she continued. "So, short day for me. I'll get the kids. I have a staff meeting and then I'll probably need to do some work tonight after they're down."

She laughed and held up a clingy, long-sleeved, black dress with a ruffled, Jabot collar, which I always found oddly sexy.

"So no hanky panky?" I teased.

"We could try multitasking. But even at our most married-people-sex level of passion, I think I'd have trouble focusing on effective long-term disability planning."

"I'm sorry about that," I mumbled.

"What?"

"Last night. You know. You wanted to play, and I gave you married-people-sex."

She laughed. "I gave you married-people-sex back."

"But you wanted more."

She shrugged. "I had fun. We are, you know, married people, even though we don't always act that way."

"Terri –"

"Bill, don't beat yourself up over everything like this. I love everything about our life together. Including the married-people-sex."

I shook my head skeptically.

She smirked. "And anyway, that's what our deal is for, isn't it? In case I do decide I just can't live without."

I nodded. I felt my dick twitch beneath my towel.

"You're still sure, right?" she persisted.

"Yes."

"Then, everything is perfect, isn't it? You don't need to worry about *me* anymore. I'm all taken care of. You just need to tell me what *you* want. And if that is married-people-sex, that's great. And if it is something different, that's fine too. As long as it doesn't involve farm animals."

"Catherine the Great used to have sex with a horse," I noted.

"And it crushed her and killed her," Terri grinned back.

“Okay, no farm animals.”

She grinned. “Okay then.”

She leaned in and kissed me on the cheek and then made her way into the bathroom for her own shower.

I dressed and snuck out of the house silently to avoid waking the kids. I stepped out into the cold, dark winter morning and began my commute into work.

I had to work late and only arrived home after our usual dinner time with the kids. I had resigned myself to heating up some leftovers, when Terri told me she’d fed the kids early so that we could have a rare, mid-week, adult meal together. The good news continued. She’d made one of my favorite dishes, flounder with a cilantro-curry topping over a bed of fragrant jasmine rice. When I asked for a second helping, she stopped me.

“Save some space for dessert. I have a special treat for you.”

She was giving me a crooked smile, and I wondered if she was making a sex reference that I was totally missing.

“Um... okay.”

“Let’s clean up the dishes and put the kids down and then I’ll bring it out.”

I was tempted to search the kitchen while she was upstairs with the kids, but I resisted the urge. I wasn’t sure what Terri was up to. After the misfires of the last couple of evenings... or more precisely, my incredible lameness in the face of my wife’s invitations to kink it up... I was a little worried about what she had planned. Though... dessert... we’d never done any food play. The idea always seemed a little creepy, but then again, it might be fun to eat some whipped cream out of her snatch. I could probably pull that off without too much prompting.

I jolted as she slapped my ass. “Your turn, Big Boy.” She gestured upstairs, and I faintly heard the kids clamoring for my attention.

With the kids tucked into bed, I came back downstairs.

“I’ll be right out,” Terri called from the kitchen.

I sat down at the dining room table. She appeared a moment later, carrying a... pie.

“I doubt it’ll be as good as Melanie’s, but....”

It looked as good. A golden crust and delicious aroma, sweet with a hint of cinnamon.

“Smells great,” I said. “You didn’t need to go to all that effort.”

“You know I’d do anything for you.” She paused. “I decided not to risk berries. I can never get those to not come out runny. So I went with apple.” Another pause. “You’ve got to play to your strengths.”

I looked at her curiously. “Um... are we talking about pies? Or something else.”

She shrugged. “You want ice cream on top?”

“Sure.”

She smiled. “It is a nice little extra, even though a pie is good enough by itself.”

“Um... Terri...”

I trailed off as she disappeared into the kitchen. I plated two slices of pie. She returned with a container of vanilla ice cream, and added a scoop on each. I took a bite.

“Wow, this is good,” I exclaimed.

She smiled. I hoped she’d say something, but she didn’t.

“So... um... Terri? What is this about?”

She shrugged again.

“Okay, now I know you’re up to something,” I said.

Another shrug.

“Please stop that.”

She hesitated and then shrugged again.

“Maybe you should see a doctor about that shrug.”

She chuckled. “I don’t think I need a doctor. I think I’m fine.”

“Oh, and I’m not?”

“Bill, Bill, Bill, did I say that? Oh the places your mind goes. You do realize how much is just in your mind, right?”

I ate some more pie. “Look, Terri, I’m not saying that you don’t do nice things for me just ‘cause. You do. All the time. Really and truly, I know that, and I appreciate it. But you can’t pretend that you don’t have some agenda here. What’s the deal with the dinner and pie and the... riddles?”

She hesitated. “Okay, Bill, I guess I was just thinking we need to finish off that conversation we started about Melanie.”

“Huh?”

“At Thanksgiving? I got the story... finally... but we never explored it.”

I groaned. “Must we?”

She nodded. "I think we must."

"Why?"

"Because, the more I think about it, the more I think it has something to do with the conundrum you've built for us."

"I've built?"

"Mmmm, yes."

"Even though you're the one with --"

"The uncontrollable libido?"

"Something like that."

"The same kind of uncontrollable libido that it turns out Melanie had?" Terri proposed.

"I'm not sure that --"

"Well, that is what broke you two up, right? Turns out Melle Mel was addicted to the D as well."

"It wasn't... wasn't quite like that."

"How did it make you feel to hear her screaming in passion?" she asked.

"Look, I told you. I'm not even sure it was her."

Terri shot me a skeptical gaze. "Really Bill?"

I sighed. "Okay, look, I... I don't know. I told you it was weird. You know. I... It... Oh fuck it, Terri, okay, fine, I'm a sick pervert. It sort of turned me on, and --"

She shook her head. "No, no, Bill, that's not what I mean."

"Then what do you mean?" I grunted.

She took a bite of pie. Buying time. Slowing the discussion. Allowing my emotions to cool.

"Let's leave that aside, for now," she said, "as well as all the shame and self-loathing that comes with it."

"I don't --"

She held up her hand to stop me. "Bill? Just do this for me, okay?"

"I don't know what you want from me."

"Just for you to talk about your emotions for a bit. Look, I'd think that was a pretty traumatic moment. You were dating this girl, and she'd met your folks, and then suddenly..."

"I... I don't know, Terri. I guess I was angry, and --"

"What do you mean, you *guess* you were angry? Were you or not?"

"Well, yeah, I mean, she was cheating on me...."

“So, what did you do? Did you scream? Punch a hole in a wall? Call her dirty names?”

I shrugged. “No. I don’t know. Maybe.... Maybe angry isn’t the right word. I don’t know. It was a long time ago.”

“But it still feels like just yesterday, sometimes, doesn’t it?”

I shrugged. “I... I guess. I mean, it isn’t like, you know, I was thinking clearly. I *was* angry. But, I don’t know, it’s... you know... I was surprised,” I concluded finally.

I realized I’d never really explored the issue. She was right. There was a lot of shame. Denial too. That weird excitement of it. And....

“Terri, it’s... weird, you know. I don’t know that I was really angry. It was more like I thought I should be angry. Except... I wasn’t. Not so much. It was more this weird disappointment.”

She tilted her head. “In her?”

I took a deep breath. “Yeah. I guess. In part. You know, disappointment that she’d gone off with that asshole.... And.... I guess, disappointment in myself because, well, I’d never... could never....”

“Make her scream like that?”

I nodded.

She looked at me, her expression tender and sad.

“Okay, so what would you have done differently?”

I laughed. “What? If I could go back in time?”

“Sure, why not.”

“Kept her away from Toby.”

“And that would have accomplished what?”

I shrugged. “Nothing. Sooner or later she’d have found another guy.”

“And you’re just resigned to that?”

“What do you want me to say, Terri? I mean, look, it’s not like I wasn’t trying to keep her. I was. It’s just... she wanted more than I could give.”

“In bed?”

“Yeah.”

“I think you’re selling yourself short,” she said.

I snorted. “Says the woman who has more kink in her little finger than I have in my entire body.”

She nodded slowly. “Hmmm.”

I backtracked. "I'm sorry. I know this isn't about you, and --"

"Of course it is. I mean, that's why we're talking about it, right? It's not about me, but it's... about me."

"I don't know. Is it?" I asked.

"Is it?"

I didn't respond.

She answered for me. "It is. Because you think... and correct me if I'm wrong... you think that just like Melanie, I am hardwired to want more than you can provide."

I shrugged. "I don't know. Something like that?"

"You do realize that is something of an insulting characterization?" she asked coldly.

I felt a rush of anxiety. I didn't want to hurt her. "I'm sorry, I didn't mean --"

She stopped me. "Let's... let's posit that Melanie was, in fact, the girl you imagine her to be. What makes you think I am like her?"

I smiled grimly. My mind filled with images, real and imagined, of Terri with other men.

"Is it that obvious?" she asked.

"Isn't it?"

"It doesn't really matter what *I* think. It matters what you believe. But I'd ask you to explore that. Both about you and me."

"What does that mean?" I asked.

"It means, Honey, that a lot of what goes on in your head, particularly as it concerns me and my sexuality and you and your sexuality may be just that. In your head."

"And what if it's not, Terri. What if, I'm the one who sees things clearly, and you're the one in denial."

"Then, I guess we're in for a bumpy ride."

CHAPTER THIRTEEN

I have to admit, I didn't really know what to make of the pie conversation. I didn't quite understand what Terri wanted from me. Ultimately, facts were in my favor, weren't they? She did have, if not an overactive libido, then at least a healthy sex drive. Which is fine. Great even. Except for the fact that it seemed to me to make her vulnerable to the attention of other men.

How much so? I didn't know for sure. I only had her word to rely on. But even though I resisted the urge to peek at her cell phone when a text came in or surreptitiously explore her Facebook messages when she left her computer unattended, I had a pretty good idea of what I would find.

I mean, *of course*, there was an endless series of guys trying to get into her pants. Who wouldn't? High school classmates just *catching up*. Work contacts inviting her to *networking* lunches. Inboxes full of *innocent* messages that were just polite ways of offering dick.

She didn't make it easier on me. I kept expecting her to come back to the Melanie conversation. We hadn't really resolved anything. And if we hadn't gone to bed that night angry, we'd gone to bed in an unsettled mood. So much so that after about an hour of each of us silently tossing and turning, and knowing I had an early morning, I took a handful of Benadryl and went to sleep on the sofa.

Did I want to continue the conversation? No. Not really. At least, I never initiated a renewed discussion. But, on the other hand, I was surprised that Terri seemed to let it go.

Then again, Terri just seemed generally... off. Not so much distant as... hardened somehow. Had I hurt her more than I realized in accepting without dispute the comparison to Melanie? I didn't know. But I also didn't see how it was fundamentally wrong. Yes, Melanie had gone behind my back, and Terri's adventures had been in front of my face. That is an important difference, particularly in how I felt about it, but ultimately, how was it different in terms of what it meant for the future?

That's the thing. Regardless of how she felt about it or how I did, it was simply reality that Terri was into other dudes. And whether I just

reflected on what had already happened or on what might, it didn't change the reality of it.

I don't want to make it seem as if I were thinking about Terri banging other men nonstop. It came, as it always had, in waves. Each one higher and more thrilling than the last, until finally one came that was so high and so thrilling that it was terrifying.

Herb, for whatever reason, was the first one that really made me reconsider things. I had invited him over to have sex with my wife. And even now, that vision of them going at it could leave me shaking.

Yet at the same time, I was so grateful that nothing had happened. That cooler heads -- well, Terri's cooler head had prevailed. Because Terri was right. The likely outcomes were an impressive range of epic disasters. Herb was just too close, and the consequences too difficult to contain. Maybe that's part of what made it exciting to me. It's not as if, stolid, wide-faced, domesticated Herb was a particularly likely stud. Indeed, once the fever broke on that, I didn't obsess about him and Terri anymore, although I have to admit that it did amuse me to think about how he'd react if he knew how close he'd come to knocking off a piece of my wife's ass. I'd caught him sneaking a peek often enough to suspect he'd be kicking himself about the missed opportunity.

So, like me, she'd pulled back. Terri was playing it cool. But why? I got the sense that she too was worried that things had nearly gotten out of hand again, and she wanted to tamp down my fantasies and expectations. I knew she still had some stories to share about Jean-Pierre and Brian and maybe even Chucky, but she was keeping those under wraps even as our lovemaking remained firmly grounded in married-people-sex territory.

Nonetheless, I thought there was something in her still trying to fight its way out. I'm not even sure she was doing this on purpose, but what continued and even accelerated was the special care she put into her appearance. There was always *something* about her that hinted at more than met the eye. It became sort of a game for me to find because it shifted day by day.

Terri spends most of the day on the go between client visits in their homes or medical facilities or going to various workshops and seminars. So

it did strike me as odd when I noticed her wearing three-inch heels as she went out the door one morning. Nothing major. Nothing that would have people staring and pointing fingers and whispering “slut” as she passed, and yet it was something that in a Sherlock Holmes novel would be regarded as a meaningful clue.

Then there was that long, silver pendant she paired with a tight sweater. It hung in such a way as to accentuate ample breasts and prompted visions of her delightful cleavage. Again, subtle enough to be deniable, yet sexy enough to make it onto one of those hot girl/cute cats image sites online.

Sometimes, it was things that were only visible to me. At least, I assumed so. I’d peek into her closet at the clothes she’d laid out for the next day and notice that rather than her usual, cute, but utilitarian cotton underwear, she was planning a matching lace, demi-cup and thong set. Another time, when she had laid out plain, sensible bra and panties the night before, I looked in after she’d left for work to find the panties, alone of the all the clothes she’d prepared, left behind on her wardrobe. Had she just changed her mind and worn a different pair? Did she know I was checking up on her that way?

I assumed she did, and that this was more of her demonstrating to me how all of our sexual experimentation was grounded more in my fantasies than hers. That, of course, had been the point of the games she’d played when she went out and pretended to get picked up in a bar and when she led me to believe she was hot for Herb. I was determined to play it cool. If she could control herself, then so could I.

Except, it was hard. In bed, our married-people-sex weakened my resolve. The feel of her luscious body, her hot pussy, short-circuited my brain. I wanted to be in the moment, and yet, each moan and gasp in my ear, every tickle of her nipples against my chest, every contraction of her orgasming pussy on my prick formed associations with those little breadcrumbs she’d been leaving behind, breaking my resolve, pushing me closer and closer to asking the kind of question she seemed to want me to ask. The kind of question that would allow her to weave a seductive tale that would soon drive me to distraction.

And then she broke me.

It took me a while to notice it. I had peered in at her wardrobe the night before and seen nothing out of the ordinary. When she came down to

breakfast, she looked wonderful, as always, but actually quite conservative in a blue business suit. I knew she was in an all-day conference, which explained the fashion choice, and was also the reason I was both taking the kids into school and picking them up. She leaned in to kiss me goodbye. I caught a slight, respectable, whiff of perfume. She kissed the kids as well and then briefcase in hand walked out of the door. It was just as she passed through the threshold that I noticed it. Just above her burgundy pumps with the sensible one-inch heels, a glint of gold on her right ankle, a thin chain with a little heart charm.

I looked up. Our eyes met. She smiled. And then, she was gone.

CHAPTER FOURTEEN

Now, I know many women wear anklets. They can be just a fun little piece of jewelry that maybe calls attention to some cute shoes or a shapely leg. But Terri had already told me that she'd done *research*, as she called it, into our, my, whatever, fantasy so she surely had to know that an anklet was also, sometimes, a visible symbol of a hotwife on the prowl. I knew then that she *had* been leaving me clues.

Still, I wasn't sure I wanted to take the bait. I had started to feel that her games had a dark side. That the ease with which I allowed myself to be dragged along represented a vulnerability that she played on. I don't think it was malicious, but, by the same token, it didn't seem to bespeak a deep respect either. The fact that she could manipulate me so easily and did it so casually seemed a little disdainful, even if she explained it away as trying to bring to life my fantasies.

The truth is, I'd actually begun to question more and more about our game. I knew she'd been with Chucky. I knew it because at the end I'd seen it with my own eyes. I'd watched her impale herself on his cock, and I'd watched him roughly fuck her in our own bed. So *that* at least, had happened.

I was pretty sure Jean-Pierre had bedded her as well. Whether he'd stripped her naked on a Paris balcony, I couldn't be sure. But either she'd been with him, or she'd spent the better part of three nights roaming alone around Paris. No. She had fucked him as well.

But Brian? All I knew was she went off with him for a few minutes, and that she had what seemed like a used pussy for me after. Suggestive, yes. Conclusive, no, especially after she'd fooled me into believing that she was also giving me Te'ron's sloppy seconds. That had been pure invention, as had her interest in Herb.

So, now, faced with an anklet and a risqué smile, I was skeptical that this was anything more than another tease.

Still, she had that hold over me. As long as I was with the kids, I could focus on domesticity. Getting them dressed and fed and off to school grounded me to reality. But the minute I drove away from the school, my mind began to race.

On my way into my office, I called Terri's cell. It went right to voicemail.

Please leave a message. I'm in meetings all day, today, February 9, so I may not be able to get back to you until tomorrow. If it is an emergency, please call Maggie at....

I disconnected without leaving a message. She'd see I called and could return my call if she wanted.

She didn't.

The conference she was attending was real. I checked it out online once I got into the office. I glanced through the list of panels. The topics were, to me, a study in tedium. *Multigenerational wellness management. Techniques and risk for self-insurance for high-net worth individuals. Five potential revolutions in health care.* I noted as well the closing keynote from 6:00pm to 7:00pm in the Lincoln Ballroom, and the closing reception from 7:00pm to 9:00pm in the Grand Atrium. It was going to be a long day.

Surely the discussions were relevant to the participants, but I couldn't imagine them being sufficiently enthralling to distract the male attendees from the sexy blonde one row over with the enticing anklet on display. Except, now that I knew that was the thought she was trying to put into my head, I felt like a chump for having it. And yet, that didn't make it any less true.

She was going to be the belle at the ball, surrounded by dozens of men who shared her professional interests and would have no shortage of excuses to strike up a conversation. And then, as always, it would be up to her. Even men with qualms about messing around with a married woman would see those evaporate at the first flirty gaze from Terri. Indeed, even though she usually went for strong, confident, aggressive men, I could imagine that it might amuse her to seduce a man who wasn't initially inclined to make a pass at her.

All part of the game. Her game. Not *our* game. So many different games going on that I had trouble keeping track.

I expected her to at least check in around lunch. To see what my call had been about. But I guess she knew. So she didn't. I was tempted to call again, but I didn't want her to see how much she'd gotten under my skin with that stupid anklet.

"Not this time, Terri. Not this time," I muttered to myself under my breath like a lunatic.

Mid-afternoon and I packed up some work to take home since I needed to pick up the kids from school. Annabelle had ballet. Braden and I would pick up Chinese takeout while she danced and the kids and I would eat at home.

Chicken Lo Mein. Moo Shu Pork. Dumplings. I stopped by the 7/11 and picked up a six-pack of beer. I don't usually drink mid-week, but I knew I'd need it.

Despite my determination not to give in, I was spending more and more time imagining her day. Flirty conversations in the hallways between sessions. A man tracking her down and taking the seat next to her before the keynote.

We keeping running into each other.

Ha ha, yeah, must be fate.

Hi, I'm Greg.

I'm Terri.

A lingering handshake. A gaze held a heartbeat longer than comfortable. A soft giggle. A confident smile.

"Daddy, make me a pancake," said my lovely daughter.

"Me too, me too!" added Braden.

I took a swig of beer and handed over some folded Moo Shu to my kids, even as I tried to clear my mind of images of their mother giggling and flirting with other men.

A little after seven, my phone buzzed in my pocket. Terri. I answered it.

"Hey, honey, had a good day?" I asked cheerfully.

"Mmm, yeah, and very interesting and stimulating," she said.

"Oh? Want to give me some more details?"

"Oh, Baby, I'd love to, but I'm running from one room to another. Can I just say goodnight to the kids?"

"Sure, sure, of course."

I passed the phone to Braden who nattered on for several minutes about, I think, something that happened in gym class. It isn't always clear what he's talking about. Then Annabelle spent her time complaining that Braden had eaten the last of the Moo Shu. My daughter then handed the phone back to me.

"So, long day?" I prompted.

But the line was dead.

“Oh,” Annabelle explained, “Mommy said she’d talk to you when she got home.”

I forced a smile. “Of course.”

I got the kids into bed and came back down stairs a little after 8:00pm. I cracked open another beer and pulled out my phone and stared at it, as if by doing so I’d get some additional insights into my wife’s activities. I wasn’t expecting anything, so I was actually a little startled when a text popped up.

[Terri]: *Going out to dinner. Be home later than planned.*

Nothing really weird there. Except.... She didn’t say who she was going out with. And “later” struck me as deliberately vague.

[Bill]: *Okay, have fun.*

[Terri]: *I always do.*

I groaned. She was teasing me again. I imagined her smiling to herself as she composed the text, especially since she was almost certainly just with a group of people planning to go to an Olive Garden or something.

Except.... What if she wasn’t? What if dinner was a continuation of the flirting I’d pictured during the keynote address.

What if *Mr. We Keep Running into Each Other* had, after a glass of wine at the closing reception, become *Mr. How About We Go Somewhere a Little More Private*?

I was constructing all of this out of whole cloth. Still, why was it so much easier to imagine her huddled close to a handsome man in a darkened booth than to picture her laughing with a bunch of women as they passed around a basket of breadsticks?

According to her text, she left the reception around 8:00pm. Half an hour to get settled somewhere else. Dinner, dessert, coffee, split the bill. At around 10:00pm, I began expecting her to come through the front door. By 10:30, with my six pack of beer gone, I began wondering what game she was playing now.

I resisted the urge to send her a text. I imagined her sitting at Starbucks, waiting for me to panic, then grinning at her control over me before heading home. And then, a second later, unbidden, was the image in my head of her naked, writhing beneath a new man as my text flashed unseen on her phone.

At 11:00 I began to worry. Maybe she’d had an accident. Or more likely, maybe after a few glasses of wine at the reception and dinner she’d

gotten pulled over for DUI. And then, bam, the segue flashed into my head of Terri in the back of a police car, on her hands and knees, sucking off a beefy cop as he churned a fat finger in and out of her wet pussy.

11:30. Just as I was about to call, I received another text from her.

[Terri]: *Sorry. Got tied up. On my way now.*

Still playing me. I knew she planned the double entendre. She knew I wouldn't be able to stop myself from picturing her, what, bound? With whom? *Mr. How About We Go Someplace a Little More Private?* I shook that one off, finding now that my annoyance with her had outstripped my manias.

Stop fucking messing with me Terri!

She finally got home right before midnight. I was waiting for her in the living room. She crept in, shoes in one hand, clutch in the other, her hair disheveled, and a guilty grin on her face. Staged. All staged.

"We need to talk," I said firmly.

"Don't you want to hear about my evening first? It was quite, um, interesting."

"Uh huh," I replied noncommittally.

She read my skepticism and gave me a queer look. Then she smirked. "I was a bad girl tonight."

Then, without another word she slowly slinked up the stairs.

I remained downstairs for a few minutes. I wanted to pull the plug on it, let her know I was onto her game. But I also had to admit, I couldn't quite help myself. I wanted to hear what she had to say. Let her dig a nice deep hole before I called bullshit on the whole thing. I was also curious about who she was going to use as a foil. Not Herb. Brian? Maybe. But perhaps, most likely, a new man. A compilation or invention based on some people she met during the course of the conference, like she'd done the night she went to Bardos.

I rose and went after her.

"Anyone I know?" I asked as I entered the bedroom.

She paused. "Know? No. Know of? I think yes."

"Um, okay."

She circled around me and shut the door behind us.

"Did I ever mention Mike Coates?"

"The silver fox," I groaned softly.

She smiled, crossed the room, and stood in front of her closet. “You really do keep track of my crushes, don’t you?”

Fuck. I’d stepped right into her trap. I held my tongue.

“Yes,” she continued. “Mike Coates, the silver fox. He was one of the speakers at the conference. I kept having the naughtiest thoughts as I watched him, up there, on the stage.”

I laughed. “You sound like a groupie.”

“I acted like one too.”

She neatly placed her shoes in her closet and turned to face me again.

“Terri, you don’t have to—“ *continue playing these games.*

“But I want to,” she interrupted me. “I want to tell you all about it. It was pretty memorable.”

I shrugged. Fine. Best to get it over with. “Where did you go for dinner?” I prompted.

She moved gracefully over and placed her clutch on her bedside table.

“No dinner. Just his place.” She frowned. “Sorry to have lied about that. But, I still wasn’t sure how things would turn out and I didn’t want to, ah, raise your expectations. I know how you hate when I tease you.”

I chuckled again. “Doesn’t seem like much of a mystery if you went back to his place.”

She nodded and brushed a strand of hair from her face. “I have been to men’s apartments without sleeping with them, you know.”

I felt a surge of excitement, but it vanished almost immediately when I realized she was just planting another seed. I edged over to the bed and sat down on the edge.

I sighed. I wished she’d just get on with it. “So, how did he seduce you?”

She blushed and looked away. “He told me to get naked.” Seeing my expression, she grinned. “I know. I know. I need to make them work for it a little more.”

I thought of her and Brian. An extra pour of champagne, a little flirting, and she was following him into a storeroom for a quickie.

“Well,” she continued. “I did protest... a little. But he just said, ‘We’re both adults here. Let’s not play games.’”

“So?”

She slowly peeled off her suit jacket. Even in the dim light of our bedroom, I could see that she was no longer wearing a bra. Her breasts tented out the sheer fabric of her white blouse, her nipples poking through obscenely.

“So,” she said slowly, as she unbuttoned and removed her blouse, “I... got... naked.” A quick tug at the zipper on her skirt, and it too fell off.

And suddenly, there she was, fully nude, except for her gold anklet, nipples hard, an enticing glimpse of pink cleaving her swollen mound. Despite my skepticism, I couldn’t help but picture her naked, aroused, before this sophisticated, handsome, older man.

“Was he surprised?” I asked.

She shook her head. “No, Honey. I think he’s used to being obeyed.”

My mouth was suddenly very dry. I couldn’t speak. Not that I would have known what to say. My brain and my cock were having a chaotic battle inside me. I wanted her to stop mocking me, but at the same time, I had this desperate desire to just roll with it, let her get us both worked up to within an inch of madness, and relish the fiery passion that followed. And yet, like an alcoholic having a moment of clarity, I could also see beyond the immediate bacchanalia to the hangover the following morning, when I’d wake up ashamed and resentful that she’d played me once again.

She seemed unaware of my inner struggle. Or maybe she read my inner turmoil as excitement. Or maybe, she read me better than I could read myself.

She proceeded. “Not that he took any chances.” She approached me and held out her wrists. “Can you see the marks?” she asked.

I looked closely, and yes, faintly, I could discern lines coiled up her wrists halfway up her forearm.

I lifted my eyes to hers, confused.

“He had this very thick, very soft white rope. He slowly wound it around my wrists and up my arms and tied it off with a big knot. It felt sort of silly, like I could just shake it off, but when I tried to move my hands apart, I realized that I was really, really tied. He gave me this cocky smirk, sort of like, *you’re going to get more than you bargained for.*”

“Terri –“

“Normally, you know, I’d have just come home and ravaged you... or played with my toys. But since you insisted I should pursue my desires, I decided –“

“Terri –“

“He grabbed the free end of the rope and dragged me into his bedroom.”

I couldn’t ignore it anymore. My mind was filled with a vision of my gorgeous, naked wife, wrists bound, being pulled by a well-dressed man.

“He led me over to the bed.”

She edged past me, brushing against me with her naked body. A whiff of soap. An unfamiliar shampoo scent on her hair. And yes, just a hint of her excitement.

I stood to get out of her way as she sprawled onto the bed, arms together and stretched out over her head. I turned and looked down to see her draped enticingly across the bedspread.

“He threaded the rope through the headboard and made it fast. Then he trailed his hand down my spine. I closed my eyes and just enjoyed it. His palm was soft, but strong. It made me shiver as he touched me. My lower back... my ass...”

Her voice had dropped deeper, throaty, rumbling.

“...he slid his thumb between my cheeks. And I thought... I thought for a moment that he was going to push it in my butt...”

Her pauses were, as intended, driving me nuts. I couldn’t take my eyes off her naked body, except in my mind, she wasn’t alone, but instead being fondled by this debonair, handsome man.

“...but he didn’t. And then his fingertips fluttered against my pussy. And this time I was hoping her *would* put them inside me. I know he could feel how wet I was...”

She spread her legs for me. Just a little. Just as much as she would have for him to touch her. Her pussy was glistening and pink. It was all I could do to not fall upon her and devour her pretty, little slit.

“...but he didn’t. Instead, he caressed my inner thigh. Oh God, Bill, it drove me nuts. I just wanted him to... take me...”

A longer pause.

“...but he didn’t. He spread my legs... further... further...”

Her legs scissored open wide. Obscenely wide. Spreading and exposing her pussy, wet and pulsing with excitement.

“...and then he wrapped a rope around my ankle...”

With difficulty, I tore my eyes away from her throbbing snatch. And yes, there below her calf, another series of thin lines corkscrewing up her leg.

“...and pulled my legs even wider apart... and tied it to the leg post... and even though I knew what he was going to do, I still started shaking as he tied my other leg to the bed. It wasn’t even that I was completely exposed to this... man. But now I was completely helpless. And I knew he could do *anything* to me.”

I shuddered as well, watching my beautiful, naked wife, spread eagle on our bed, knowing that she’d been in this same position with another man just hours earlier. A stranger. A stranger who’d tied her up....

Suddenly, I groaned. It was all bullshit. Despite my best intentions, she’d sucked me in. But she’d gone too far. There was no way she’d let this virtual stranger tie her up. No way she’d give up control so thoroughly.

“Terri, stop. Okay. Just... stop.”

She looked back over her shoulder at me, her hair sexily draped across her face.

“What’s the matter, Bill? I thought this was what you wanted.”

“I did. I... do. I just feel like you’re making fun of me.”

She frowned in confusion. And then, after a moment, her eyes went wide, incredulous.

“You don’t believe me?”

“Terri, I appreciate you making up these stories. And you are good at it, but it –“

“I have pictures.”

I laughed. She was digging a deeper hole. “You let him take pictures of you naked?”

She shrugged her shoulders. “I was tied up. I didn’t have a choice.”

I felt suddenly a bit like Wile E. Coyote, the ground disappearing beneath me, but not yet falling.

“Do you want to see?” she teased.

Bam. Gravity kicked in. My pounding heart jumped into my throat. A weird tingle surged through me. I thought, for a brief second, that I was having a stroke.

Terri has a bit of a cruel streak, I guess. It is usually well hidden, or maybe it just doesn’t come out often. But her reaction to the stricken expression that appeared on my face was a sudden, proud smile. *Got ya!*

She bounced up onto her hands and knees and crawled across the bed to her clutch, shaking her ass at me as she did. She pulled out her phone, and then flipped over and sat cross-legged on bed, shamelessly exposed.

I stared at her mutely until she patted the bed beside her. I moved awkward toward her. Somehow my synapses weren't firing quite right. I sort of flopped onto the bed, and awkwardly half-crawled, half-squirmed over to her.

She was regarding me bemusedly now.

"Are you okay?" she asked. Her voice dripped with a coating of honey covering what felt to me like a core of sarcasm.

I nodded.

"Are you going to speak?" she asked.

I nodded again.

She laughed.

"I... I..."

She grinned. "Here's one."

She held out the phone toward me. And there on that stunning high resolution, Retina display, was a twelve megapixel image of my naked wife, bound and spread open on a strange man's bed. My gaze was drawn from detail to detail, building up a pointillist impression that overwhelmed my senses.

There were the ropes. White, very thick, coiled tightly up her limbs and pulled taut. Her pale, naked body against a background of rich, peach colored sheets. A cylindrical, navy blue, cushion wedged beneath her that angled her butt upward, putting on display her tight, little asshole and her sweet, pink pussy. Her hair crimped by a leather band....

"What's that?" I asked.

She swiped right and the screen was filled with a close-up of her pretty face. Eyes-wide, mouth stretched around a bright red ball held in place by a thick strap.

"You let him gag you?"

I looked over at her, and sure enough, up close, I could see faint reminders of the straps across her cheeks.

"He told me he had to. Otherwise my screams would bother the neighbors. And anyway, he said that I didn't need to speak. All I would be doing is begging for more."

I felt a surge of anger. At *Mike*, who seemed increasingly like an arrogantly blowhole. And at Terri too, for again reminding me that she sometimes had fucking terrible taste in men. I could tell she sensed my irritation. She decided to aggravate me further.

“I have to admit,” she added coolly. “He was right. He did make me scream. And he did make me want to beg for more.”

“Sounds like you picked a good man to fuck,” I grumbled.

“Mmmm, I’ll say,” she gushed, totally ignoring my tone. Or maybe deliberately poking at me. “But since I was all tied up and couldn’t move, it’s more like he fucked me.”

My mind was slowly catching up to her revelations. My growing conviction that Terri was just humoring me left me unprepared to deal with the fact that she had, actually, no shit, gone through with it. She’d had sex with another man without giving me any warning or asking permission. And she hadn’t just dipped her toe into the water either. No hurried quickie or even a normal, vanilla lovemaking session. She’d gone zero to sixty in no time flat.

“Did he fuck you in the ass?” I blurted out.

She smirked at me. “Oooh, what a naughty question.... Would you have liked him to?”

“Did he?”

“Is that what you want, Bill?”

I just stared at her. And when I didn’t answer, she smirked again, and continued, “He did all sorts of things to my ass. Do you want to hear about them? Hear about what he did to my ass?”

I rolled onto my back and closed my eyes. I was still off-balance. My mind reeled. This was what I had wanted. What I had badgered Terri for. And yet, in a weird way, I think I *was* secretly hoping that Terri would never take me up on my offer. That she would never *need* to. That despite her maddening infatuation for that asshole Chucky, her weird/hot, rapey fantasies, her attraction to dominant jerks, that despite it all she might, really and truly, need nothing but me.

I was pissed off. I remained stubbornly mute, though yes, I did want to hear it. I wanted to hear all about all the things he’d done to her ass. And her tits. And her pussy. I wanted to hear how he’d made her scream and beg. How he’d turned my wife into his personal, little slut.

Terri finally took pity on me. I startled when she placed her hand on my chest. I looked over to see that she'd stretched out on the bed beside me. Her face close to mine. I closed my eyes again.

"He was actually very gentle," she traced a circle on my chest with her fingertips. "At first, at least. He caressed me all over. My cheeks. My back. My legs. Sort of showing me that now that I was bound and gagged, I was his to do with as he pleased. He tickled my anus, and the side of my boobs. I kept shivering, like I was scared."

"Were you?"

"A little. I have... a dirty mind. A... sick imagination sometimes. It took me to some dark places."

"Like?"

"Like that he might sodomize me."

"I thought you liked that."

She chuckled. "I do. Sometimes. But Chuck and Jean-Pierre were actually pretty gentle and –"

My eyes flew open. "You had anal with Jean-Pierre?"

She covered her mouth, but her eyes were amused. "Oops. I was saving that story for another time. Sorry."

"Terri..."

I trailed off. What was there to say?

She resumed. "Let's stick with Mike. Okay? So... where was I?"

"You worried he might fuck you up the ass harder than your other boyfriends," I snapped hotly.

She grinned. "Um... yeah. Or... that he'd invite some friends over, and –"

"Are you sure you wouldn't like that?"

She batted her eyelashes at me. "Maybe I would. Maybe next time, Bill. Maybe next time I'm feeling horny, I'll make sure it's a roomful of guys to take care of me."

I snorted. "You're sick."

"Yes, Bill. I'm a sick, dirty, little whore." Her tone was precisely calibrated. Confirming, mocking, amused, angry all at once.

I grunted.

She laughed softly. "Shall I continue?"

I nodded, staring again at the ceiling.

“And then suddenly, he spanked me.” She rapped her palm firmly against my chest. “Not my ass. My pussy.”

I peered over at her.

She slapped me again. “He said I had a dirty twat. Or maybe that I was a dirty twat. And I had to be punished.” She laughed. “I hate that word. It’s so... crude,” she noted a bit absurdly. “Hard. But just with his fingertips. I tried to scream, but all that came out was a wet, muffled, squeak. He slapped my pussy again. I strained against the ropes, but I couldn’t move an inch.”

She paused, thinking about the sensation. I suspected if I touched her *twat* it would be soaking wet.

“Then he stopped,” she continued. “And I looked over to see him slowly taking off and carefully folding his suit. He climbed back onto the bed in just his boxers. I tensed, expecting another blow. My pussy already stung; it felt like it was on fire, but this time he was careful and gentle. He slowly traced the outline of my labia with his moistened fingertips. I was so wide open that he could have jammed them inside me, and I would have probably loved it. But he dragged it out. Slow teases. A feather light brush against my clit. Two fingers tracing a line down the middle of my wet, swollen pussy. It made me crazy. Horny. Desperate. It felt like I was on fire again, but different this time. Or maybe the same. I tried to thrust back against his hand, but I could barely move. I wanted to beg him to make me come, but I couldn’t speak. He just teased me.”

Terri moaned softly beside me. I took me a second to realize she wasn’t just reliving the beginning of her evening. I looked down between her legs to see her hand slowly, gently moving up and down her slit. She rolled over onto her back, and spread her legs slightly.

“Then he put his finger inside me,” she said.

I rose up on my elbow to see better, and when I did, she slowly pressed her slender, manicured finger inside her. She gasped softly. Her finger pumped in and out of her pussy, glistening wetly.

“Then another,” she sighed.

She slowly finger-fucked herself with her index and middle fingers, now rotating them inside her, now gently trailing over her clit, now just teasing up and down her slit. Her hips pumped sensuously.

“God, it felt so good. So good.” Her fingers churned faster. “I was so close.... And then he stopped.”

She removed her fingers. Our eyes met. Hers were a little glassy, heavy lidded.

“I screamed into the gag, begging him to finish me. I could hear him chuckling. He left me dangling for a good long while.” She chuckled as well. “The bastard.”

Then she grabbed my hand with hers. Her fingers were still slick with her juices. She eased my hand toward her red, spread pussy, her obscene, juicy gash. I felt her heat and wetness. Without even thinking, I pressed a finger into her tight hole.

She moaned.

“Oh, yeah, that’s it. Make me come. Make me come, Mike,” she sighed.

I added a second finger. She gasped and bucked against me.

“Harder,” she groaned.

I didn’t really need the encouragement. There is something about a wet, swollen pussy that almost demands to be penetrated vigorously, if not with a cock, then with fingers, or a toy. Still, feeling her hand on mine, urging me on, her soft gasps, the undulations of her sexy body was intoxicating.

“Oh God, oh God,” she gasped.

Her tight, little snatch clenched my fingers over and over.

She gulped.

“And then he really got me worked up,” she cooed.

Our eyes met again. She gave me a quick nod.

“Take off your clothes, Honey, and I’ll tell you the rest.”

I nodded and stripped. We lay side by side on the bed. She dragged it out, parceling out details slowly, carefully until my cock ached.

He didn’t give her a break. After making her come by finger-fucking her, he went after her swollen clit. It was too much, like pin pricks. She screamed into the gag and tried to shake off the ropes. He just went at her harder. Her pleas coming out as muffled whimpers. And then, suddenly, the agony turned to pleasure, a weird, head rush, a sensation that seemed to come from deep inside her. Dizzying, even before his tongue began teasing her ass.

She came hard and again as he continued to eat her ass while tormenting her clit. I wanted to do the same to her. To flip her onto her stomach and go to town. Or maybe I didn’t. Either way, I didn’t follow his

lead. Instead, we remained face to face. She stroked my cock slowly, enough to keep me right on the edge, but not enough to push me over.

“My arms and legs ached from struggling against the ropes. I had spit running down my face. Sweat dripping into my eyes. And then, Bill, finally, he fucked me.”

I pictured him rearing up behind her, his fat cock plunging into her soaking, over-stimulated cunt.

“Was he big?” I asked.

She shook her head and laughed. “Normal,” she replied.

But in my mind he was anything but average. In my imagination he was long and very thick, and her pussy stretched to the limit to accept him.

“He fucked me hard,” she continued. “I didn’t think I could come anymore. But there was something so exciting about it. About being restrained like that, unable to stop him from using my pussy as hard and as long as he wanted. I probably would have come anyway, even if he hadn’t put his thumb in my ass. But once he did, I was lost. My vision blurred. My head pounded. He plunged into me one last time, and came inside me.”

She leaned forward and gave me a soft, incongruous kiss on the lips. She rolled away from me, off the bed. I followed after her, sitting on the edge.

“He untied me. I was shaking all over. I waited for him to remove my gag. It was like I wasn’t sure I was allowed to do it myself. I ached, everywhere. He told me that if I enjoyed myself, I had to do one last thing.”

I shuddered as she dropped to her knees between my legs. Without a word, she swallowed my prick deep into her mouth. She rose up slowly, her tongue trailing along the bottom of my shaft.

“I could taste him... us... on his prick. I sucked him hard. He ran his hands through my hair.”

She reached out and grabbed the phone. She swiped to next picture and handed it to me. I took it just as she swallowed me again. I gasped, in part in delight at her hot, wet mouth, in part as the image on the screen of Terri, mouth full of cock, the strap marks on her cheeks still fresh, looking up at the camera with her big, blue eyes.

“Oh God,” I sighed.

I came in my wife’s mouth. She swallowed my load without hesitation, just as I knew she’d done for Mike Coates, the silver fox, a couple of hours earlier.

She rose and disappeared into the bathroom. I heard her brushing her teeth and then she reappeared in her flannel nightgown.

She grinned at me, still sitting naked on the edge of the bed.

“Bill? You okay?”

I nodded.

She tilted her head as she studied me.

“This is what you want, right?”

I nodded again, less out of conviction than some sort of inertia. Truth is, I didn’t know how I felt. I was on autopilot, even as I rose and changed into my PJs as well. As I climbed back into bed and Terri turned out the lights, I was sure I’d never be able to fall asleep. But I did. Almost before my head hit the pillow.

CHAPTER FIFTEEN

Terri let me sleep in the next morning. I woke up around 9:00am to a delightfully empty, quiet house. Terri had already taken the kids to school and left for work herself.

She did leave me a surprise though. Her anklet was draped across my phone, and when I checked my email, I found that she'd sent me another batch of pictures from last night. I swiped through them one at a time.

A close up his fingers deep in her sweet pussy, her folds wet and glistening, her clit swollen and prominent.

A close up of her asshole, wet with his saliva, almost begging to be fucked.

His fat prick about to penetrate her hot cunt. Even though she'd said he was just average, he looked big to me. Some sort of cuckold theory of relativity. The closer a man's prick is to your wife's pussy, the bigger it seems.

A wide angle shot from above of him fucking her. Just as obscene as I'd imagined. His cock glistening with her juices, half inside of her, his palm on her lower back with his thumb wedged deep into her ass.

A close up of the wreckage he left behind. Her pussy, red, raw, dripping his seed; her ass gaping open.

Her face, gag still in place, sweaty hair pinned to her forehead, mascara running, lips and chin dripping drool.

Kneeling before him, hands on her knees, a submissive slut waiting for cock.

Her head in his lap, his hands threaded through her hair.

My beautiful wife, open mouthed, a pool of come on her tongue.

And then finally, her again, ravishing, hair a mess, smiling, a drop of jism, apparently unnoticed, dripping from the corner of her lip.

I couldn't help myself. I swiped through the set again and again, stroking myself, until I came in my hand.

I immediately felt disgusted with myself. Ashamed. Another man had fucked my wife better than I ever could, and I'd jerked off into my palm.

I jumped into the shower to clean myself off. There was something nagging at me. A sense of real discomfort with what had happened.

The pictures... that was definitely part of it. When I was looking at them, it tended to short-circuit my brain. It would have, I think, even if she'd just been some random porn slut. They were just so wildly erotic. The fact that it was my wife made it that much more intense.

Still, this was a pretty wild escalation of things. As weird as it may sound, at some level I could deal with the sex. It wasn't easy, of course, but it provided such a mix of emotions, from the sublime to the ridiculous, as the saying goes, that I couldn't produce a coherent reaction. I neither wanted her to do it, nor to stop.

Part of what gave me that option was the fact that it was transitory. Knowing my wife was with another man was deliciously painful, like poking at a bruise. The memories of it, whether my own recollections, or those provided by Terri as she recounted details of it providing an echo of that sensation. But always, always, it had been something that was time limited. At some point she'd be home. Time and a shower would wipe away all the traces. At some point the power of those stories would fade. It was, of course, precisely that slow dimming of it that had led us to Brian in the first place.

But the pictures.... Those were permanent. Especially nowadays. No destroying the negatives. No burning the prints. No, somewhere, somehow, probably for eternity, out on the cloud, there existed pornographic pictures of my wife.

Terri had been bound. She couldn't stop it. Except, that wasn't quite right. She not only didn't stop it, she was now circulating them. She could have demanded he delete the pictures. She didn't. She was, it occurred to me, complicit in their production, a partner with Coates in creating a permanent record.

I stepped out of the shower, feeling queasy.

I dressed in a fog and made my way downstairs. There, on the sofa, was a tote bag from the conference. I was drawn to it. I've never rifled through Terri's things. Even as crazy as things were between us, I'd could never bring myself to violate her privacy like that. But that tote seemed almost like a public item. Less a handbag than a shopping bag. At least, that's how I rationalized it.

Instinctively, I knew what I was looking for before I realized it consciously, but as I came across the conference program, I knew this was it. It was creased, either from yesterday... or perhaps she'd printed it out earlier? I couldn't be sure.

Unlike my quick online scan the previous day, I read through it carefully this time, my eyes reviewing the list of panels, the names of the presenters. Medical and insurance jargon melding together. A torrent of names, words, associations. A few notations here and there. A checkmark. A star. A conference room underlined.

I needn't have been so meticulous. There was no missing it when I came to it. There, two-thirds of the way through the third page was Mike Coates' name, which Terri had ostentatiously enclosed in a rounded heart like a schoolgirl might the name of her not-so-secret crush.

My legs suddenly felt weak. I leaned against the table. I began to put the tote down, when I noticed another little piece of paper buried near the bottom. I fished it out. It was Mike's business card. And when I flipped it over, there, in blue ink was his cell number. The same card he'd given her the day they first met.

My heart was pounding, my head spinning.

She'd made it sound like they'd just run into each other at the conference. But now I couldn't help but wonder if she'd known in advance he'd be there. If, in fact, she'd planned it that way. If, maybe, they'd even been in touch beforehand. It would explain a lot. The bondage, the gagging, the pictures... either Terri had become recklessly impulsive or more likely, she'd worked herself up to all of this in advance. Maybe even with him. I wondered... how many times had they spoken? Or... maybe... even seen each other?

This wasn't what we had discussed. Not that I could really expect to hold Terri to any particulars. But, that said, our "deal" was supposed to be about her having the freedom to give in to her impulses, not to seek out assignments. Not to see men behind my back. I don't know why that made a difference to me, but it did. Terri seeing a hot dude and not being able to resist was, well, exciting. It didn't feel like cheating. Planning a hookup in advance, by contrast, seemed to violate our understanding, or perhaps my unspoken assumptions.

I shook my head. All this was making me dizzy. I couldn't put my finger on it, but something had changed. It made me uneasy.

We had an early dinner, and after, the kids got a rare evening opportunity to watch some TV. Terri and I were in the kitchen. She was cleaning up. I was going through a stack of mail.

“You’re quiet tonight,” Terri noted.

Indeed, I was. Terri wasn’t the first to have noticed. Our attractive 23-year-old, admin assistant, Emily, had asked me if I was okay, as had an old married, co-worker, Sam, over lunch. In both cases, I demurred, although I did momentarily amuse myself with the possibility of unburdening myself to Emily. I pictured a look of horror and then disgust spreading across her pretty little face.

Oh, my God, Mr. Nichols, what is wrong with you?

What was wrong with me?

“Bill?” she persisted.

I looked up at her.

She snorted. “Oh for Christ’s sake, you look like I just took away your toy.”

“I’m sorry if it affects me when my wife has sex with another man,” I snapped.

“It was your idea,” she noted.

“No. I... I just gave you the option. The freedom.”

She laughed, but there was a dark edge to it. She sat down at the table beside me and leaned in.

“Tell me, Bill, did you like the pictures I sent you?”

I hesitated and in doing so lost the opportunity to credibly deny it. Mulishly I persisted. “Not really.”

“Uh huh,” she replied skeptically.

“So you never want me to do it again.”

Again, I paused as my mind churned.

“It’s not about me,” I replied.

She laughed, shaking her head in astonishment.

“What?” I grumbled.

“You’re incredible, you know that.”

“Not as incredible as *Mike*, apparently.”

Anger surged across her face. I was about to apologize when she broke out in a sickly, sweet smile that didn't quite reach her eyes.

"He *was* incredible," she gushed.

I felt myself flush. "So why don't you see him again?" I challenged.

"Who says I won't? In fact, Baby, who says I didn't? Maybe my pussy is leaking his come right... this... second," she hissed, punctuating the last few words with a finger jab to my chest.

She let that linger in the air for a moment. She slapped her palms on the table and rose quickly, sending her chair skittering across the kitchen floor. Without another word, she stormed off.

I waited a little and then followed after her. She was squeezed in between the kids on the sofa, watching TV, asking them questions about their show, which Braden, in particular, answered with alacrity.

She looked over at me, still angry, but then I saw her soften and she gave me a small, inviting smile. I joined them on the sofa. A perfectly normal family, having a perfectly normal evening.

"I'm sorry I blew up at you," she said softly as we climbed into bed.

"I'm sorry for being an ass," I replied.

I wasn't actually one-hundred percent sure I was being an ass, just as I suspected she felt at some level that she was justified in her anger as well. Having a successful relationship always involves at least some apologizing for things you're not really sorry about.

Maybe it would have been healthier for us to each say something like, *I understand why you're upset, but I'm not ashamed of my feelings*. But that wasn't Terri and me. Maybe that was a fatal flaw to all of this. She and I just didn't communicate well enough to either deal with the emotions we were churning up or find some way to resolve things.

The truth is, we'd been papering over the tensions since the beginning, dulling our anger with sex.

Which is exactly what we did again that evening. Apologies turned into kissing. Kissing into naked fondling. After she admitted that she hadn't actually been with Mike again, I went down on her, safe in the dark, beneath the covers, enjoying her silky smooth pussy, its fresh tang, the way my tongue made her moan and squirm.

I eased myself up her body, between her spread legs, letting my cock ease its way into her inviting channel. Even though I'd just been eating her out, we kissed wetly. Her hands squeezed my ass, urging me on. I thrust in harder, faster. She gasped, coming suddenly, unexpectedly. She craned her neck up and sucked my nipple into her mouth, her tongue swirling around my sensitive nub. I plunged in as far as I could and shuddered, filling her womb with my sticky come.

I collapsed onto her.

She kissed my neck. "That's all I need," she said.

"But it's not all you want," I replied mechanically.

She sighed, but didn't reply. And just like that, we were back to square one.

Square one, once again involved relatively little communication, but a great deal of teasing. Or... I don't know, was it teasing? Was it more like taunting? Or perhaps just my imagination.

The unexpected heels and left-behind panties had not meant anything. The anklet had. Coincidence or something else? Was the anklet the clue that she was planning on sleeping with another man? Or had she been up for it those other days as well and no opportunity had arisen? Was it all random?

I should have just asked. But I knew what her answer would be. If I asked her if she was planning to see another man, she'd ask me if that is what I wanted. And when I said it was up to her, she'd snort and tell me that if that was the case, then why was I asking?

Lots of angst, but no crisis. We co-parented beautifully. We had frequent married-people-sex, which was always amazing while it was happening, but which always left me feeling like I'd disappointed her after.

She was a girl who liked being tied up and gagged, having her pussy slapped, and then fucked with a thumb up her ass. She was a girl who enjoyed being stripped naked and screwed in public. A girl who would allow herself to be picked up by a muscular stranger and banged on a stack of beer crates. A girl who liked threesomes and anal sex and God only knows what else.

The truth is, being with Terri was fucking intimidating just because of her looks. She could have any man in the world, and she'd chosen me to marry. But it was still anxiety provoking.

That's another reason why I could never confide in anyone about this. Aside from the embarrassment at admitting the situation, I knew I'd seem like a complete ass when I explained that my existential problem was that my wife was too beautiful, too kinky, and too sexual for my comfort.

Here is another weird truth. I would probably have been happier, overall, if Terri had been plainer and more conservative sexually. If she were the sort of woman married men joke about. I could have been just one of the guys, joking about my wife's fat ass, the fact that she no longer sucked cock and only wanted to screw once a month.

Clues. Hints. Breadcrumbs. I noted them all. Commented on none. Spiky heels one day. Hoop earrings another. Little touches on other days: Rich, red lipstick with a shiny gloss. Hair done in a loose curl. French-tipped fingernails. A lacy, white bra visible beneath a sheer, white blouse. Tights and boots. Thigh-high stockings.

Just a woman mixing things up playfully? Or something more?

Then one night we were in bed. It was the night of the thigh-highs, although now she was in her flannel nightie.

"I'm too sore to fool around tonight."

She said it casually. *No big deal*. Did she just have a tough workout at the gym? No, the way she looked at me, expectantly, excitedly, told me it was more.

Mouth dry, I asked her, "Mike?"

"I've been thinking about him a lot recently," she admitted.

It hurt, even though I wasn't really surprised. I'd been thinking about him as well, even when we made love... especially when we made love. Why shouldn't she as well?

I nodded.

"But that's not who I went to see," she added, dragging it out. "I had a client lunch at Marlin Malin."

I thought about the bar next door.

"Brian...." I breathed.

She smiled widely as if his name alone was enough to make her swoon. I remembered the night he'd dragged her into the...

"Storeroom?" I asked.

She twirled a strand of blond hair around her manicured finger.

“Actually, Honey, they were expecting a delivery, so instead we ducked into the ladies room. You know how much I enjoy having sex in a bar bathroom.”

Almost too perfect. She was flaunting her latest fling even as she recalled the way this whole situation had begun, with the disclosure that her old boyfriend had screwed her in a nightclub toilet. I could see her playing me, and I was determined to stay cool.

“Reliving your experiences with Chucky?” I asked.

She smirked. “Well, not really. At least not after we actually locked the door. Not only is Brian *much* bigger than Chucky...” and by extension me “...but he didn’t bend me over either. He just picked me up in his powerful arms and bounced me up and down on his huge cock until I screamed.”

I knew he was strong enough to do it, so it was easy to imagine my slender wife wrapped up in his tattooed, lumberjack arms, skirt bunched around her waist, and her once-tight, little pussy obscenely stretched around his massive prick.

“Maybe he should have taken a tip from Mike and gagged you.”

“But what would be the fun then? See, Bill, that was one of the hottest parts of it. When we were done, there was a whole group of them, waiters, kitchen staff, even a couple of customers waiting to cheer at us. The only thing better would have been if you’d been there too.”

I let out an involuntary grunt. She’d gotten to me after all, both with the knowledge that a whole bar full of people knew Terri had fucked Brian, but also with the image of me sitting there as they all cheered my cuckolding.

“I think you enjoy tormenting me as much as the sex.”

She laughed. “Oh, no, Bill, nowhere near as much. In fact, I’m grateful. It’s not every man who is confident enough and generous enough to let his wife sow her wild oats with a stud like Brian.”

“Or Mike.”

“Or Jean-Pierre. But actually, Mike and Jean-Pierre aren’t studs. They’re very, *very* talented lovers, not studs. Brian, though, God, those muscles and that cock....”

She paused and I could see her preparing the next blow, but there was nothing I could do to stop it. I braced myself. She smirked.

“....speaking of which, would you like to see a picture?”

She didn't wait for an answer. She grabbed her phone off the side table, and before I knew it she held it out to me. It was an obscene, post-sex selfie. My freshly fucked wife, smiling, face flush and shiny with sweat, kneeling beside his tree-trunk legs, palming his softening, but still massive cock, glistening with their shared fluids.

I was speechless.

“I should have taken a picture of it when it was hard, but to tell the truth, Honey, when it's hard, all I can think of is getting it inside me.... You can see that, can't you?” she trilled.

“Maybe you should spend the night with him,” I growled.

She laughed and rolled her eyes. “Oh, Honey, I can't do that. He's much too big for more than a quickie.”

I was making it too easy for her. She twisted in the knife.

“I mean, unless you really wanted me to try. Would you really want that big man to pound my poor, little pussy all night long with his huge prick?”

A searing vision flashed into my mind. My wife, on her back, Brian pressing her thighs to her chest, plunging his oversized cock into her. I imagined her labia, impossibly stretched, clinging to his fat shaft. It was an image I'd seen in porn videos, but now I was casting Terri in the role of the skewered ingénue.

“No... I...”

But I didn't know what to say, and when Terri suddenly lunged at my crotch I stopped trying.

“Hmmm. You do seem to love hearing about my adventures.”

She massaged the erection I didn't even realize I'd had, although neither she nor I were surprised by it.

“Next time, if I'm not too distracted, I'll have to try to film it somehow. I bet *that* would really set you off.”

Terri slobbering on a huge prick, impaling herself on it, seeing him pound it into her as she cried out and swung her head from side to side, long strands of blond hair arcing across her face. She rubbed me harder. I grunted, coming in my PJs.

“Uh oh,” she cooed. “Looks like we made a mess.”

I pushed her away in embarrassment and stormed off to get changed and cleaned up.

In the bathroom, I stared at myself in the mirror. I didn't recognize the man I saw. He was haggard and haunted with sunken wild eyes and a wan complexion. I could see the fear in his eyes.

I was losing her. It hit me like a thunderbolt, but as the thought formed in my mind, I knew it to be true. And I couldn't blame her to being tempted by her various men – stylish, sophisticated, skilled studs. They were well-endowed, creative, and commanding. And what was I? Just an average guy, scared and married way out of his league.

Our game was just an illusion. Wishful thinking. And the current situation was unstable. I'd tried to convince myself that giving her an outlet would prevent me losing her like I'd lost Melanie. But now I saw the truth. Terri would fall again and again into temptation, until, one day, temptation would turn into infatuation and infatuation into love. One day, Terri would break a different kind of news to me. Not just a sexual adventure, but a deeper connection, one that would demand more regular attention and that would quickly compete with and then push aside what we had.

That wasn't Brian. He was a fling. Just a hot body, a big cock, and overflowing confidence. And even if Terri were to fall for him, he wouldn't be interested in an older woman, no matter how hot, with kids. Given his attributes and his job, he was probably dripping with pussy. But he was part of the process. Every time my wife creamed on his fat prick, it reminded her that the grass was indeed greener elsewhere.

"Oh Honey," she cooed from the bedroom. "I almost forgot the best part."

I groaned and tried to compose myself. All of this was just in my mind. A product of my masochism running headlong into my insecurities. Ultimately, she was just doing what I had encouraged her to do.

"Coming," I replied.

I splashed some cold water on my face and then tried to affect a serene smile. I doubted it would fool anyone, much less my wife, but it was the best I could do.

I returned to the bedroom. She was naked, her back to me. I thought I could see his handprints on her glorious ass, but maybe that was just my imagination. The swell of her full breasts was visible on either side of her slender torso.

She began to turn, and I braced myself for what must surely be coming next: the sight of her usually pretty, little pussy now swollen and

red from taking Brian's massive prick.

See what that big, bad man did to your little wife?

But when she turned, her body looked perfectly normal. She wasn't gaping or dripping or anything else obvious and crude. In fact, it took me a few moments to notice it.

"Is that?" I asked.

She approached me slowly, hands framing it for me. A tiny rose, lovely even against a background of irritated skin. Just a few inches from her pussy, on her lower abdomen.

"A tattoo?" I stammered.

"Brian got it for me."

He was covered in ink himself, so it wasn't surprising that he'd offer. She'd said she had no interest in a tattoo, so it shocked me that she'd accept. And in such an intimate spot....

As always, she seemed to read me like an open book. She grinned.

"I think," she began slowly, "that Brian got of kick out of getting me naked in front of the tattoo artist. And he... definitely didn't seem to mind. One of the perks of the job, I guess."

I nodded mutely. I know she was trying to get me worked up with the exposure part of it. And in a different circumstance, that might have done it. The idea of my wife, accompanied by her lover, bare-assed in front of a perfect stranger working just inches from her pussy.... Normally, that would make me nuts. But that image just got pushed from my mind by the other reality.

He's marked her. No, Brian hadn't tattooed his name on her flesh. It was just a rose. Delicate and pretty, even classy maybe, albeit intimate. But it was the symbolism of it. She was now changed. Different. Permanently so.

"Do you like it?" she asked.

I didn't reply. I may have nodded. I'm not sure.

"Brian did," she continued. "When it was done, he couldn't keep his hands off me. We had another quickie right there in the tattoo parlour, with just a curtain between us and the rest of the studio."

Intellectually, I knew that this also would normally have set me off. But it didn't. Not this time. Somehow, it felt like we'd just crossed some invisible, yet very real line. There was no going back. And worse, I knew where things now inevitably led.

I could see it all unfolding before me. It was April and Melanie again. And I was helpless. A slow motion car crash that I was incapable of avoiding. There was nothing I could do... because in truth, it wasn't that I was losing her. I had lost her.

It was my own fault, of course. In order to deal with my own fears, my insecurities, my... issues, I had pushed Terri to confront her temptation. Secretly I'd hoped she'd be the stronger one... or maybe, I was counting on her shame. That's a dark thought, isn't it? But there is some truth to it. I was hoping that she'd be sufficiently ashamed of her desires that she'd recoil from acting on them.

In my mind, I was the virtuous one. I was just allowing her to express her sensuality. Yippie. What a fucking well-adjusted, secure, giving guy I am. Except, deep inside, I always hoped she wouldn't or couldn't call my bluff.

Chucky I wrote off to a unique, irresistible attraction that predated me. He'd had her first. And Jean-Pierre... well, that was just a one-off. Paris-induced romantic madness. But then Brian... and now Mike.... The floodgates were open. And new boundaries were being crossed.

I had pressed Terri again and again to explore her desires, even as I hoped eternally that she'd suppress them for me, but somehow without blaming me. I'd wanted to square the circle, but instead I had just continued to throw logs onto the fire of temptation, until it burned so hot and so bright that it was all-consuming.

I had tempted her again and again. And, ultimately, she'd given in. I couldn't blame her... but I did. I hated her for it, and yet I didn't, couldn't. I'd done it to myself.

But whatever.... I could go around and around forever. It didn't really matter. It wouldn't change anything because in that moment of lucidity I saw it all clearly, once and for all. She was still there with me, so maybe I hadn't lost her, but I also no longer had her. I knew she was her own person and had never really "belonged" to me, and yet the realization that I would, from now, on be sharing her with other men left me profoundly sad. And defeated. And resigned. There was no going back.

She was too tempting to deny and too tempted to resist.

THE END... for now

AN EXCERPT FROM *Taming Terri*:

“You know what I like about you?” Brian asked.

“It is my wit and love of theater?” Terri suggested playfully

He laughed. “No romance, no foreplay, you’re just in it for the cock.”

She chuckled. “You know what I like about *you*?”

“My big dick?”

He thrust in hard to punctuate the response.

She gasped.

“Mmmm, yeah. You fuck like you’re angry.”

I wouldn’t have thought that was a good thing. But obviously from her tone, it was.

“Just giving you what dirty slut like you needs.”

“How do you know what I need?”

Another hard thrust from him. A sultry gasp from her.

“I just do. All those things your hubby won’t give you. Rough. Sweaty. The kind of shit you won’t admit to him. Weird stuff. Dirty. A roomful of strangers taking turns with you.”

“No,” she moaned.

“I felt your cunt twitch when I said it.”

“No,” she repeated, her tone even deeper, throatier, belying her response.

He laughed. “You don’t know you want.”

“I do,” she protested.

He laughed again. I could see why. Despite her objection, she remained his to do with as he pleased. It wasn’t just her tone, which dripped with sexual excitement, but also her body, undulating slowly as his fat prick churning inside her, the way she thrust her ass toward him, molding herself to him, the way her lips trembled, the way her face glowed.

“Get on your knees,” he growled. “I want to nut in your mouth.”

Such was his command over her that not only did she not protest, she didn’t even hesitate. She spun gracefully and dropped to the floor. With both hands she gripping his fat, slick prick and stroked it up and down.

“Yeah, Baby, open up.”

Again my wife complied.

“Like this?” she asked.

She opened her mouth wide, tongue flicking at the head of his prick as she continued to work his cock.

“Yeah, slut, here it comes....”

A thick spurt of creamy jism shot into her mouth.

“Don’t swallow,” he commanded as he continued to rope onto her tongue.

She knelt there submissively, naked, mouth full of his come, until from both corners of her mouth a thin stream of jism and spit leaked out, sliding down her cheek and meeting at her chin. A drop dripped onto her heaving breasts.

“Go ahead and swallow.”

She nodded, and with a loud gulp drank his heavy load. She wiped her chin and licked that up too. And then, unbidden, she licked a last drop of come off his prick.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

I am your typical family man with a wife and kids and an overactive imagination. I am a longtime reader and author of erotic fiction. I write in genres that I find exciting and arousing. Most of my stories are in the naughty wife, wife-watching genre, though occasionally I venture into other subject matter.

I have written several pieces of longer-form fiction.

Two Sides of Terri

Bill has just about the perfect life. Good paying job. Lovely home. Perfect children. And most of all, he has his wife Terri--smart, funny, great with the kids. Thing is, she's a good girl trapped in a bad girl's body. Blonde, busty, and devastatingly beautiful, she makes him want to do dirty things--things you don't admit to wanting from the girl-next-door.

Or so he thought.

It starts with a revelation about Chucky, a past boyfriend, and everything he thought he knew about his sweet wife unravels. He becomes obsessed with learning more about this other side of Terri--and everything he learns points back to Chucky, a man she couldn't say no to. Does he dare invite her past back into their present? And if he did, would she now be able to say no?

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